DEGREE PROJECT

Hybrid Board game for Business thinking

Sponsor : Business Design Lab Pvt. Ltd

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GUIDE : Mr. Shekhar Bhattacharjee

2020

INDUSTRIAL DESIGN FACULTY (TOY & GAME DESIGN)

राष्ट्रीय डिज़ाइन संस्थान
NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF DESIGN

The Evaluation Jury recommends MURALI KRISHNA MENON for the

Degree of the National Institute of Design

IN INDUSTRIAL DESIGN (TOY & GAME DESIGN)

herewith, for the project titled "Hybrid Board game for Business thinking"

on fulfilling the further requirements by*

Chairman

Members :

Jury Grade : _____

*Subsequent remarks regarding fulfilling the requirements :

This Project has been completed in _____ weeks.

Activity Chairperson, Education _____

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Throughout the creation of this work, I have adhered to the principles of academic integrity and ethical research practices. Any information or ideas derived from external sources have been appropriately cited and referenced, giving due credit to the respective authors and creators.

I attest that the design process has been diligently followed to conceptualize, develop, and refine the ideas presented in this work. This process involved rigorous research, analysis, brainstorming, prototyping, testing, and iteration to ensure the highest level of creativity, quality, and authenticity.

I take full responsibility for the originality and authenticity of this work and am committed to upholding the standards of intellectual honesty and integrity in all academic and creative endeavors.

Manish Yadav
Toy and Game Design
National Institute of Design, Gandhinagar

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Manish Yadav
Toy and Game Design
National Institute of Design, Gandhinagar

PREFACE

In a world where innovation must meet impact, strategic thinking can no longer be taught—it must be experienced.
Unbox is a hybrid, collaborative board game designed to build real-world business thinking in individuals—from students and postgraduates to designers, product managers, and aspiring entrepreneurs.

This isn't just a game—it's a gamified journey of building a business from scratch.

Players begin online, diving deep into design thinking using Miro-based templates. Guided by the Double Diamond model, they discover problems worth solving, define their customer segments, and frame sharp challenge statements. They map their ecosystem, scan competitors, and build clarity before stepping into strategy.

Then comes the board game—where teams move from abstract ideas to concrete business models. Using curated tactic cards and creative frameworks, they co-create value propositions, craft strategies, and test their logic through hypothesis-building and experimentation.

Blending play with purpose, Unbox is more than just strategy—it's about learning to think like a business, together.

To the readers of this document whether you are educators, gaming enthusiasts, or fellow curious designer. I invite you to immerse yourself in this realm of business thinking. May you find inspiration within these pages, and may our collective commitment to fostering the development of the younger generation illuminate a promising future.

I extend my gratitude for joining me on this transformative journey.

Manish Yadav
Toy and Game Design
National Institute of Design, Gandhinagar

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

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I extend my sincere thanks to Shekhar Bhattacharjee, Head of the Toy and Game Design discipline at NID Gandhinagar, for his unwavering support, insightful feedback, and constant motivation throughout the journey. His encouragement played a pivotal role in shaping the vision of this hybrid game.

I would also like to thank Austin Davis, Co-Discipline Lead of Toy and Game Design at NID Gandhinagar, for his thoughtful guidance, constructive critique, and mentorship during key phases of development.

A special note of appreciation goes to the Business Design Lab and Ajay Parasrampuria, whose visionary leadership and collaborative spirit brought the business innovation lens into this game. Their expertise and encouragement helped me bridge the gap between playful design and strategic thinking, creating a game that's not only engaging but also educational and impactful.

Lastly, I would like to thank my parents and friends from NID for their constant motivation, advice and blessings.

To everyone who supported this journey with time, feedback, or belief—thank you.

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NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF DESIGN

ABOUT NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF DESIGN

The National Institute of Design (NID) is one of India's premier institutions for design education, research, and practice. Established in 1961 and recognized as an Institute of National Importance by the Government of India, NID has consistently played a pioneering role in shaping the design landscape of the country.

With campuses in Ahmedabad, Gandhinagar, and Bengaluru, the institute offers undergraduate, postgraduate, and doctoral-level programs across a wide spectrum of design disciplines. NID is known for its interdisciplinary and human-centered approach to design, fostering creativity, innovation, and social impact. Its alumni have gone on to lead transformative projects across industries—from product and communication design to systems thinking and design for social change—both in India and globally.

Established to expand NID's vision of advanced design education, the Gandhinagar campus offers specialized Master of Design (M.Des.) programs across various disciplines, including Toy and Game Design, Transportation and Automobile Design, Strategic Design Management, and more.

Located in the capital city of Gujarat, the campus fosters a dynamic environment where creative exploration meets strategic thinking. It emphasizes research-driven, industry-relevant learning while encouraging interdisciplinary collaboration.

TOY AND GAME DESIGN

राष्ट्रीय डिज़ाइन संस्थान
NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF DESIGN

ABOUT TOY AND GAME DESIGN

The Toy and Game Design program at NID has a unique mission: to harness the power of play and infuse it into various aspects of our lives. It adopts a 'play-centric' approach, delving into the realms of education, entertainment, and human development to meet evolving needs and seize opportunities for innovation.

This discipline is a rich tapestry of knowledge, drawing from diverse fields within and beyond design. It's a creative playground where design interventions take on a playful twist, sparking creativity and fostering unconventional thinking.

In a world where the concept of 'play' is rapidly evolving, toys, games, and the concept of 'gamification' are making their mark in unexpected places – from education and technology to healthcare and corporate settings. The Toy and Game Design program at NID is at the forefront of this transformation.

One of its core strengths is its project-based pedagogy. Here, students are encouraged to choose projects that resonate with their passions and interests. They explore a wide spectrum of creative endeavours, including digital and board games, toys, play spaces, educational materials, interactive experiences, and even sports equipment. The goal is to merge imaginative ideas with practical expertise, yielding innovative and profoundly meaningful outcomes. It's a journey of discovery, where play is not just a pastime but a powerful tool for shaping the future.

Business Design Lab

Design Services

ABOUT BUSINESS DESIGN LAB

Business Design Lab Pvt. Ltd. is a multidisciplinary innovation and strategy consultancy that blends the principles of design thinking, business modeling, and systems innovation to solve complex challenges for organizations and institutions.

Founded by Ajay Parasrampuria, a seasoned strategic designer and transformation expert, Business Design Lab (BDL) is committed to helping individuals and teams reimagine the way they approach value creation, problem-solving, and organizational growth.

At its core, BDL operates as a creative catalyst—offering gamified learning experiences, customized innovation workshops, and strategic facilitation formats that enable deeper thinking and collaborative action. One of its flagship offerings, the Unbox Gamified Business Innovation Workshop, has been widely recognized for turning complex business strategy concepts into engaging, accessible, and actionable learning experiences.

BDL partners with startups, corporates, academic institutions, and ecosystem enablers to build innovation capabilities, design scalable models, and foster leadership that is both imaginative and execution-ready. Their mission is simple yet profound: to make strategy playable, innovation practical, and collaboration powerful.

OVERVIEW

The career development trajectories of young professionals and entrepreneurs often exhibit notable parallels, particularly in the early stages of their professional lives. Both groups engage in processes that involve defining problems, devising solutions, and identifying appropriate markets or career opportunities. The primary distinction lies in the level of autonomy and risk each is willing to assume.

EMPATHISE & UNDERSTAND

SECONDARY RESEARCH AND LITERATURE REVIEW

PRELIMINARY AND PRIMARY RESEARCH

IN-DEPTH MARKET STUDY AND COMPETITOR ANALYSIS

SECONDARY RESEARCH AND LITERATURE

Common Stages in Career Development:

Assessment:

Individuals evaluate their skills, interests, and values to determine suitable career paths. This stage is crucial for both aspiring professionals and entrepreneurs as they identify their strengths and areas for development.

Investigation:

Exploration of various industries, roles, or business opportunities occurs, with individuals seeking information and networking to understand potential paths better. This phase involves researching market needs or job requirements.

Preparation:

Acquisition of necessary skills and qualifications through education, training, or practical experience is undertaken. For entrepreneurs, this might include learning about business management; for professionals, it could involve obtaining relevant certifications.

" HERE IS THE SPACE TO ADD SOMETHING PART OF THE TEXT LOREM"

Commitment:

A decision is made to pursue a specific career or business venture, leading to the development of a strategic plan or career roadmap. This stage signifies a focused direction toward set goals.

Retention:

Efforts are concentrated on growth and development within the chosen path, whether scaling a business or advancing in a professional role. Continuous learning and adaptation are key components

Transition:

Individuals may reassess their paths, leading to changes such as career shifts, business pivots, or new ventures. This stage reflects the dynamic nature of professional and entrepreneurial journeys

The early career stages of young professionals and entrepreneurs involve similar processes of self-assessment, exploration, and commitment. The choice between pursuing entrepreneurship or traditional employment hinges on individual preferences for autonomy, risk tolerance, and desired career dynamics. Understanding these commonalities and differences can aid individuals in making informed decisions aligned with their personal and professional aspirations.

Income potnetial:

Entrepreneurs:
Some startup founders may earn very little initially, while successful entrepreneurs in tech hubs like Bengaluru can earn substantially.
For instance, successful tech entrepreneurs can earn anywhere from INR 10 lakhs to INR 1 crore annually.

Employees:
The average annual salary for employees in India is around INR 3.8 lakhs (Naukri.com data). Salaries vary widely by industry, with tech sector employees often earning higher wages.

Job satisfaction:

Entrepreneurs:
According to a survey by Global Entrepreneurship Monitor (GEM), about 80% of Indian entrepreneurs report high satisfaction with their career choices.

Employees:
A study by Michael Page shows that around 60% of Indian employees report job satisfaction, with higher satisfaction in sectors like IT and finance.

Faliure rates

Entrepreneurs:
Approximately 90% of Indian startups fail within the first five years (IBM Institute for Business Value and Oxford Economics report).

Employees:
The job turnover rate in India is about 15-20% annually, depending on the industry (LinkedIn India Workforce Report).

Hours worked

Entrepreneurs:
On average, Indian entrepreneurs work around 55-60 hours per week (YourStory).

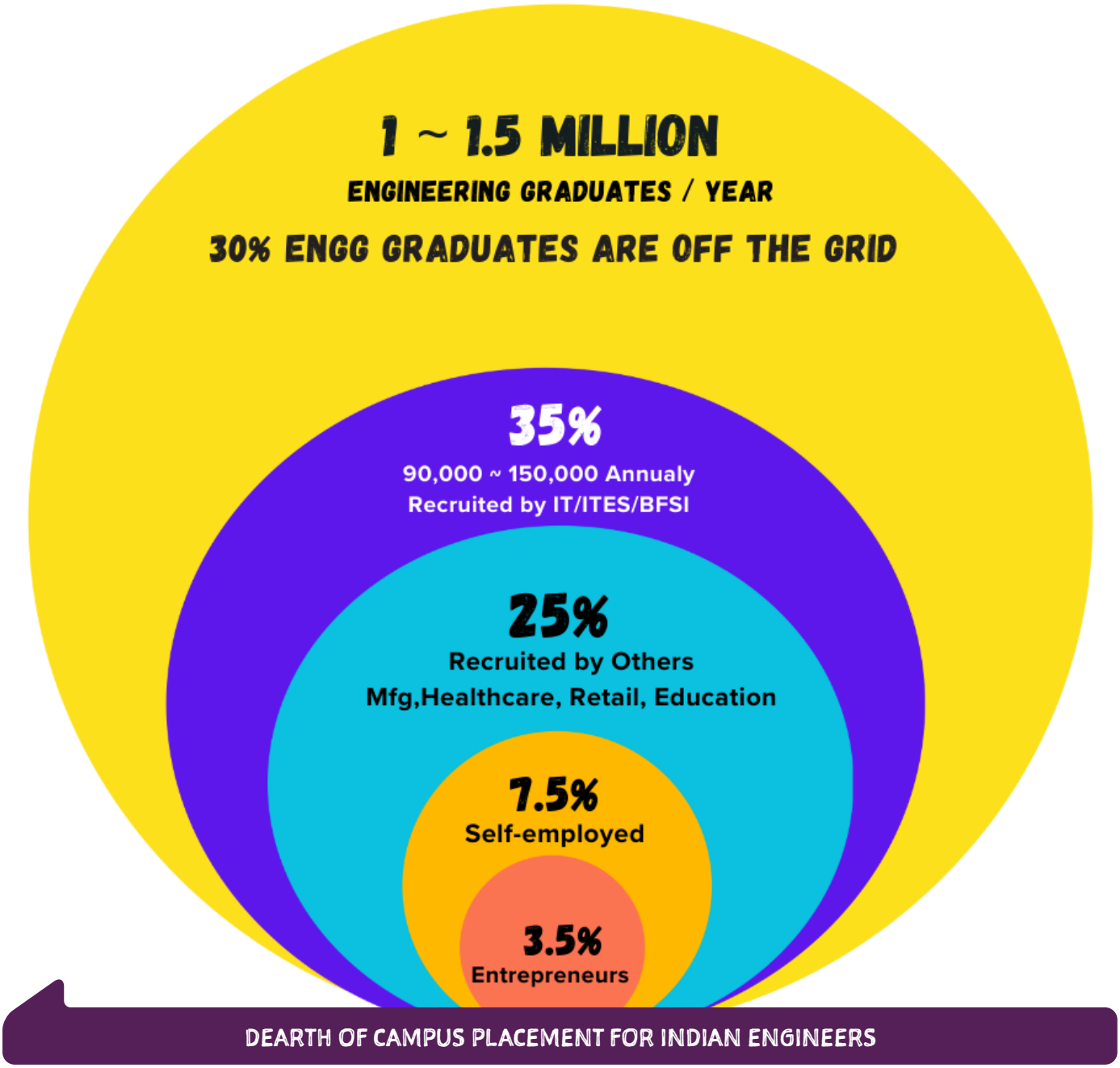
Employees:
Full-time employees in India typically work about 48-50 hours per week (International Labour Organization).

Professionals & Entrepreneurs follow Problem-solving framework:

Step 1: Define the Problem
Professionals: Identify gaps in their skillset or career growth.
Entrepreneurs: Identify a market problem or inefficiency.

Step 2: Find the Solution
Professionals: Learn new skills, upskill, or change jobs.
Entrepreneurs: Develop a product/service that solves the problem.

Step 3: Find the Right Market Fit
Professionals: Identify industries or companies that align with their goals.
Entrepreneurs: Identify the right customer base and market demand.



Source: NASCOMM, All India Survey on Higher Education (AISHE) and other educational reports by the Indian government (People's Archive of Rural India) (NAFSA) (PIB)

What challenges youth face today ?

The rising cost of higher education
Higher education cost rose 10% annually over the past decade.

Low return on investment(ROI) in higher education.
Graduates earn an average starting salary of 3.5LPA. It takes 6-8 years for graduates to break even.

Low employment rates and significant skill gaps.
Only 40% of engineering graduates find employment in their field within 6 months.

Impact of automation on the entry level jobs
By the end of 2025, automation may displace 25% of data entry, customer support & basic coding roles.

Motivations:

Entrepreneurs:
Many Indian entrepreneurs are driven by the desire for autonomy, the ability to innovate, and the potential for significant financial rewards. Cultural factors and government support for startups also play a role.

Employees:
Indian employees often value job security, steady income, and the benefits provided by established companies. Many seek career advancement opportunities within their fields.

Faliures:

Entrepreneurs:
Entrepreneurs in India face challenges such as securing funding, navigating regulatory environments, and managing competition. Access to capital and mentorship are significant barriers.

Employees:
Employees may face issues like work-life balance, job insecurity, and limited opportunities for creative expression in some roles.

As of December 2023, there are over 117,000 recognized startups in India, creating over 1.24 million direct jobs (Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, DPIIT).

63% of Gen Z (born between 1997 and 2012) want to start their own business, according to a survey by EY (2020)

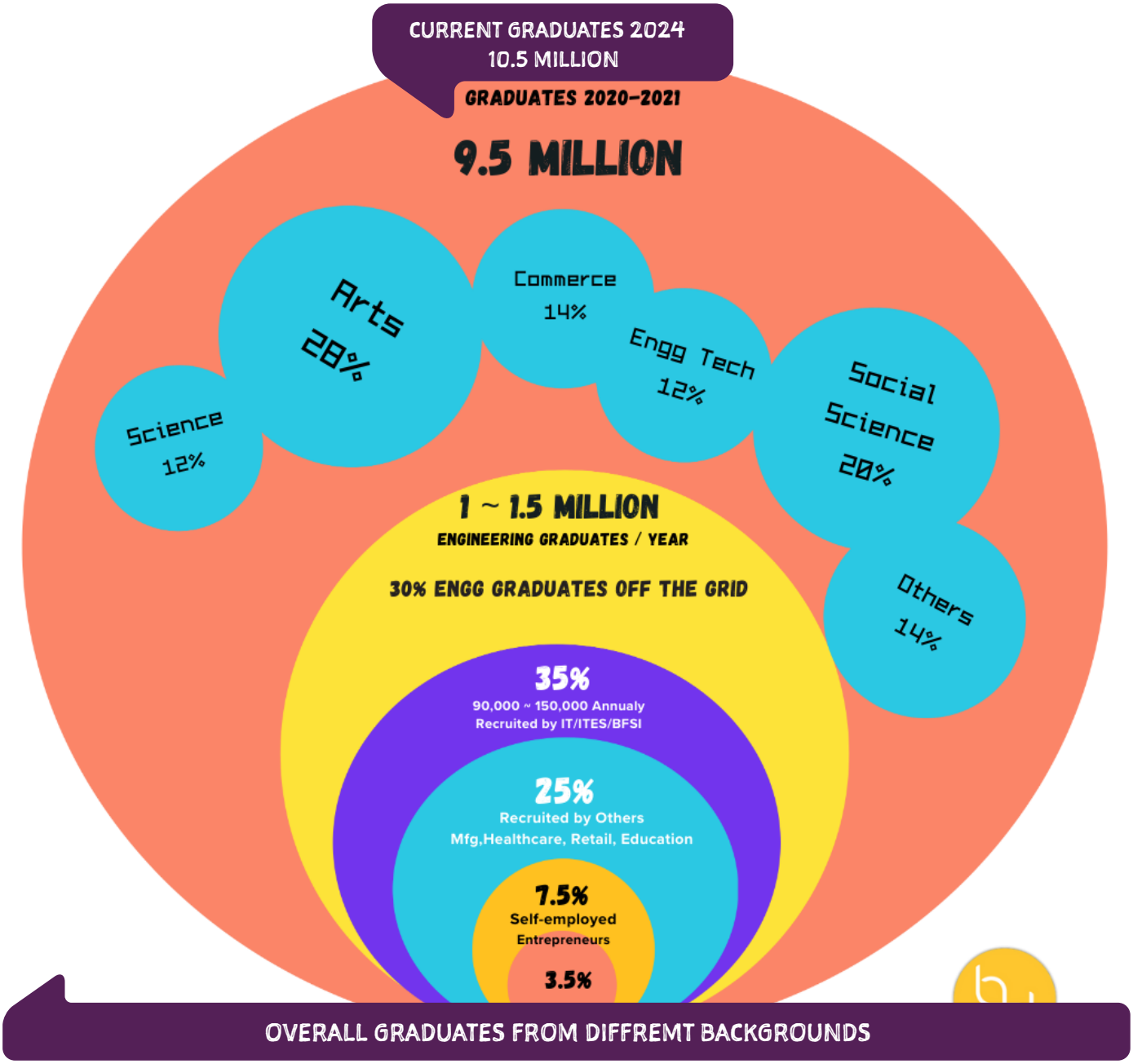
Entrepreneurs are 3 times more likely to create jobs than non-entrepreneurs (Kauffman Foundation, 2019)

Objective of the individuals:

Whether one chooses a job or entrepreneurship, the core objective remains the same: Personal and professional growth, financial stability, and long-term fulfillment.

Both paths demand: Continuous learning, Risk management, Adaptability

A young professional can start in a job and later transition into entrepreneurship, or vice versa. The key is to align one's career decisions with personal goals, risk tolerance, and long-term vision.



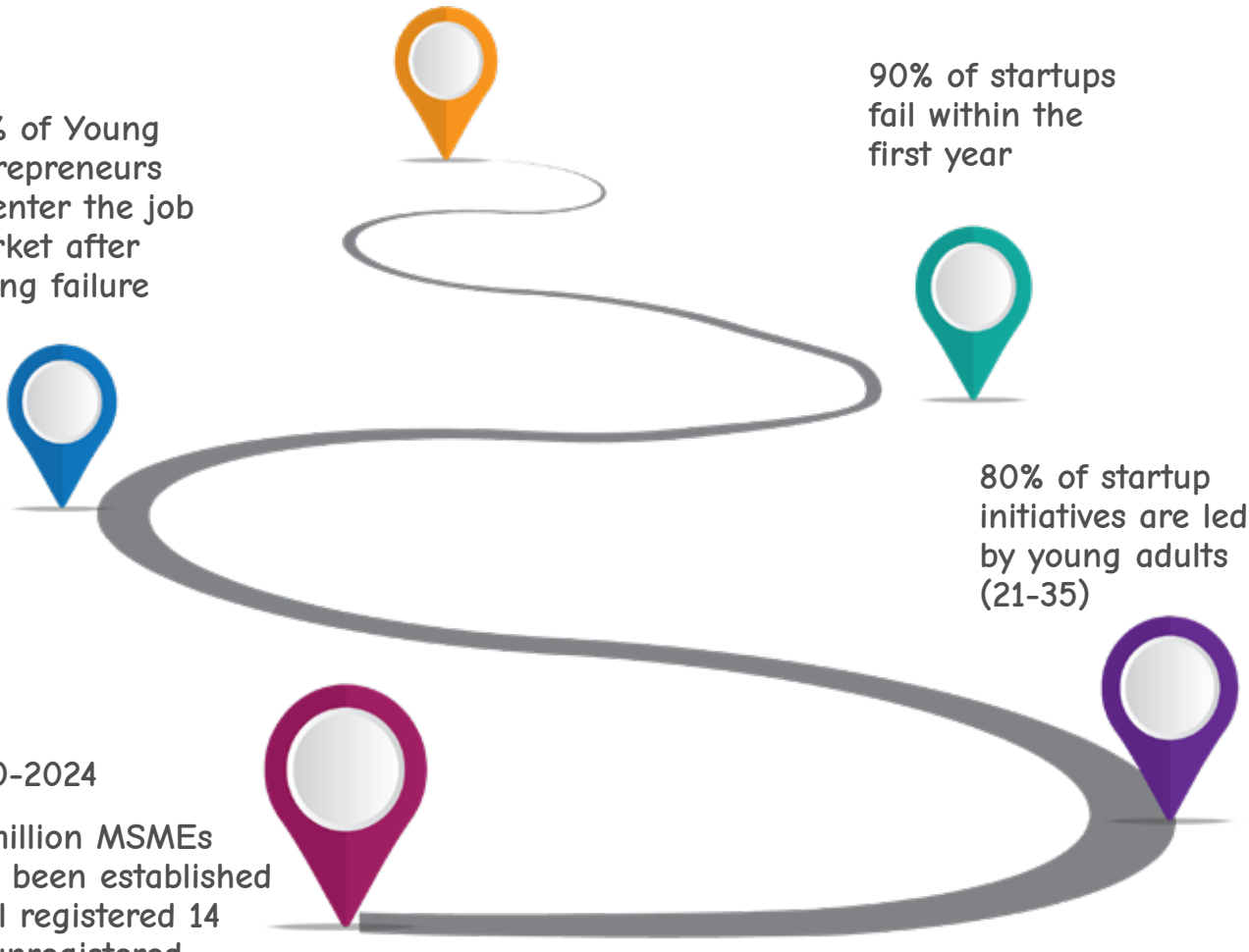
Source: NASCOMM, All India Survey on Higher Education (AISHE) and other educational reports by the Indian government (People's Archive of Rural India) (NAFSA) (PIB)

Entrepreneurship is like graduating from a job:
It requires risk-taking, problem-solving, and leadership like moving from student to professional.

Not everyone becomes an entrepreneur immediately:
Some gain industry experience first, just like how students learn before entering the workforce.

Both career paths demand adaptability:
Jobs provide structured learning, while entrepreneurship is self-driven learning.

Startup story



Career Journey Parallels:
Students → Professionals | Jobs → Entrepreneurship

Visual Framework: The Parallel Career Cycle

Insight:

Both students and professionals go through similar growth phases but in different domains (education vs. work). Similarly, jobs and entrepreneurship involve choosing a path, gaining experience, and scaling up over time.

Students & Professionals | Jobs & Entrepreneurship:

Both involve learning, experimenting, and growth but at different risk levels.

Jobs & Entrepreneurship require skills beyond education:

Soft skills, adaptability, and problem-solving are crucial for both paths.

Mindset Shift:

Moving from student to professional is like transitioning from job security to entrepreneurship—both demand new thinking patterns.

Some professionals become entrepreneurs:

Many employees eventually leverage their experience to start businesses, blending both worlds.

A research project on entrepreneurship is relevant because it aligns with current career trends and economic needs. By studying the motivations, fears, and challenges of young professionals, we can provide better frameworks for entrepreneurial success and help more individuals transition confidently from education to innovation.

OVERVIEW

This primary research was conducted to understand the mindset, challenges, and aspirations of young professionals, recent graduates, and aspiring entrepreneurs when deciding between traditional employment and starting their own venture. Conducted surveys and interview across different backgrounds from Engineering, Business, Design, IT, and Arts.

EMPATHISE & UNDERSTAND

SECONDARY RESEARCH AND LITERATURE REVIEW

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PRELIMINARY AND PRIMARY RESEARCH

The survey highlights a clear divide between job seekers and aspiring entrepreneurs, with most professionals preferring job stability at the start of their careers. However, entrepreneurial ambitions grow over time, with many professionals considering starting a business after gaining experience.

Key Findings: Quantative data

Career Aspirations:

60% of respondents preferred starting their careers with a job for stability.
25% were inclined toward entrepreneurship from the beginning.
15% were unsure and open to both opportunities.

Challenges Faced:

Among professionals in jobs:

40% felt stuck in routine tasks.
35% wanted more creativity & ownership in work.
25% cited job security as their biggest concern.

Among aspiring entrepreneurs:

50% cited financial insecurity as a major roadblock.
30% felt a lack of mentorship & guidance.
20% were concerned about market competition.

Risk Appetite & Decision Factors:

80% of job seekers preferred a stable income over high-risk, high-reward ventures.
65% of aspiring entrepreneurs were willing to take risks but wanted initial financial support.
50% of respondents believed they needed 3-5 years of work experience before considering entrepreneurship.

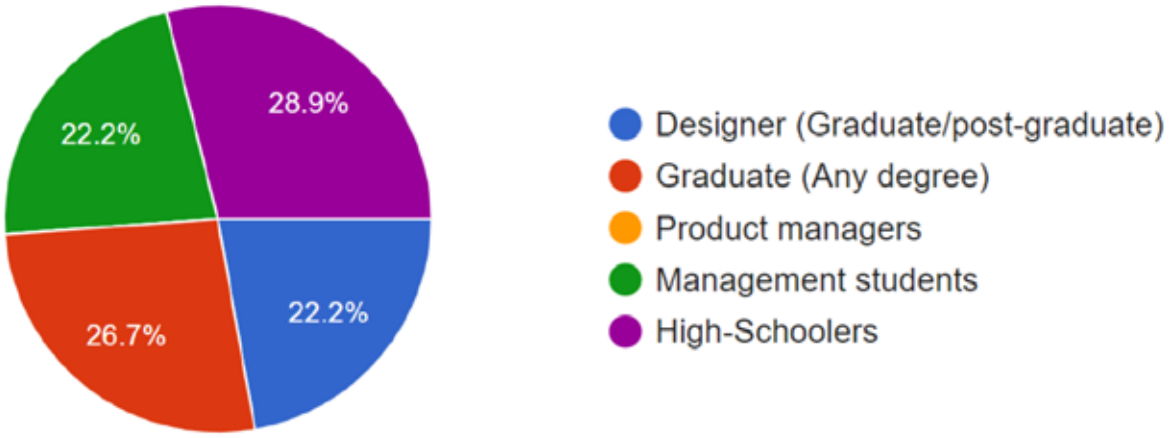
Skills & Readiness:

75% of job-seeking respondents felt university education didn't fully prepare them for industry demands.
55% of aspiring entrepreneurs lacked financial literacy and business skills.
40% believed networking and mentorship played a crucial role in career success.

Conducting a project on entrepreneurship helps to:

1. Understand young professionals' career inclinations (startup vs. job).
2. Identify key barriers (funding, risk, lack of mentorship).
3. Develop strategies to encourage entrepreneurship (incubators, education, government support).
4. Compare entrepreneurial success factors between early-stage professionals and experienced founders.

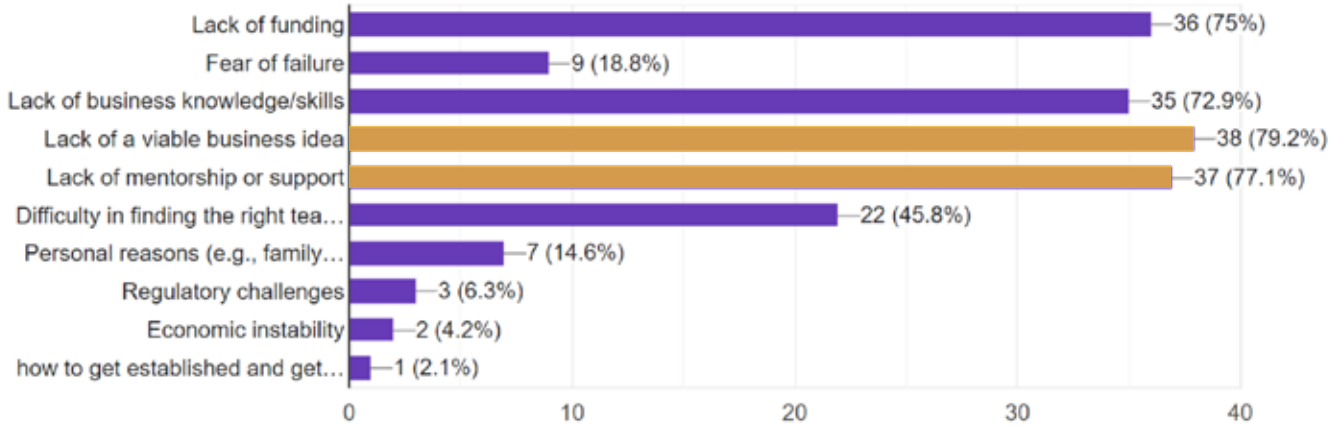
Survey on Entrepreneurship



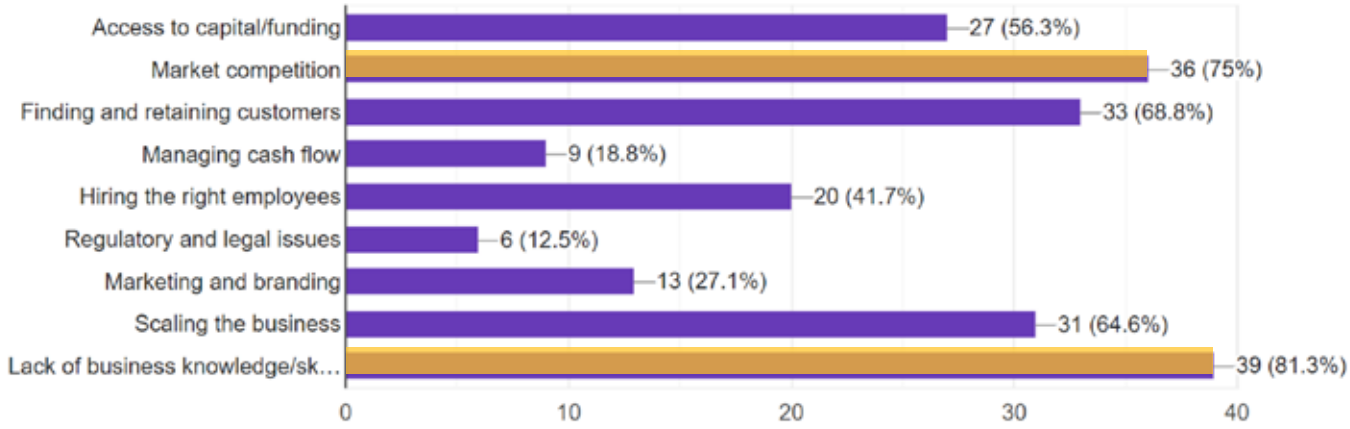
Survey Questionaire:

1. Write your Name ?
2. Select the area that specifies you the best?
3. Are you interested in pursuing entrepreneurship?
4. Have you ever started your own business?
5. If yes, is your business still operational?
6. If no, what are the main reasons you haven't started a business? (Select all that apply)
7. What do you think are the biggest challenges faced by entrepreneurs? (Select all that apply)
8. What kind of support do you think would be most helpful in starting or running a business? (Select all that apply)
9. How do you prefer to learn about entrepreneurship?
10. What type of content do you find most engaging? (Select all that apply)
11. What challenges do you face in accessing learning resources for entrepreneurship? (Select all that apply)
12. Please share any additional thoughts or comments on entrepreneurship: (What Do you need)

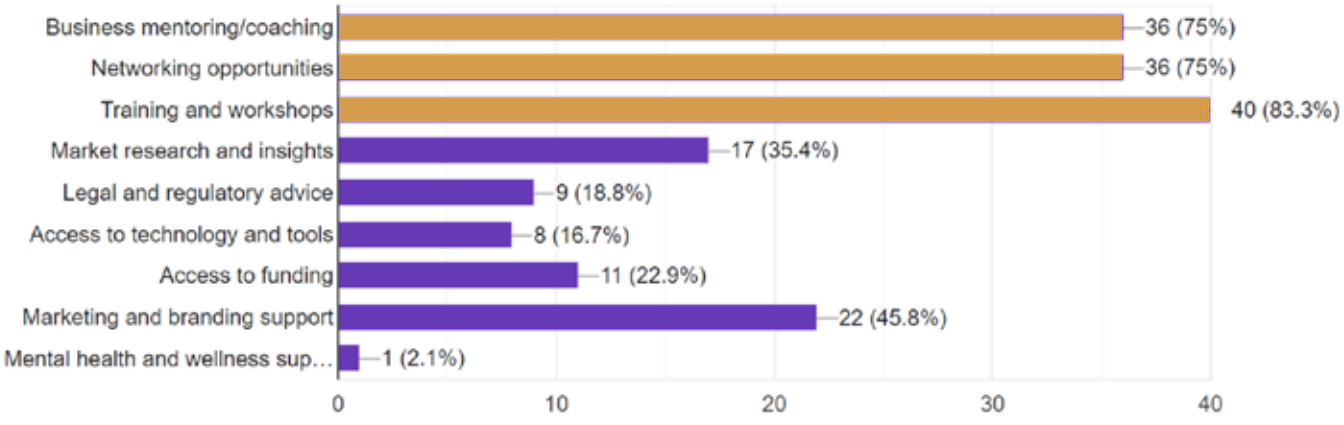
IF NO, WHAT ARE THE MAIN REASONS YOU HAVEN'T STARTED A BUSINESS? (SELECT ALL THAT APPLY)



WHAT DO YOU THINK ARE THE BIGGEST CHALLENGES FACED BY ENTREPRENEURS? (SELECT ALL THAT APPLY)

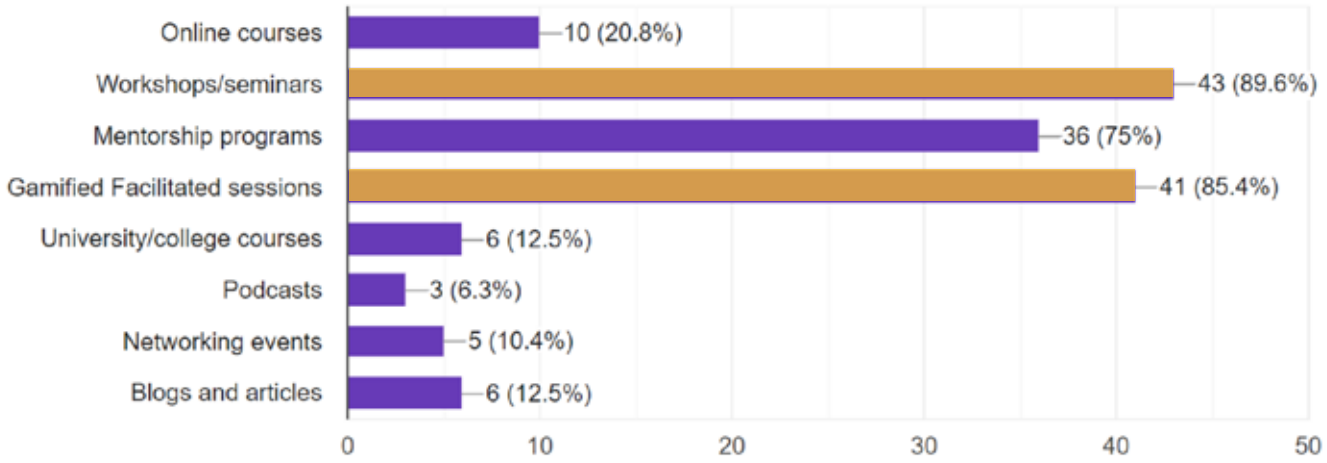


WHAT KIND OF SUPPORT DO YOU THINK WOULD BE MOST HELPFUL IN STARTING OR RUNNING A BUSINESS? (SELECT ALL THAT APPLY)

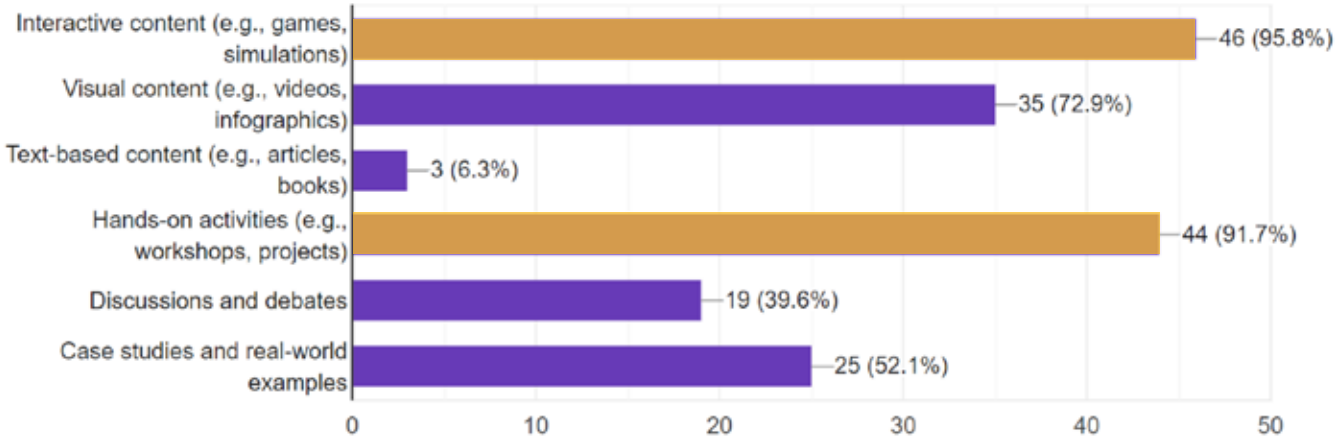


ABOVE ARE SOME KEY SURVEY QUESTIONS AND POTENTIAL DATA INSIGHTS

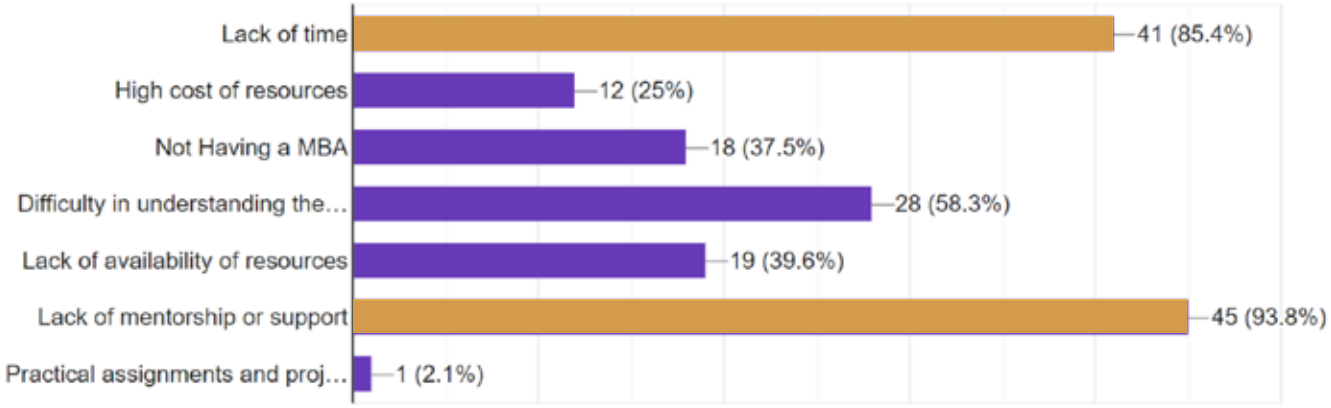
HOW DO YOU PREFER TO LEARN ABOUT ENTREPRENEURSHIP?



WHAT TYPE OF CONTENT DO YOU FIND MOST ENGAGING? (SELECT ALL THAT APPLY)



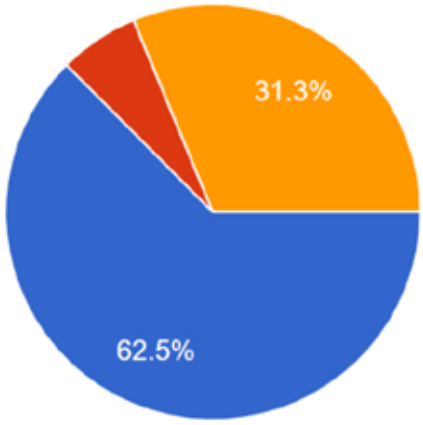
WHAT CHALLENGES DO YOU FACE IN ACCESSING LEARNING RESOURCES FOR ENTREPRENEURSHIP? (SELECT ALL THAT APPLY)



ABOVE ARE SOME KEY SURVEY QUESTIONS AND POTENTIAL DATA INSIGHTS

Entrepreneurship is not just about starting a business; it represents a mindset of innovation, problem-solving, and economic growth. Young professionals today face a dilemma between pursuing stable jobs or taking risks to build businesses. According to Indeed (2024), entrepreneurship offers greater autonomy, financial potential, and creative freedom, while traditional employment provides security and structured career progression.

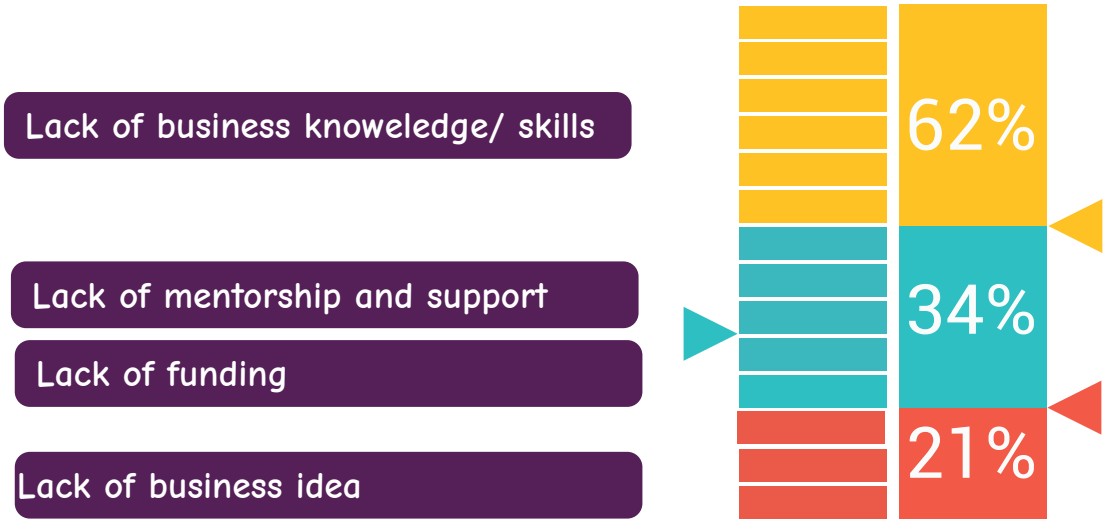
Survey insights pie chart



62% are interested in pursuing entrepreneurship

31% people seems confused and unable to take a decesion as risk factors are high.

7% People are not interested and are happy with their job.



To gain deeper insights into the decision-making process of young professionals and aspiring entrepreneurs by conducting one-on-one interviews with individuals from different career paths. The Individuals selected for the interview were interested in starting their own business.

One-on-one interviews revealed that career choices are dynamic, not static. Many professionals view jobs as a stepping stone to entrepreneurship, while entrepreneurs recognize the value of corporate experience before launching a business.

Customer personas for interview

High-schooler

Name: Aanya Verma
Age: 17
Background: Bright, curious, active in school clubs; interested in entrepreneurship and innovation challenges.

Goals: Explore real-world problem-solving, understand how businesses work, stand out in college applications.

Motivations: Wants to learn beyond textbooks, be part of startup clubs, and create her own product idea.

Pain Points: Limited exposure to business frameworks or design thinking tools; short attention span for complex concepts.

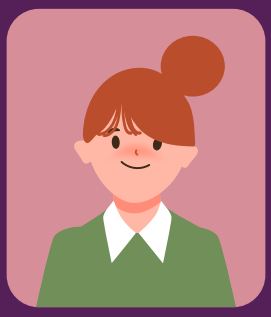
Designer

Name: Rohan Sethi
Age: 24
Background: M.Des student in Communication Design; experienced in visual storytelling and prototyping.

Goals: Translate design work into marketable products and services; collaborate with business and tech teams.

Motivations: Passionate about human-centered design; wants to build meaningful solutions with real impact.

Pain Points: Struggles to articulate the business value of design ideas; lacks confidence in strategic thinking.



Graduate

Name: Neha Kulkarni
Age: 21
Background: BBA graduate exploring career paths in innovation, consulting, or entrepreneurship.

Goals: Gain clarity on how businesses grow; explore startup thinking before pursuing an MBA or master's.

Motivations: Wants to apply theoretical knowledge practically; loves brainstorming, teamwork, and real-world simulations.

Pain Points: Business education felt too textbook-heavy; lacks exposure to startup ecosystems.

Management

Name: Rajeev Malhotra
Age: 34
Background: Mid-level corporate manager (operations and growth); part-time mentor at startup events.

Goals: Stay relevant in the fast-changing business world; develop innovative thinking within his teams.

Motivations: Wants to lead future-facing projects and contribute to strategic planning beyond execution.

Pain Points: Too many frameworks, not enough engagement; conventional workshops feel disconnected from his day-to-day work.

Product Manager /strategist

Name: Priya Sharma
Age: 29
Background: Product Manager at a tech startup; works at the intersection of design, tech, and market.

Goals: Sharpen her product-market thinking; align product vision with customer insights and business goals.

Motivations: Loves rapid experimentation, user validation, and systems thinking.

Pain Points: Team alignment is hard; strategy discussions often become abstract and non-actionable.

One on one: Major Interview questions

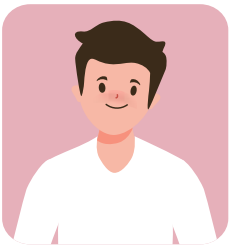
1. Can you tell me about your educational background and any work experience you have?
2. What inspires you to pursue entrepreneurship?
3. What do you see as the biggest barriers to starting your own business after graduation/ 12th?
4. How do you prefer to learn new things? Are you more visual, auditory, or kinesthetic in your learning style? Are you more hands-on, theoretical, or a mix of both?
5. What types of resources do you find most effective for learning about entrepreneurship?
6. Have you used games to learn any skills before? If so, which ones and how was the experience?
7. Have you had any experience with educational games? If so, what did you like or dislike about them?
8. Have you played educational board games before?
9. What elements would you like to see in a game designed to teach entrepreneurship?
10. What support or resources would make it easier for you to embark on an entrepreneurial path?
11. Is there anything else you'd like to share about your learning preferences or challenges in becoming an entrepreneur?

Interview Insight report

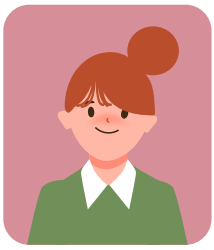
High-schooler

High Schoolers prefer hands-on activities and visual content, including interactive games and project-based learning.

They are excited by the idea of entrepreneurship but lack experience and knowledge about starting a business.



Designer



Designers tend to prefer visual and interactive learning tools. They are attracted to the creative aspects of entrepreneurship but often feel challenged by the understanding business and financial side.

They appreciate learning formats that involve real-life scenarios and interactive decision-making.

Graduate

Graduates are a mix of hands-on and theoretical learners.

They value practical applications of knowledge and are often concerned about funding and lack of experience.

They find online courses and strategic games particularly effective.

Management

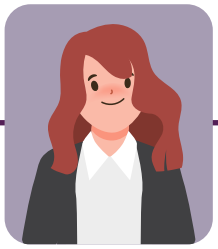
Management Students favor a blend of lectures and hands-on practice.

They are driven by the strategic challenges of entrepreneurship and are familiar with business simulations, which they find beneficial for learning. (Case studies)

Product Manager

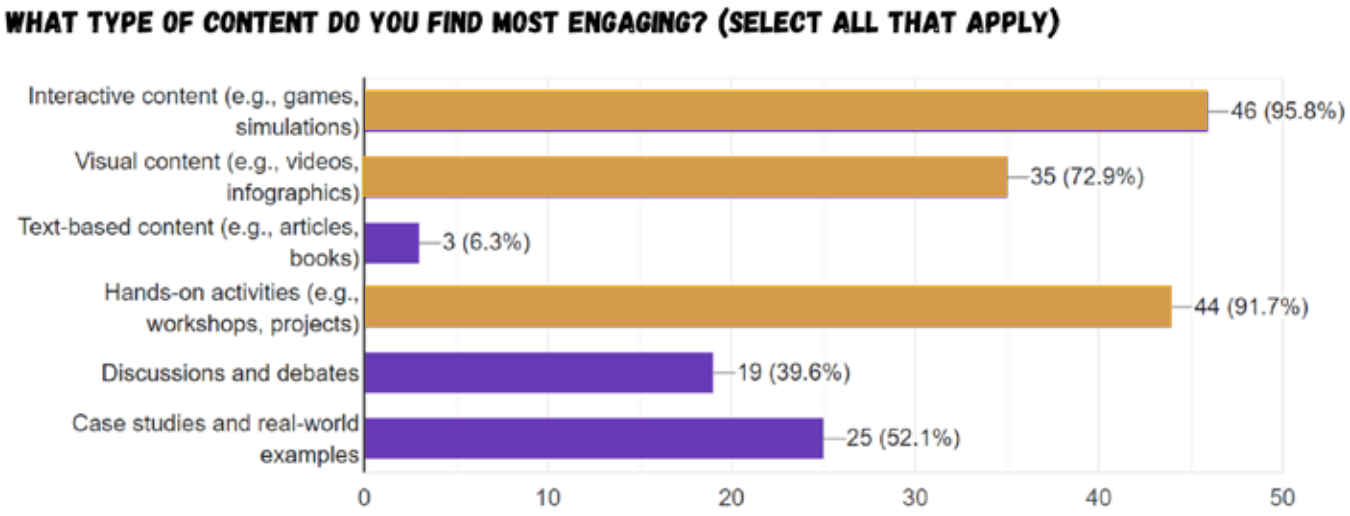
Product Managers are experienced in strategic decision-making and are interested in entrepreneurship for innovation.

They value practical, real-world learning experiences that allow them to apply their extensive management knowledge.



Preffered Learning Methods- Insights

Entrepreneurship is a dynamic field that requires practical skills, problem-solving abilities, and continuous learning. Unlike traditional education, entrepreneurial learning is hands-on, iterative, and highly adaptive. Below are the best learning methods to develop entrepreneurial skills.



Interactive and hands-on learning

Most groups prefer learning methods that are interactive and hands-on, such as board games, online courses with interactive elements, and practical workshops.

This indicates a strong preference for experiential learning, where participants can actively engage with the material.

Visual and Kinesthetic Learning

Designers and high schoolers, in particular, lean towards visual and kinesthetic learning styles.

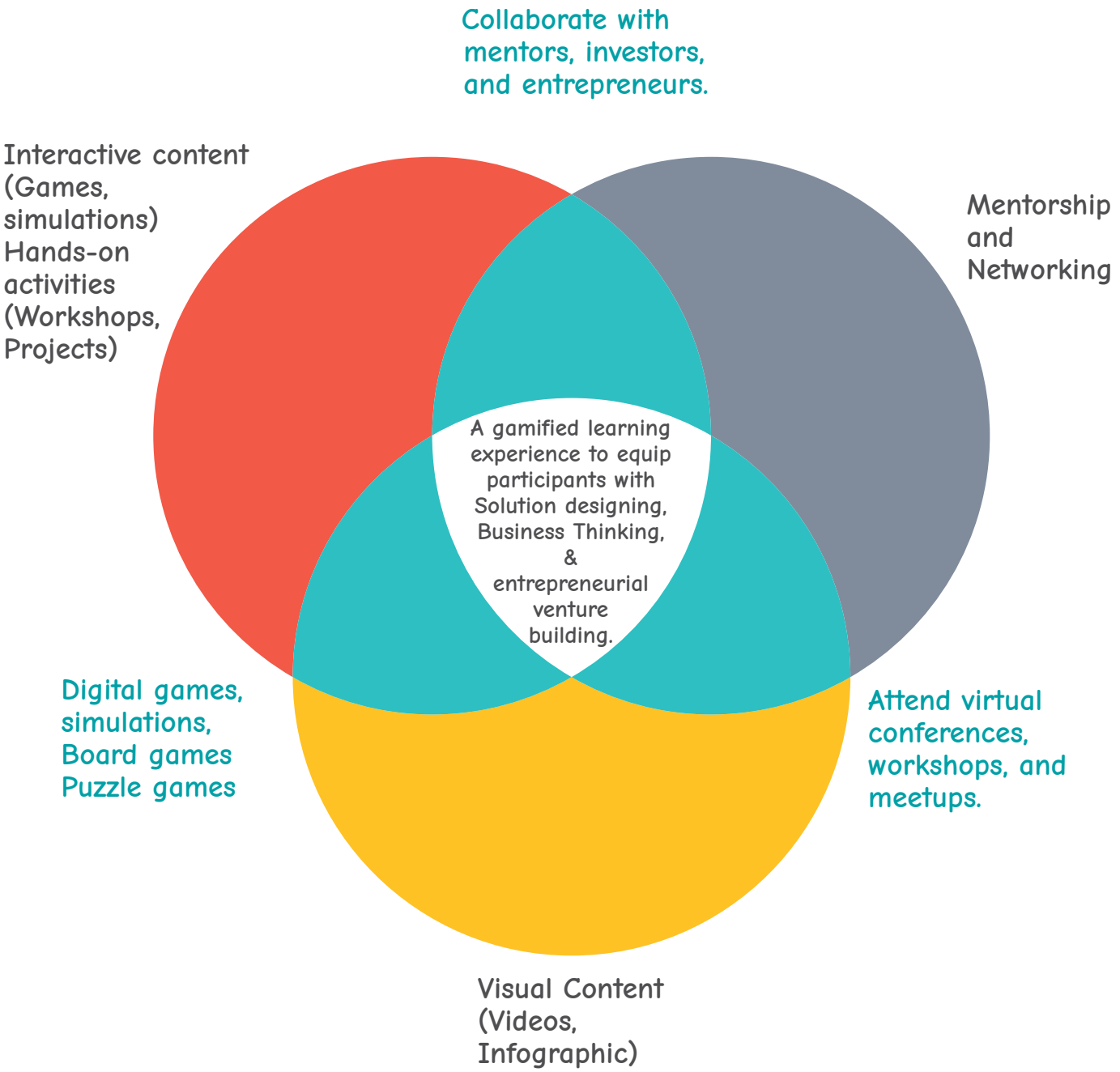
They find videos, infographics, and games more effective than traditional lectures.

Mentorship and Networking

Across all groups, there is a desire for mentorship and networking opportunities.

This is seen as a crucial support system that can provide guidance, real-world insights, and confidence to pursue entrepreneurship.

Entrepreneurship requires a unique blend of knowledge, skills, and real-world experience. Unlike traditional education, learning entrepreneurship is hands-on and requires a mix of formal, informal, and experiential learning.



Board Games as a preferred medium for learning Entrepreneurship

Board games are an interactive, engaging, and hands-on way to teach entrepreneurship. They simulate real-world business challenges, fostering critical thinking, strategic planning, and risk management. Unlike lectures or case studies, board games make learning fun and experiential.

- Hands-On Learning through Simulation
- Collaborative and Competitive Skills Development
- Good for Attention, Engagement and Enjoyment
- Nurtures Strategic Thinking Development & Critical Thinking
- Cost-Effective and Accessible
- Risk Management and Decision-Making
- Realistic Decision-Making Practice
- Customizable Learning Scenarios
- Immediate Feedback and Iterative Learning
- Social Interaction and Networking

By simulating real-world business scenarios, encouraging strategic thinking, and making learning fun and engaging, board games provide an optimal platform for developing the essential skills needed for successful entrepreneurship.

The insights gathered highlight the importance of practical, interactive, and customizable learning experiences, which can be effectively delivered through well-designed board games.

Other mediums for learning Entrepreneurship

Top Learning Platforms:

Y Combinator's Startup School – Free entrepreneurship training.
Harvard Business School Online – Entrepreneurship Essentials.
Coursera / Udemy / EdX – Affordable courses on business, finance, and innovation.
The Lean Startup Bootcamp – Learn agile business-building techniques.

Insight: Online courses bridge the gap between theory and practice, but execution matters most.

Books:

The Lean Startup – Eric Ries (Build & test business ideas).
Zero to One – Peter Thiel (Innovation & market disruption).
The Hard Thing About Hard Things – Ben Horowitz (Handling startup struggles).
The $100 Startup – Chris Guillebeau (Starting small businesses with low investment).

Insight: Reading case studies of both successful & failed businesses helps entrepreneurs avoid common pitfalls.

Mentors & Networks:

Startup Incubators & Accelerators – Y Combinator, Techstars, 500 Startups.
Business Meetups & Conferences – Engage with like-minded professionals.
LinkedIn & Twitter Networking – Connect with startup founders.
Co-working Spaces – Interact with startup teams and investors.

Insight: Learning from a mentor's experience shortens the entrepreneurial learning curve.

Apply This:

Analyze Business Models – Airbnb, Uber, Amazon, Tesla.
Study Failed Startups – Why did Quibi & Theranos collapse?
Apply Insights – Adapt successful strategies to your startup.

Insight: Understanding what works and what doesn't can save years of trial and error.

Types of Business Simulations:

Startup Simulation Games – Platforms like Wharton Interactive.
Harvard Business Review Case Studies – Real business problem-solving exercises.
Pitch Competitions & Hackathons – Solve real challenges under time constraints.

Insight: Business simulations improve strategic thinking & problem-solving.

Redefining Project/Design Brief

Design a gamified learning experience for aspiring entrepreneurs (creators, designers, engineers, management students, product managers, graduate students, and high schoolers).

This experience will provide invaluable insights into solution designing, business modeling, and entrepreneurial venture building, equipping participants with practical business modeling skills.

A transformative educational tool that offers many valuable lessons, from discovering the right product-market fit to framing strategies for self and making conscious tactical choices. Engaging in thought-provoking discussions, gain fresh insights from your peers, and leave with a clear vision of the challenge you'll individually or collaboratively tackle.

Objective

The purpose is to build an experience that will help develop cognitive skills in collaborative, problem-solving, critical, systems, and creative thinking skills, and understanding and knowledge of solution designing, business modeling, and entrepreneurial venture building

Methodology

To achieve this objective, it is imperative to first understand the complexities of the subject.

Systems View:
Integration of Design thinking into business thinking.
Product View:
Modes of learning throughout the hybrid platform. Finding Product market fit after defining problem-solution fit.
User View:
Interaction with the medium (web-based application, smartphones) with a physical companion business thinking innovation toolkit.
Game Design View:
Enhancing User experience through gamification and simplifying the whole learning process of solution designing.

OVERVIEW

A critical component of the Unbox hybrid game experience is helping participants ground their strategies in real-world context. To ensure that strategic decisions are not just creative—but also relevant and competitive—we integrated a structured process for conducting market research and competitor analysis into the gameplay journey.

EMPATHISE & UNDERSTAND

SECONDARY RESEARCH AND LITERATURE REVIEW

PRELIMINARY AND PRIMARY RESEARCH

IN-DEPTH MARKET STUDY AND COMPETITOR ANALYSIS

IN-DEPTH MARKET STUDY AND COMPETITOR ANALYSIS

Market Overview

Growth of Gamified Learning & Business Education

- The gamification industry has seen significant growth, with business simulation and learning games emerging as a major sector. The global game-based learning market is projected to reach $29.7 billion by 2026, growing at a CAGR of 20.1%.
- Entrepreneurship-focused games and board games designed for skill development are increasingly being adopted in corporate training, schools, and entrepreneurial incubators.

Demand for Entrepreneurship Education

- 72% of millennials express interest in entrepreneurship (Global Entrepreneurship Monitor, 2023).
- Business schools are integrating experiential learning and interactive simulations to teach real-world entrepreneurial skills.
- Board games and role-playing simulations are gaining popularity as effective teaching tools in MBA programs, startup accelerators, and professional workshops.

Target Audience

Primary Audience

- Aspiring Entrepreneurs: College students, recent graduates, and professionals looking to start businesses.
- Business & Management Students: Those studying business, finance, and entrepreneurship.
- Corporate Professionals: Individuals looking to develop strategic thinking and investment acumen.

Secondary Audience

- Startup Incubators & Accelerators: Seeking interactive ways to train early-stage founders.
- Educational Institutions: Business schools and entrepreneurship programs.
- Game Enthusiasts: Players who enjoy strategy-based board games like Monopoly, Catan, or Shark Tank: The Game.

Additionally, Gen Z and Millennials are more inclined towards interactive and experiential learning over traditional methods. Research suggests that 70% of learners find game-based education more engaging and effective than passive instruction methods.

With the rise of edutainment, the intersection of education and entertainment is a promising market space for Investment Wars.

Competitor Analysis : Direct Competitors (Entrepreneurship & Business Games)

Game/ Tool	Concept	Key Features	Market Fit
Monopoly	Real estate trading	Property investment, cash flow management	General business strategy
Catan	Resource management	Trading, negotiation, and expansion	Strategic business development
Shark Tank:	Startup pitching	Investment negotiations, valuation	Entrepreneurship & investment skills
Power Grid	Personal finance & investing	Economic planning, competitive bidding	Business & financial decision-making
Cashflow (by Robert Kiyosaki)	Resource management	Cash flow management, passive income strategies	Financial education
Leap	Business Model Innovation	Business Model Elements and tactics	Entrepreneurship & investment skills
Lean Startup Simulation	Strategy Making	Designing Experiments	Theory model

Monopoly

Catan

Cashflow (by Robert Kiyosaki)

Shark Tank

Power Grid

Leap

Lean Startup Simulation

Competitor Analysis : Indirect Competitors (Business Learning & Investment Simulations)

Game/ Tool	Concept	Key Features	Market Fit
Startup Panic	Startup management	Hiring, funding, scaling	General business strategy
Tycoon Series (Game Dev Tycoon)	Business simulation	Resource management, strategic scaling	Strategic business development
Online Investment Simulators	Stock trading & investment	Real-world financial decision-making	Entrepreneurship & investment skills
Capitalism Lab	Business empire simulation	Market research, supply chains, financial management	Business & financial decision-making
Biz Ops	Business strategy game	Operations, expansion, and competitive positioning	Financial education
Business Model Canvas Game	Business Model Innovation	Business Model Elements and tactics	Entrepreneurship & investment skills
The Value Proposition Game	Strategy Making	Designing Experiments	Theory model

Startup Panic

Biz Ops Board game

Tycoon Series (Game Dev Tycoon)

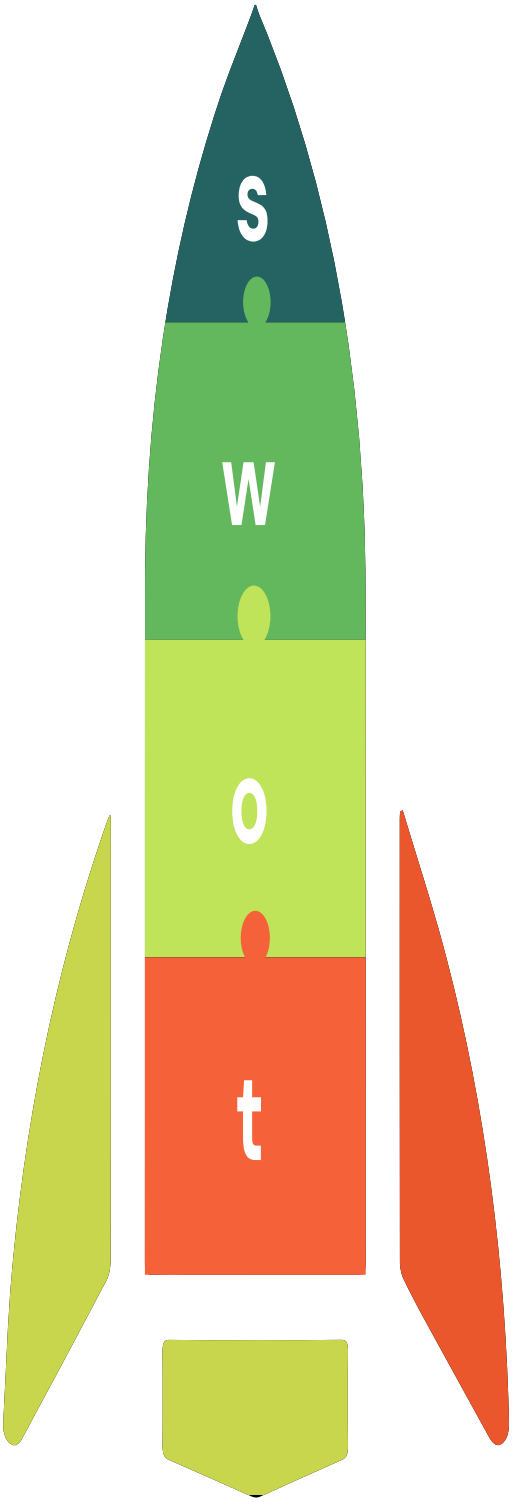
Business Model Canvas Game

Online Investment Simulators

The Value Proposition Game

Capitalism Lab

SWOT Analysis of Entrepreneurship Board Game Market



Strengths

- Unique Learning Approach
- Comprehensive Startup Journey
- Face-to-Face Interaction
- Customizable & Modular Gameplay
- Growing Market Demand
- Scalability

Weaknesses

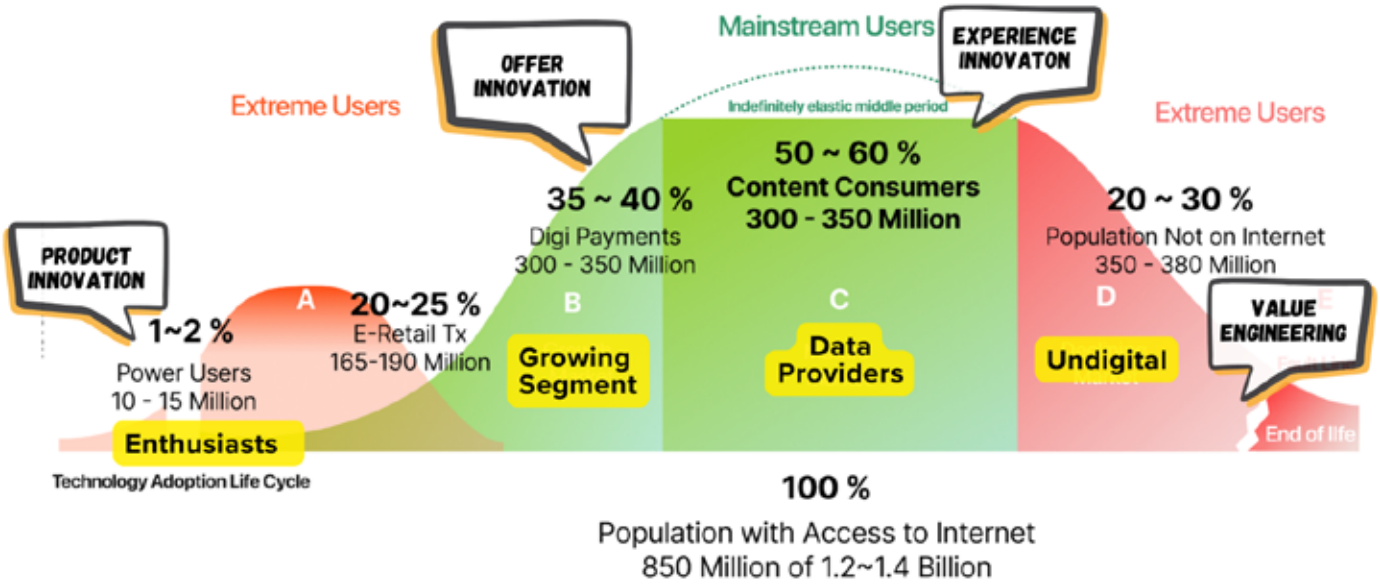
- Niche Audience
- Higher Learning Curve
- Production & Development Costs
- Time-Intensive Gameplay
- Market Education Required

Opportunities

- Rise of EdTech & Gamification
- Partnerships with Universities & Incubators
- Corporate Training Market
- Hybrid Expansion (Board Game + Digital App)
- Community-Driven Content
- Board Game Industry Growth
- Localized & Thematic Editions

Threats

- Market Competition
- Changing Learning Preferences
- High Customer Acquisition Costs
- Piracy & Copycat Products
- Economic Downturns



Market Opportunities & Gaps

Gaps in Existing Games

Lack of Holistic Entrepreneurship Board Games:

While games like Monopoly & Shark Tank focus on investments, they lack a comprehensive startup-building journey, including market research, customer validation, financial planning, scaling, and exit strategies.

Limited Interactive Learning:

Business learning games are often digital-only, missing the tangible & social elements of board games. Many players prefer face-to-face interactions, negotiations, and discussions, which a board game can enhance.

Few Real-World Case Studies:

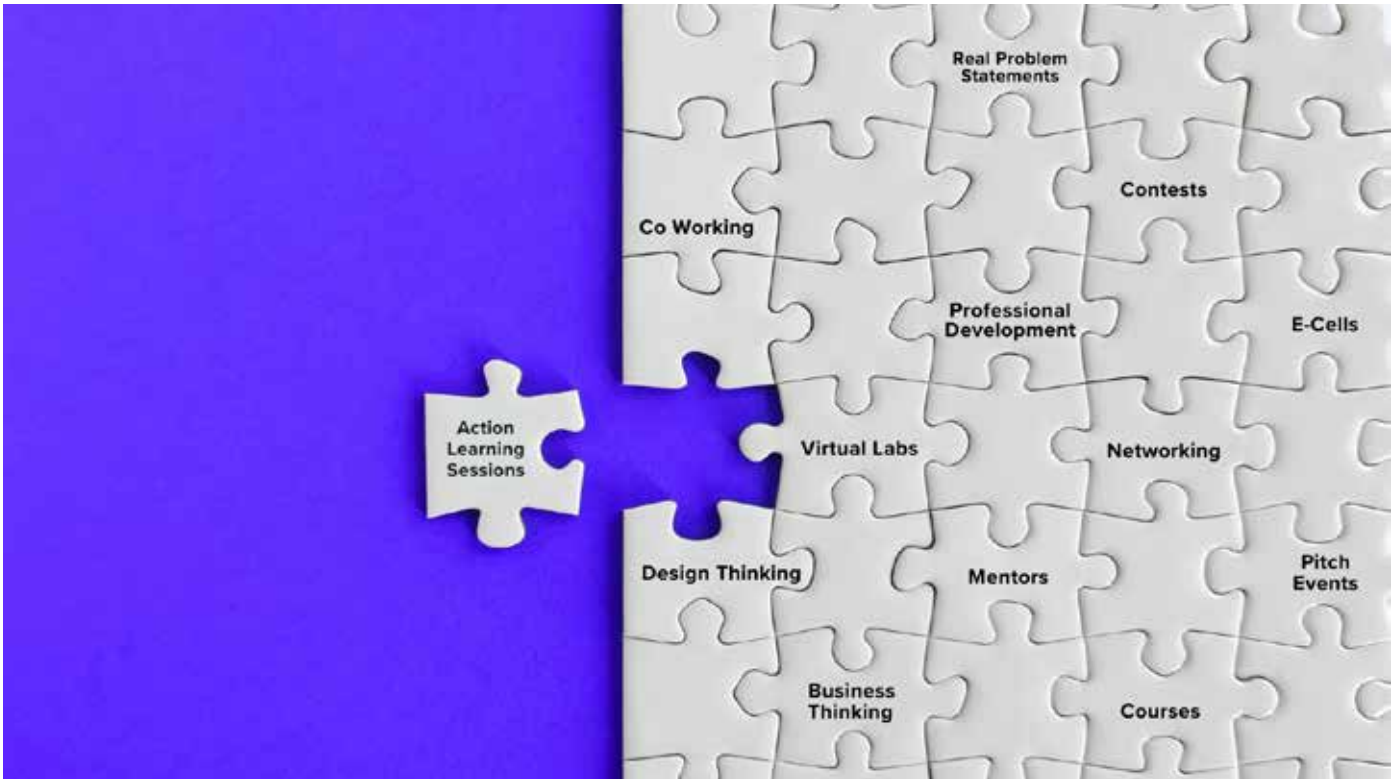
Real-World Case Studies: Many existing games lack real-world entrepreneurial challenges, pivots, and investor dynamics. Incorporating scenarios based on successful and failed start-tups can provide a more immersive and educational experience.

Lack of Modular Learning Paths:

Most games don't allow players to focus on specific aspects of entrepreneurship (e.g., fun-draising, marketing, scaling, product development). Investment Wars can introduce modular pathways, allowing players to specialize based on their interests.

Absence of Cross-Disciplinary Insights:

Most business games focus only on financial aspects, but real-world entrepreneurship involves technology, branding, leadership, team management, and innovation strategies.



Strategic Takeaways

Differentiate with Immersive Gameplay:
Position the game as the ultimate entrepreneurship simulation, offering real-world business challenges and investment strategies.

Target Multiple Markets
Students, professionals, incubators, and corporate trainers can all benefit from the game.

Develop a Digital Extension
Integrating an online version or mobile app can enhance engagement and reach a wider audience.

Community-Driven Growth
Encourage users to contribute business scenarios and engage in online tournaments to keep the game fresh.

Leverage Influencer Marketing
Partner with entrepreneurs, business coaches, and finance influencers to promote the game.

Secure Educational Partnerships
Work with business schools and startup accelerators to establish credibility and adoption.

Conclusion

Leverage EdTech & Gamification Trends:
Position "Investment Wars" as an experiential learning tool for entrepreneurship education.

Partnerships with Universities & Startup Incubators: Introduce the game in MBA programs, innovation labs, and high schools to teach business concepts interactively.

Hybrid Model (Board Game + Digital Extension):
Develop an online interactive version to expand accessibility and integrate AI-based performance tracking.

Target Corporate Leadership Training:
Sell as a business strategy tool for executives & professionals, integrating decision-making analytics.

Localization & Thematic Variants:
Develop industry-specific editions (e.g., FinTech, Healthcare, Tech Startups) with relevant market dynamics.

Community Engagement & Competitions:
Organize investment strategy tournaments, business simulations, and startup hackathons using the game.

Crowdsourced Expansion Packs:
Allow the community to submit business scenarios, startup challenges, and investment dilemmas, making the game dynamic and continually evolving.

Gamified Action Learning Experiences that solve real world challenges and build real world collaborative leadership skills

OVERVIEW

One of the defining elements of the Unbox hybrid game development process was the intentional use of data mapping to connect insights from research, ideation, and ongoing iterations. This approach ensured that every decision—from game mechanics to strategy tools—was grounded in user-centered understanding, real-world market context, and continuous testing.

DEFINE

Data mapping above research, Ideations and iteration

Creating collaborative Play Experience Design templates on Miro, focusing on business thinking concepts such as building business models by identifying Opportunities through market trends, industry forces, etc

Creating templates to identify competitors' core values and culture and align yourself with the market to determine a blue ocean strategy for your business models and also making assumptions and validating your assumptions through experiments.

Data mapping above research, Ideations and iteration

Unlike traditional education, entrepreneurial learning is hands-on, iterative, and highly adaptive. The global EdTech market is projected to exceed $400 billion by 2027, with gamification playing a significant role in modern education.

Gamified Action Learning Experiences that solve real world challenges and build real world collaborative leadership skills

Develop a gamified online version that integrates with virtual entrepreneurship bootcamps.

Develop an educator's guide and workshop module for seamless integration.

Develop an interactive content submission platform where users contribute real-world startup challenges.

Develop a customized version tailored for corporate leadership programs.

Integrate a monthly expansion pack model to keep gameplay fresh.

With strong market demand for entrepreneurship education, corporate strategy training, and interactive business simulations, Startup Journey - The game should be positioned for high growth.

By strategically expanding into EdTech, corporate training, digital hybrid models, and localized editions, this game has the potential to become a leading tool for experiential learning in business innovation.

Ideation 1- Card game

Objective

Players compete to build the most innovative and sustainable business model by strategically playing key business element cards while adapting to market challenges and customer needs.

Game Components

Business Element Cards (Core Deck - 50 Cards)

- Value Proposition Cards (Unique offerings, USP, problem-solving ideas)
- Customer Segment Cards (Target audience, demographics, niche markets)
- Revenue Model Cards (Subscription, freemium, direct sales, ads, commissions)
- Cost Structure Cards (Fixed vs variable costs, operational expenses, R&D)
- Key Resource Cards (Technology, human resources, capital, distribution)
- Key Activity Cards (Manufacturing, service delivery, partnerships, marketing)
- Channel Cards (Online, offline, retail, D2C, B2B, marketplace)
- Key Partnership Cards (Suppliers, influencers, investors, distributors)

Challenge Cards (20 Cards)

- Market Shifts (Tech boom, inflation, pandemic, competition surge)
- Customer Behavior Changes (Sustainability focus, premium demand, ethical concerns
- Investment Scenarios (VC funding, bootstrapping, crowdfunding, bank loans)

Innovation Bonus Cards (10 Cards)

- AI Integration, Sustainability Model, Subscription Model, Viral Marketing, Freemium Pivot
- Players can use these to gain an edge over competitors.

Gameplay

Players

2-5 people

Setup

- Each player gets 5 Business Element Cards at the start.
- 1 Challenge Card is drawn each round, affecting all players.
- Players take turns adding or modifying their business model by placing cards strategically
- Players can trade one card per round with others to optimize their strategy.

Rounds (5 Rounds)

- Round 1: Define your Value Proposition & Customer Segments
- Round 2: Select Revenue Model & Cost Structure
- Round 3: Choose Key Resources & Activities
- Round 4: Add Channels & Partnerships
- Round 5: Adapt to a final Challenge Card and pitch your business model.

Winning Criteria

At the end, each player pitches their startup using the built business model.

Judges (or players vote) based on:

- Innovation (Creative approach to a challenge)
- Market Fit (How well does it serve customer needs?)
- Scalability (Can this grow into a big business?)
- Profitability (Strong revenue streams & cost efficiency)
- Adaptability (How well did they respond to challenges?)T

The most viable and innovative business model wins!

Ideation 2- The Startup Board Game

Game Overview

Title
Entrepreneur Empire

Genre
Business Strategy

Players
2-6

Objective
Build the most valuable entrepreneurial empire by acquiring, managing, and growing startups in different industries through strategic investments, mergers, and market tactics.

Game Components

Game Board: Divided into sectors representing major industries:
Tech, Healthcare, Retail, Finance, Entertainment, Energy, AI & Robotics

Startup Cards Each
startup has a valuation, risk factor, and industry bonuses.

Investment Cards
Players can get funding rounds (Seed, Series A, Series B, IPO) or face investment challenges.

Founder Cards
Special abilities for players with unique entrepreneur traits.

Action Cards
Market events, economic shifts, competitor actions, government policies, and unexpected opportunities.

Money & Assets
Tokens for cash, intellectual property, patents, and team expansion.

Dice & Player Pieces
Roll dice to move around the board and make decisions.

Mergers & Acquisitions Tokens
Players can merge startups or buy out competitors.

Gameplay

Game Setup

- Each player starts with a set amount of capital.
- Players choose a Founder Card that provides a unique entrepreneurial advantage.
- Players roll dice to determine who starts.
- The board is set with startups available for purchase, and the economy tracker is initialized.

Turn Structure

- ERoll Dice & Move: Players roll dice and move to a property.
- Landing on a Startup: If unowned, the player can buy it or wait for an auction. If owned, the player may pay investment fees or negotiate partnerships.
- Investment Rounds: Players can raise funds, expand, or go public (IPO).
- Action Card Draw: Market events may positively or negatively impact investments.
- Mergers & Acquisitions: Players can buy out competitors or create industry monopolies.

Winning Conditions

- The game ends when a certain number of rounds are completed or when an economic shift occurs.
- The player with the highest net worth (assets + cash) wins.

Inspiration: Monopoly

Ideation 3- Startup Journey - The Entrepreneurial Challenge

Game Overview

Title
Startup Journey - The Entrepreneurial Challenge

Genre
Business Simulation, Strategy Board Game

Players
2-6

Objective
Navigate the startup lifecycle, from fresh graduate to successful entrepreneur, making strategic decisions in idea generation, funding, team-building, product development, and scaling while overcoming real-world business challenges.

Game Components

Game Board: Divided into key entrepreneurial stages:
- Tech, Idea Generation
- Market Research & Validation
- Business Model Development
- Funding & Investment
- Team Building & Leadership
- Product Development & MVP
- Market Launch & Growth
- Scaling & Expansion

Startup Idea Cards
Players are assigned or select a startup idea.

Challenge Cards
Real-world startup challenges (e.g., investor rejection, product failure, regulatory hurdles).

Opportunity Cards
Unexpected growth opportunities (e.g., viral marketing success, acquisition offer).

Funding Tokens
Represent venture capital, angel investment, grants, and bootstrapping

Team & Talent Cards
Different skills affecting startup performance.

Gameplay

Game Setup

- Each player/team starts as a fresh graduate with limited capital.
- Players choose or are assigned a Startup Idea Card.
- Each player starts with a basic team and an MVP blueprint.
- Players roll dice to determine the starting order.

Turn Structure

Each round follows these steps:

- Roll & Move: Players roll dice to advance across the entrepreneurial journey stages.
- Action Phase: Depending on where they land, players:
- Develop their business model.
- Secure funding from investors.
- Hire new team members.
- Overcome market & operational challenges.
- Adapt to industry changes & competition.
- Decision Point: Players choose whether to pivot, persevere, or exit.
- Financial Update: Players manage revenue, expenses, and runway.

Winning Conditions

- The game ends after 10 rounds or when a startup reaches a market valuation goal.
- Players pitch their final business.

The winner is decided based on:

- Innovation & Market Fit, Financial Performance, Team & Leadership Strength, Scalability & Long-Term Viability

OVERVIEW

Miro, a widely used online whiteboarding platform, provides a dynamic space for collaborative play experience design, allowing teams to brainstorm, iterate, and prototype ideas visually. By integrating business thinking concepts into interactive play experiences, entrepreneurs, students, and professionals can simulate real-world business challenges in an engaging way.

DEFINE

Data mapping above research, Ideations and iteration

Creating collaborative Play Experience Design templates on Miro, focusing on business thinking concepts such as building business models by identifying Opportunities through market trends, industry forces, etc

Creating templates to identify competitors' core values and culture and align yourself with the market to determine a blue ocean strategy for your business models and also making assumptions and validating your assumptions through experiments.

During the ideation refinement process, the BDL team identified strong synergies between Idea 1 and Idea 3. Recognizing their complementary potential, the two ideas were strategically combined to form a more holistic and impactful solution. This led to the conceptualization of a hybrid digital board game—a novel intervention designed to merge the engagement of physical gameplay with the scalability and interactivity of digital tools.

Creating collaborative Play Experience Design templates on Miro

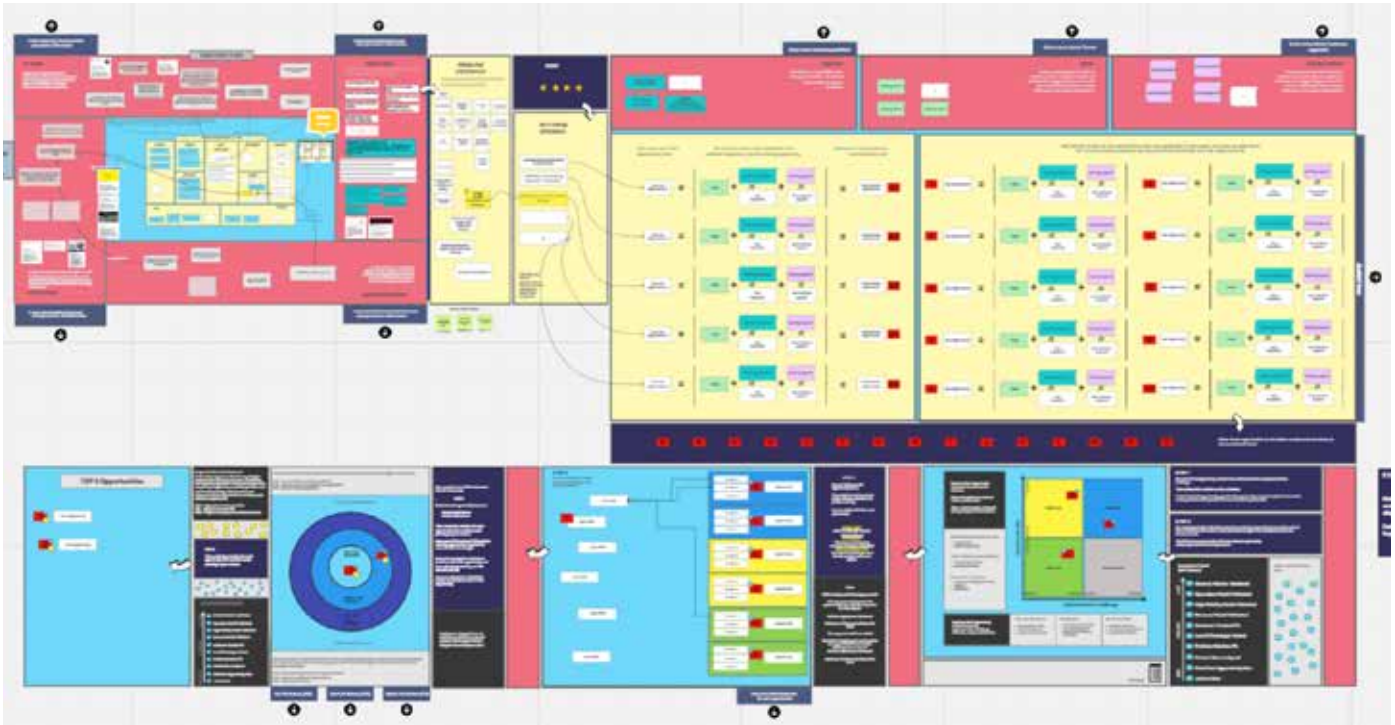
Key Features of Play Experience Design Templates on Miro

Interactive Business Model Building

- Templates are structured around the Business Model Canvas (BMC) framework.
- Participants drag & drop elements (customer segments, value propositions, revenue streams, etc.).
- Includes gamified prompts that challenge users to tweak business models under different scenarios (e.g., economic downturns, funding constraints, disruptive innovations).

Identifying Opportunities through Market Trends & Industry Forces

- Visual trend-mapping exercises using tools like PESTEL Analysis (Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Environmental, and Legal).
- Competitive Landscape Mapping – placing players in hypothetical markets to identify gaps and areas for disruption.
- SWOT-based market simulations – players analyze strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats based on real-world case studies.

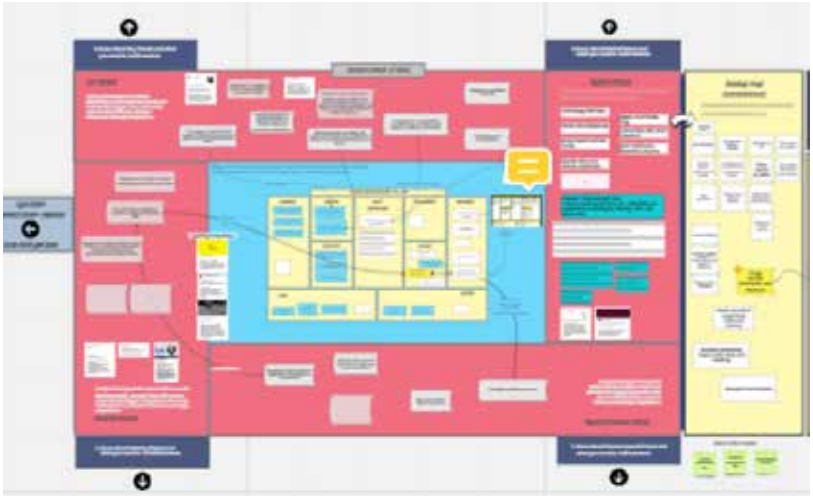


The ideation phase was structured around the Double Diamond process—a design thinking framework that helps teams navigate from ambiguity to clarity. The process consists of four phases: Discover, Define, Develop, and Deploy. In the 'Discover' phase, teams explored user needs, external trends, and business challenges. This led to the 'Define' phase, where insights were synthesized into clear problem statements. Using collaborative Miro templates designed for virtual teamwork, participants engaged in structured brainstorming, mapping, and clustering exercises. These tools helped teams converge on meaningful challenge areas and ensured alignment before moving into idea development and solution planning

Double-daimond process : Discover

Discover

By combining business context mapping, trend analysis, and creative thinking, session enables you to identify and prioritise opportunities for sustainable growth.

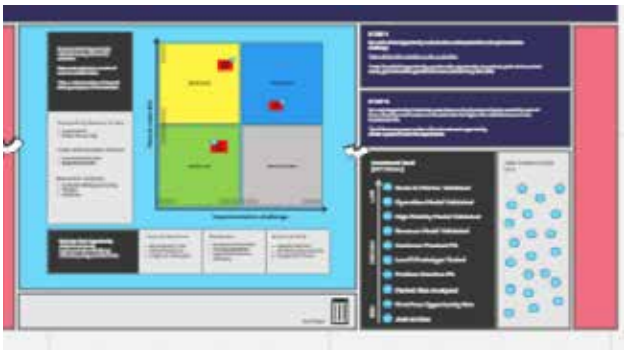


Step 1 - Business Context Mapping

Uncover the current state of your business environment. Examine internal and external factors influencing your business. Identify Industry forces, Macroeconomic forces, Market forces and key trends.

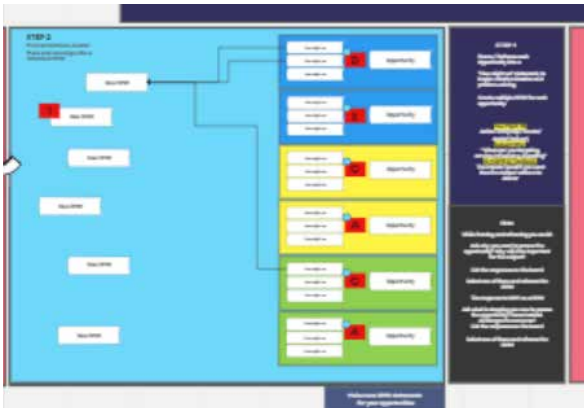
Step 2 - Sustaining Existing Business

Identify opportunities to strengthen your existing business.
Explore avenues for optimization and expansion."



Step 3 - Trend Analysis and Discovering New Opportunities

Analyze trends shaping the future business landscape.
Unearth new possibilities that align with emerging trends.



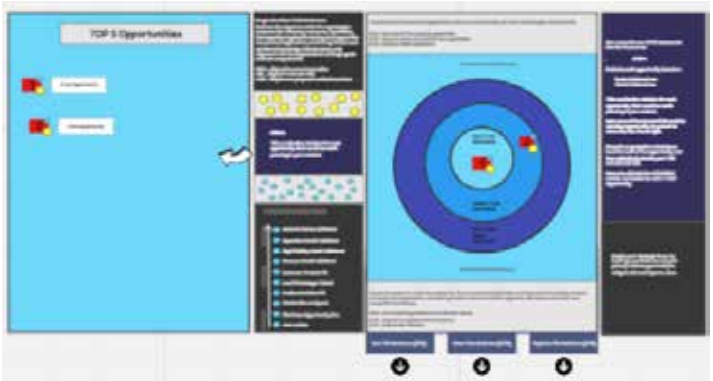
Step 4 - Framing and Prioritizing Opportunities

Frame identified opportunities within strategic frameworks.
Prioritize opportunities based on alignment, feasibility, and impact.

Outcome

An immersive session that aims to help your team uncover contextual opportunities that align with future trends.

By the end of this session, you'll have gained a comprehensive understanding of your business landscape.



OVERVIEW

Building a successful business model requires understanding the competitive landscape, differentiating from existing players, and identifying untapped market opportunities. Identify competitors' core values and culture to understand market positioning. Align their own business vision with market demands. Develop a Blue Ocean Strategy by uncovering unique, uncontested opportunities. Make data-driven assumptions and validate them through structured experiments.

DEFINE

Data mapping above research, Ideations and iteration

Creating collaborative Play Experience Design templates on Miro, focusing on business thinking concepts such as building business models by identifying Opportunities through market trends, industry forces, etc

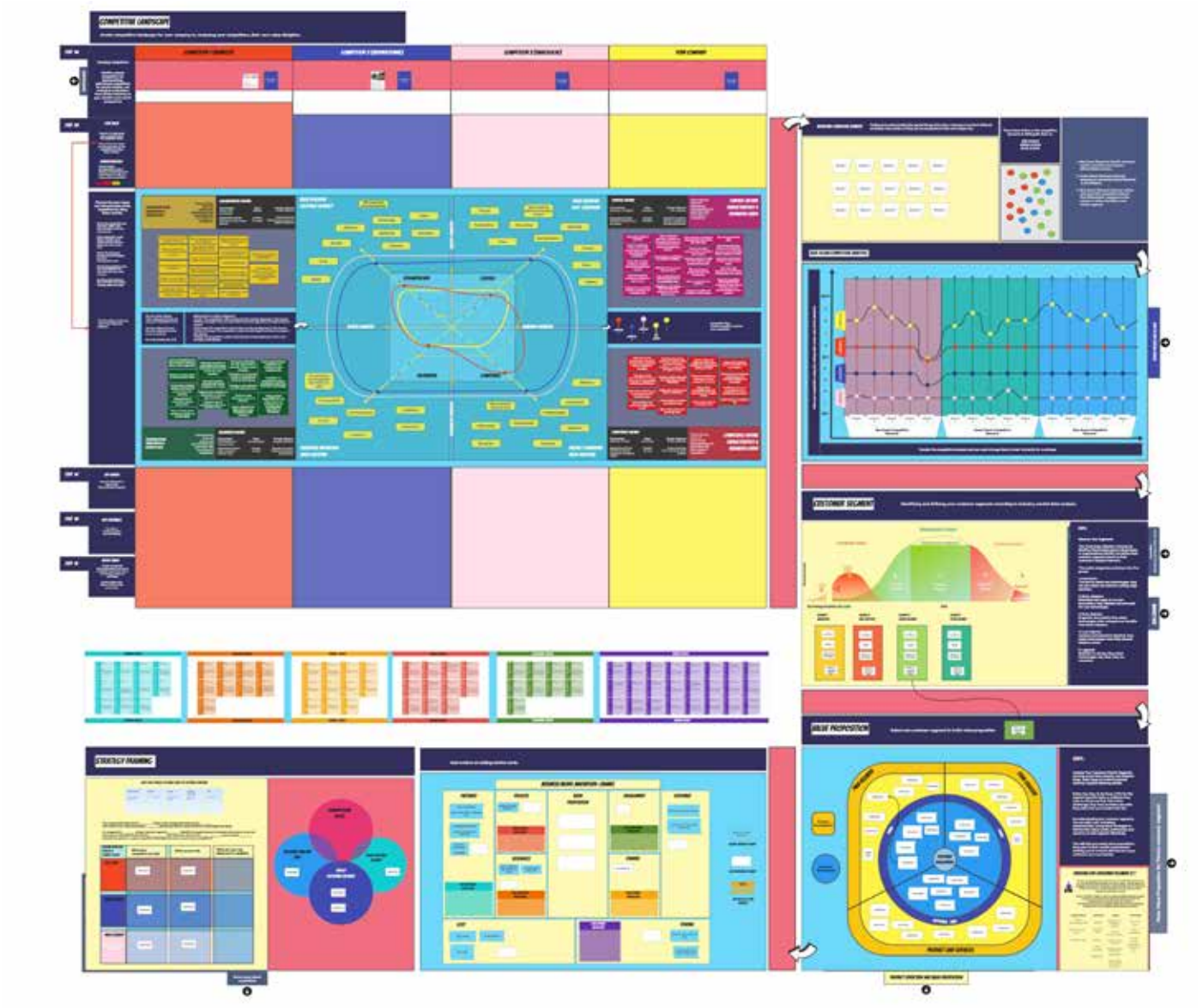
Creating templates to identify competitors' core values and culture and align yourself with the market to determine a blue ocean strategy for your business models and also making assumptions and validating your assumptions through experiments.

Creating templates to identify competitor's core values and culture

Key Elements of the Templates & Frameworks

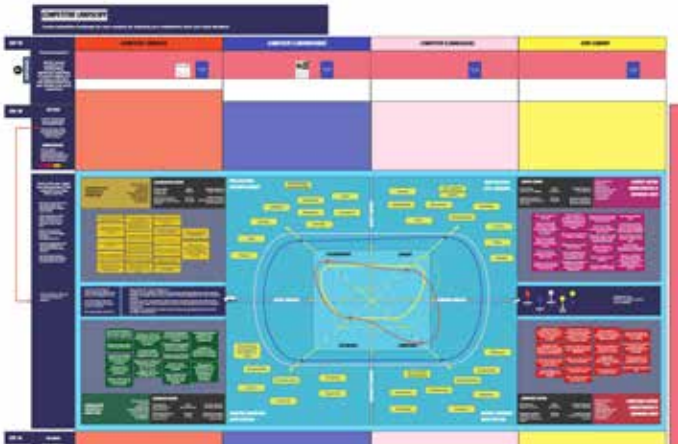
Competitor Core Values & Culture Mapping

- Understanding what competitors stand for and how they communicate their mission is crucial.
- Mission & Vision Statements: Analyzing competitors' brand positioning.
- Company Culture Audit: Studying their leadership style, employee reviews, and workplace culture (e.g., through Glassdoor, LinkedIn, or company reports).
- Brand Communication & Messaging: Identifying tone, language, and emotional appeal used in marketing.
- Customer Perception Analysis: Mapping customer sentiment through online reviews, surveys, and sentiment analysis tools.



Double-daimond process : Define

Define



Step 1 - Competitive Analysis

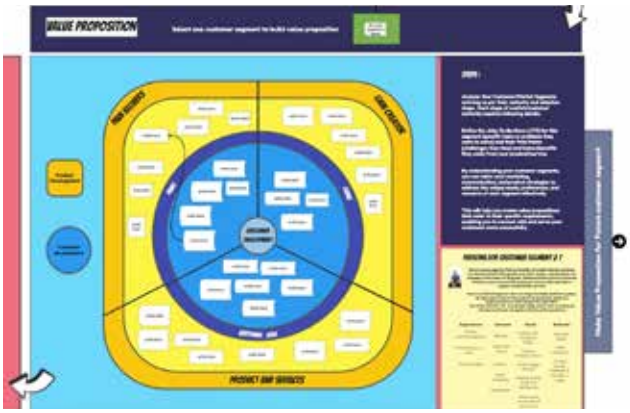
Unveil your competitors strengths and vulnerabilities. Turn insights into advantages through strategy and culture alignment analysis.

Step 2 - Blue Ocean Thinking

Navigate beyond familiar waters of competition. Discover uncharted territories of innovation and market creation.

Step 3 - Target Market + Customer Segmentation

Identify and understand your prime audience as well as future markets. Craft strategies tailored to your target market's needs.

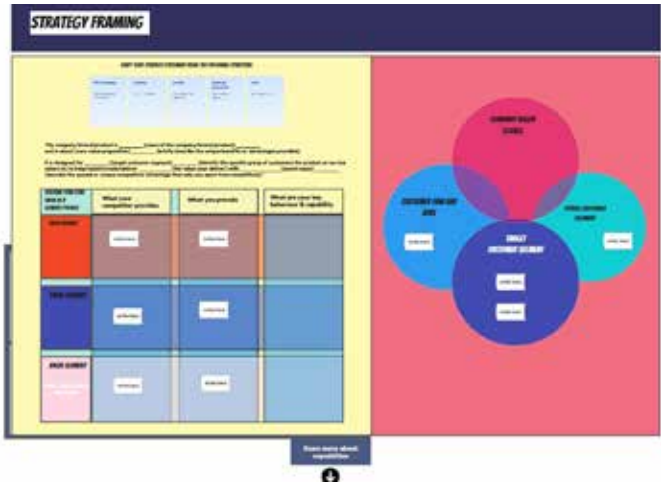


Step 4 - Strategy Framing

Weave your insights into a robust strategic framework and unleash your business's unique value proposition involves the systematic process of transforming data, market trends, customer needs, and internal strengths into a coherent, actionable strategy.

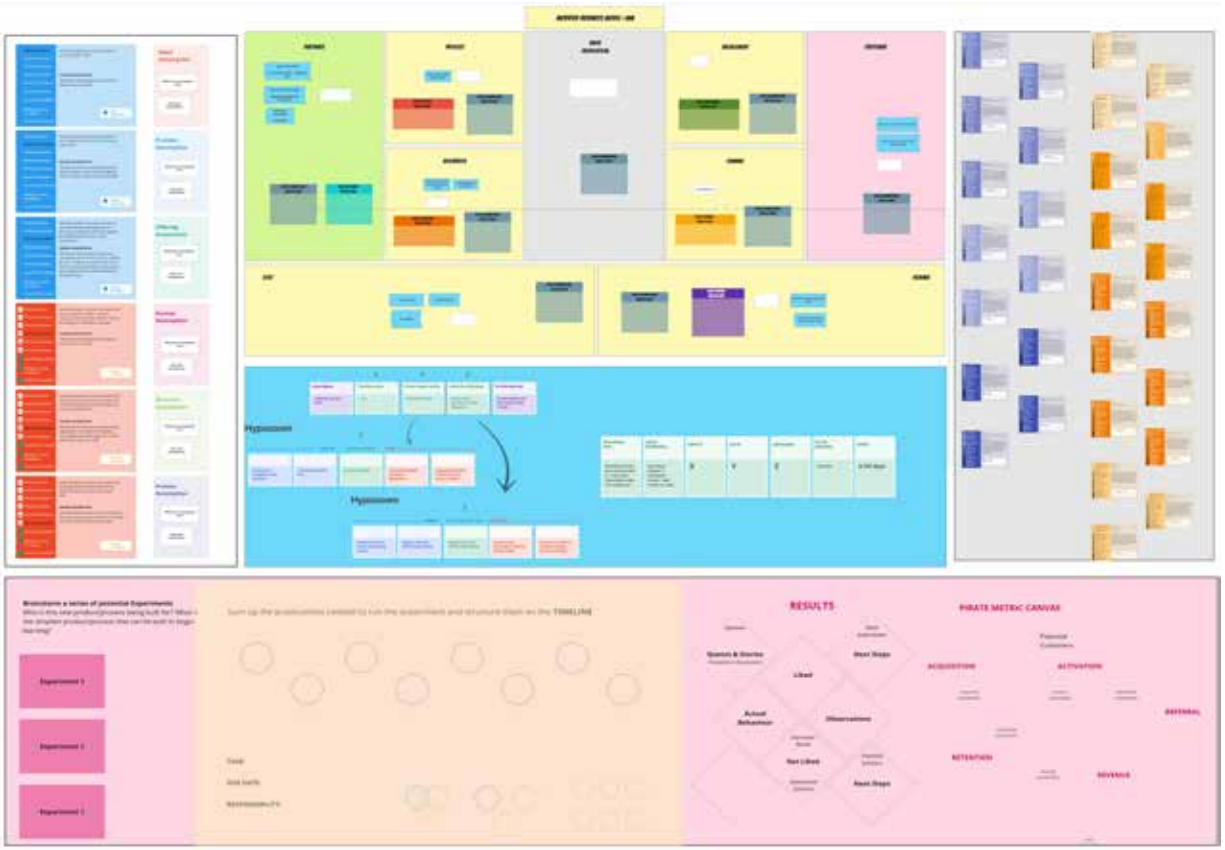
Outcome

By the end of this session, you will gain a deep understanding of the Blue Ocean Strategy Model and its practical applications, setting you on a path toward creating uncontested market space and driving innovation. You will be able to leverage BOS principles to break away from traditional competitive strategies, identifying opportunities for differentiation and value innovation that will enable you to stand out in a crowded marketplace



Double-daimond process : Develop and Deploy

Develop and Deploy



Develop and Deliver

Step 1 - Assumption Finder

Unearth the core assumptions underpinning your business concept. Frame the hypotheses to test in your experimental journey.

Step 2 - Business Pretotyping

Construct a low-cost, high-impact pretotype of your business offer. Swiftly validate concepts to minimize resource wastage.

Step 3 - Experiment Design

Craft experiments to validate or invalidate assumptions. Design testing methodologies that yield actionable insights.

Step 4 - Market Activation

Devise strategies to activate and engage your target audience. Test your business offer in the real-world market scenario.

Outcome

By the end of this session, you will gain clarity on which assumptions hold the key to your business's success

OVERVIEW

We began with early-stage ideation, exploring how to gamify complex business thinking in a format that would appeal to students, designers, managers, and entrepreneurs alike. This was followed by rounds of user research, including interviews, feedback sessions, and observational studies to better understand how users approach strategy, collaboration, and learning.

DESIGN AND IDEATE

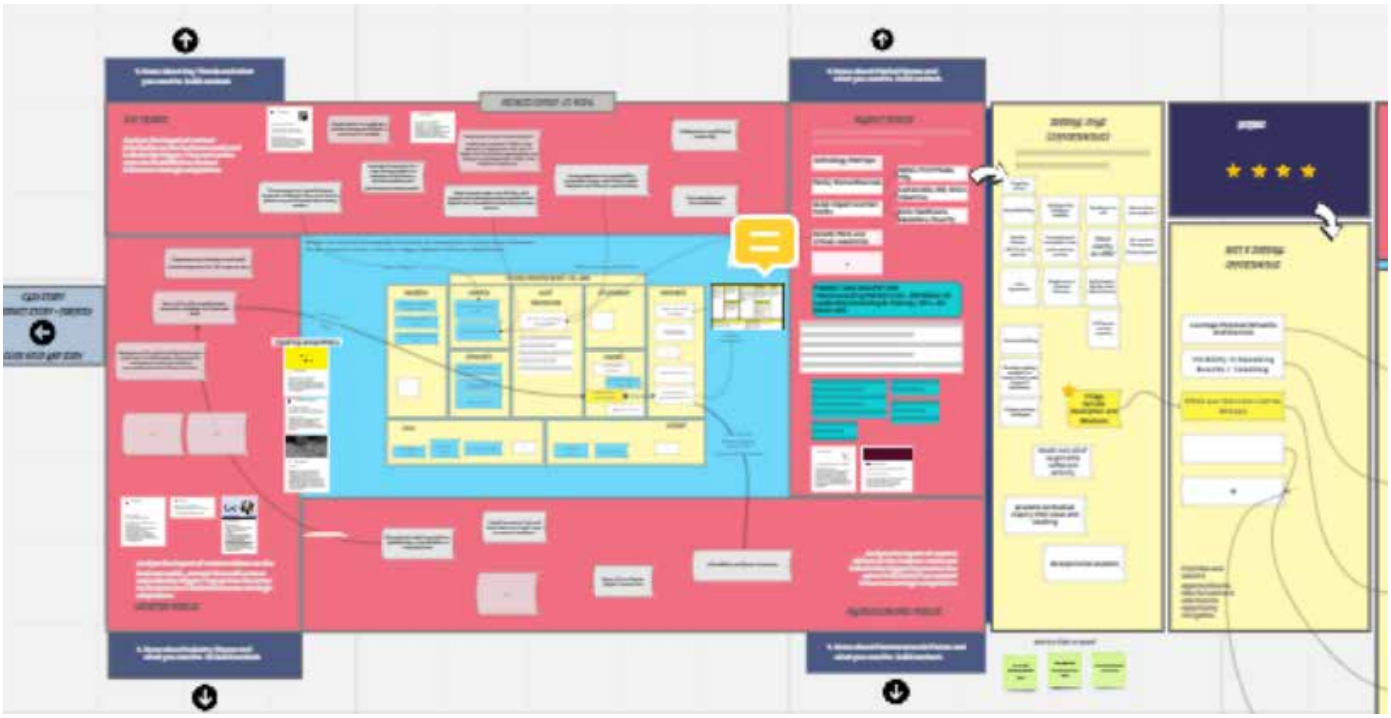
Engaged in ideation, design, user research, and user testing to ensure an immersive play experience.

Gamification of the actionable frameworks, Conceptualizing and developing a game aimed at fostering business thinking

Positioning the game as a comprehensive solution for addressing real-world challenges, emphasizing socially responsible strategies.

Creating game assets and finalizing game concepts

Prototype Testing with the Butter Community

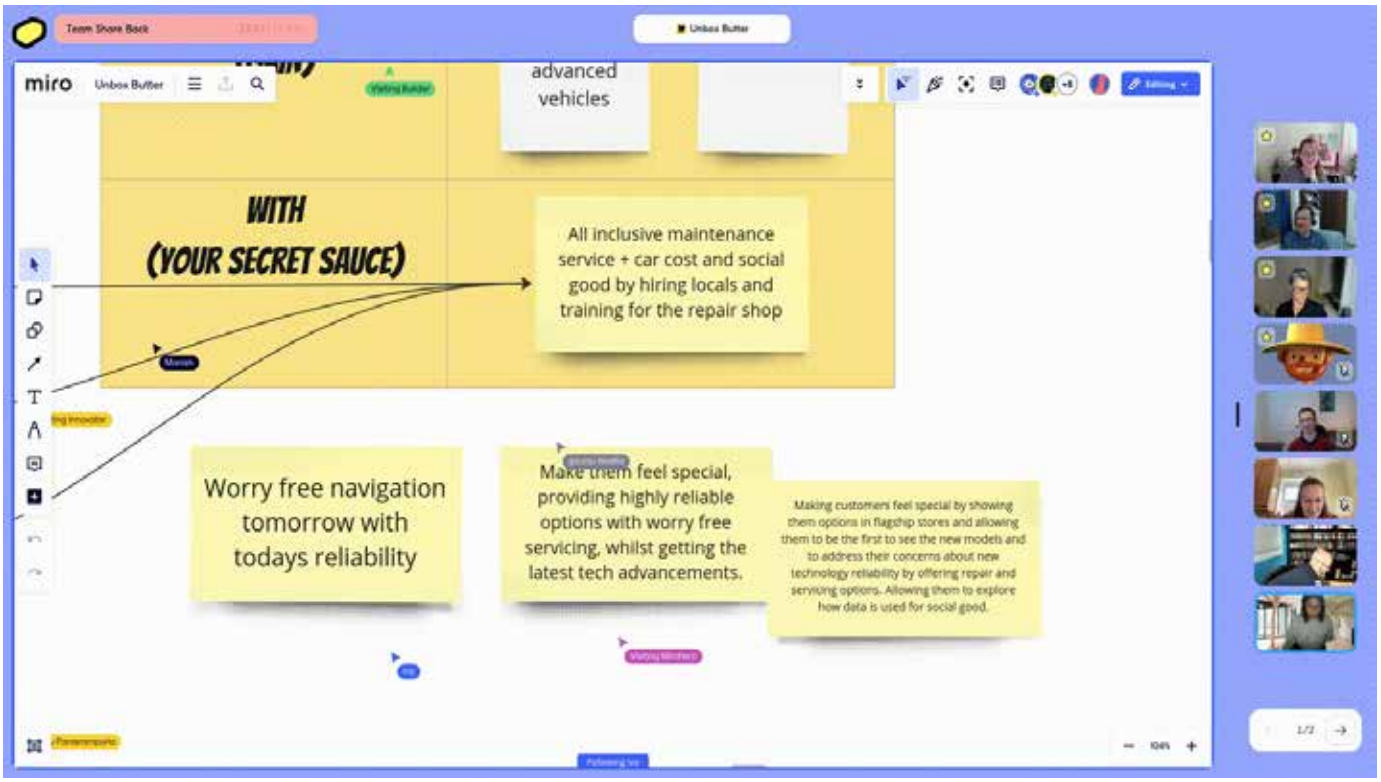


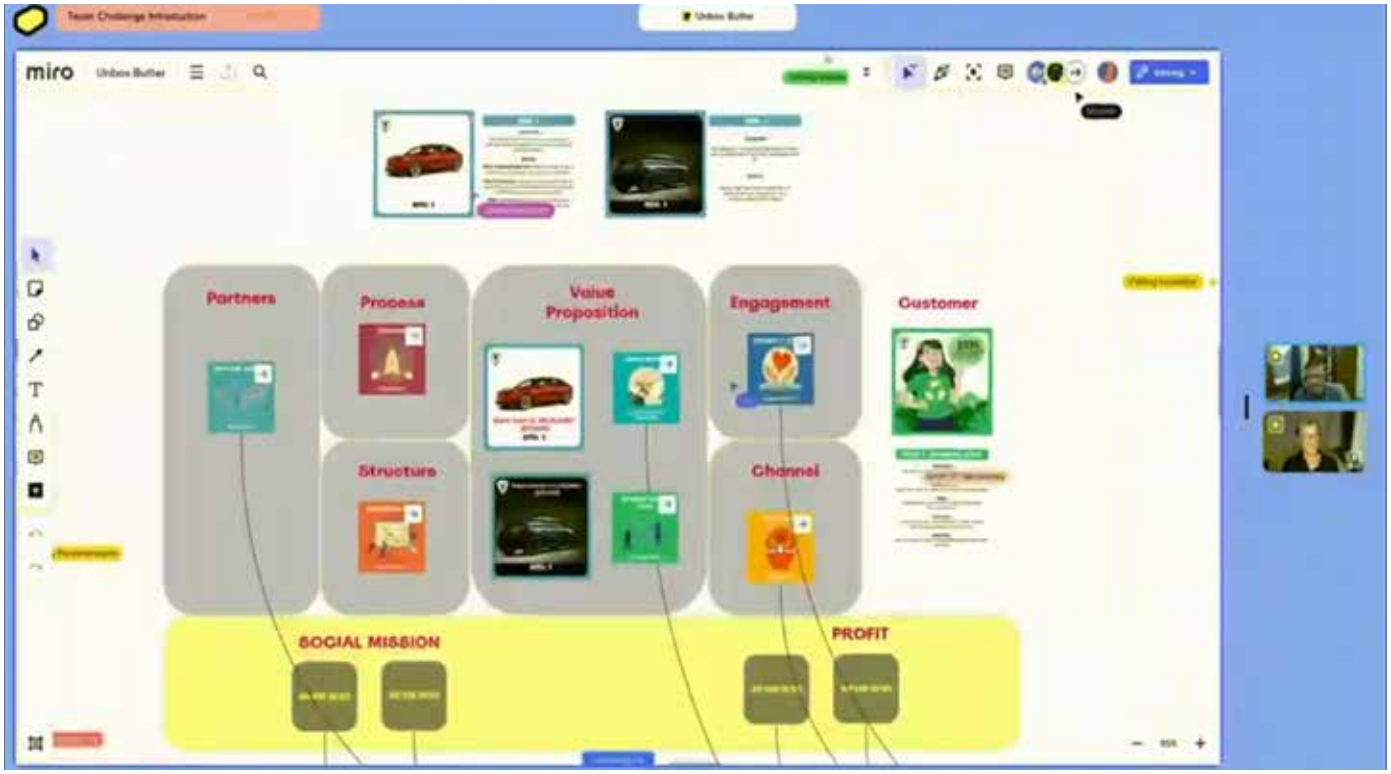
As part of our iterative development process, we collaborated with the Butter Community—a global network of facilitators, educators, and creative thinkers—to host an online event focused on testing the very first version of Unbox.

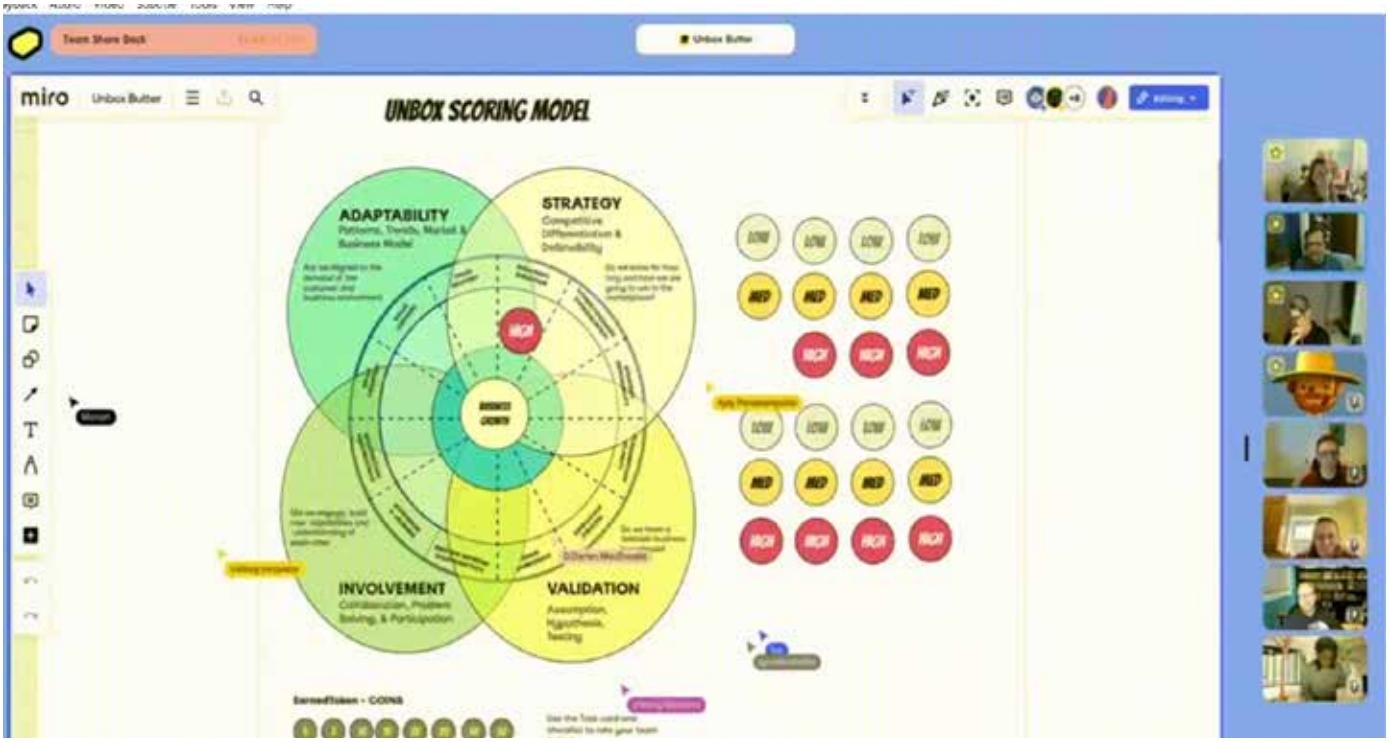
This session served as a live experiment to validate the core structure and experience of the Unbox board game using digital Miro templates. The goal was to test how well the gameflow, challenge framing, customer segmentation, and business modeling exercises translated into a remote collaboration setting.

We designed and deployed the first digital prototype of Unbox using Miro, mapping out the Double Diamond process—from problem discovery and definition to strategy development and experimentation planning. Participants were guided through each phase using structured templates, prompt cards, and interactive assets.

Online Unbox event in collaboration with butter community.







What We Learned:
Clarity of Flow: The Double Diamond model worked well in guiding participants through divergent and convergent phases of thinking.

Template Usability: Miro templates proved effective in enabling remote collaboration, though some improvements were needed in pacing and visual hierarchy.

Engagement & Feedback: Participants appreciated the gamified structure and visual scaffolding, offering suggestions to simplify certain tools and improve onboarding.

This session marked the first real-world test of Unbox in action and gave us critical feedback to evolve the experience. It also validated that Unbox could work as a fully hybrid tool, engaging both online and offline audiences through design-led business thinking.

OVERVIEW

Using these insights, we built and refined the game mechanics, cards, templates, and narrative flow—constantly testing them through live playtests and community events. Iterative cycles of design and prototyping helped us fine-tune the game's balance between structure and creativity, ensuring that each player feels empowered to think, explore, and co-create.

DESIGN AND IDEATE

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Creating game assets and finalizing game concepts

Refining the Onboarding Experience: Building Better Product Stories

One of the key insights we gained from our online playtest session with the Butter Community was the need for a stronger, more intentional onboarding experience for users. While the core mechanics of the Unbox experience—such as the tactic cards for business model creation and experiment cards for strategy testing—were well-received, we realized that participants needed more support in the early stages of the game, particularly around problem clarity and product narrative.

What We Discovered:

Many users jumped into the game without a clearly defined product idea or user problem. As a result, the strategies they created felt disconnected or abstract. Despite having powerful tools to build and test their business models, the foundation of their venture story was often unclear.

This insight led us to ask a simple but powerful question:

"What if we helped users articulate their product story before they even start designing the business model?"

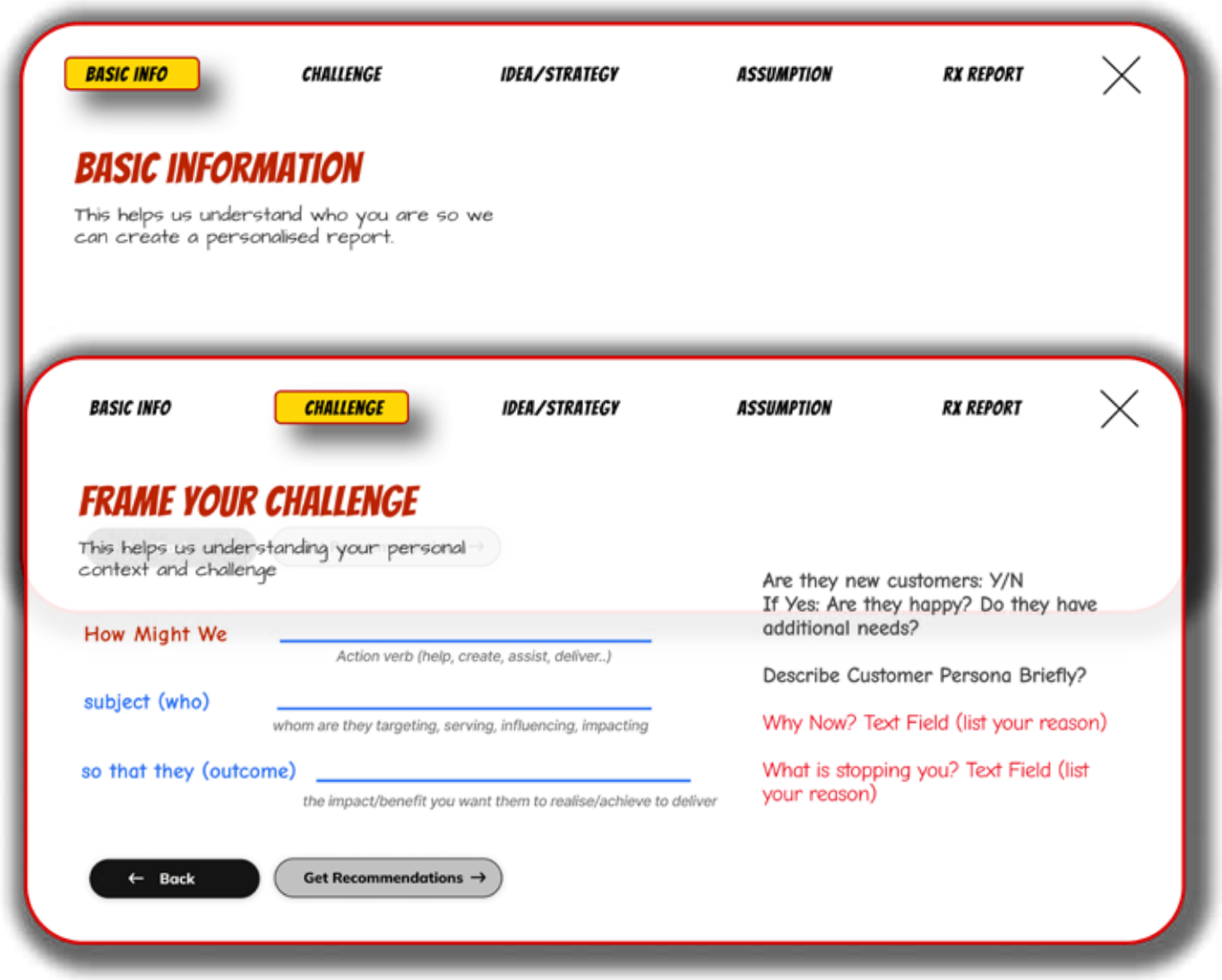
The Solution: A Guided Onboarding Form

We designed a structured onboarding process that would help players think deeply about their product, customer, and context before engaging with the tactical and strategic parts of the game.

Participants now begin their journey by filling out a form that prompts them to:

1. Define the core problem they are solving
2. Describe their target customer segment
3. Outline the product or solution idea
4. Articulate the value proposition
5. Reflect on their vision and purpose as a founder or team

This guided reflection acts as a pre-game immersion tool, helping players ground their thinking in real user needs. It becomes their venture story foundation—a strategic reference they revisit throughout the game.



Impact on Gameplay

Clearer Challenge Statements: Users were able to frame stronger "How Might We" questions with more confidence.
Better Use of Tactics: With a clearer story in place, participants selected tactic cards more intentionally, building coherent and relevant business models.
More Meaningful Experiments: Assumptions and hypotheses felt grounded in real user problems, making experimentation far more effective and insightful.

By integrating this onboarding process, we didn't just improve the user experience—we created a stronger foundation for innovation, where every card played and every strategy built is anchored in a purposeful, human-centered story.

Strategic Tools in Play: Tactic & Experiment Cards

As part of the Unbox gameplay system, we designed and introduced two core card-based tools that drive the transition from ideation to execution: Tactic Cards and Experiment Cards. These tools are central to helping participants build robust business models and test their strategies in real-world contexts.

The Tactic Cards were created to support players in designing all nine elements of their business model (based on the Business Model Canvas framework). With a deck of 98+ strategic moves drawn from real startup and corporate playbooks, these cards serve as modular building blocks for innovation.

In the real world, no strategy survives contact with the market unless it's tested. That's where the Experiment Cards come in.

These cards guide players through a structured process of hypothesis-driven learning. Players are prompted to:

Identify the critical assumptions behind their business strategy

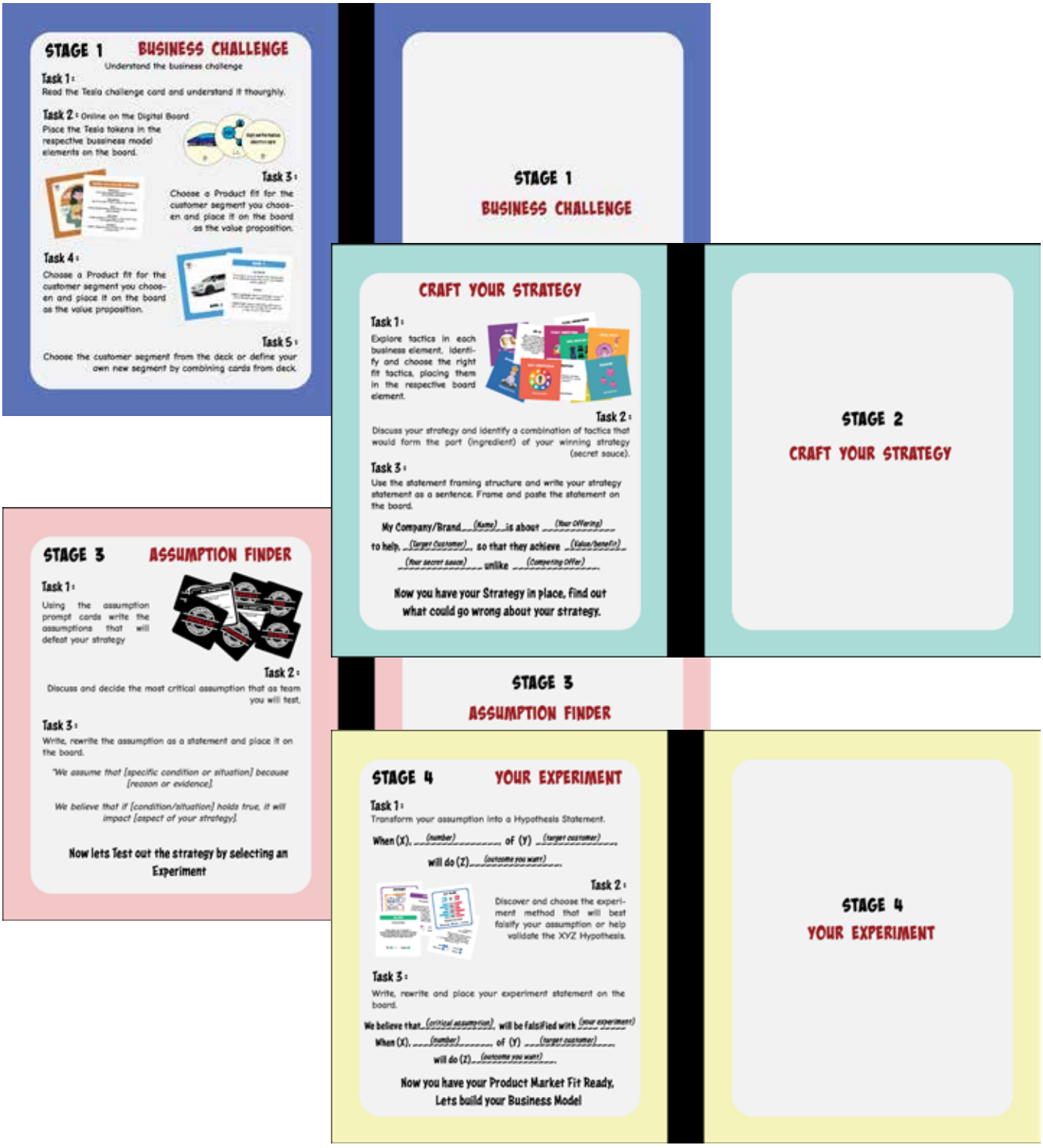
Frame testable hypotheses (e.g., "We believe that X customer will do Y because of Z.")

Design lightweight, real-world experiments to validate or falsify these hypotheses

Task Cards: Instruction cards

To ensure a structured, progressive learning experience, the Tactic Cards in the Unbox game were thoughtfully organized into four distinct categories, each corresponding to a key phase in the business model design and strategy-building process.

This division not only made the game easier to follow but also allowed players to build their strategies step-by-step, layering complexity as they moved through the experience.



OVERVIEW

Unbox is positioned as a comprehensive solution for addressing real-world challenges through the lens of strategic thinking, collaboration, and socially responsible innovation. Unlike traditional business games or abstract simulations, Unbox is grounded in design thinking and systems thinking principles, guiding users from problem discovery to strategy execution with a strong emphasis on purpose-driven innovation.

DESIGN AND IDEATE

Engaged in ideation, design, user research, and user testing to ensure an immersive play experience.

Gamification of the actionable frameworks, Conceptualizing and developing a game aimed at fostering business thinking

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Comprehensive solution for addressing real-world challenges, emphasizing socially responsible strategies.

Generic Product & Customer Persona Decks

As the Unbox experience evolved, we recognized the need to help participants engage more meaningfully with real-world business challenges, especially in cases where they didn't bring their own startup idea or product concept.

Generic Product Deck

A set of pre-designed product profiles representing well-known or archetypal innovations across industries. These cards are crafted with essential business context, offering a ready-made platform for players to build strategy around.

Purpose: Help players focus on strategy and innovation rather than getting stuck in idea generation.

Application: Ideal for learning environments, bootcamps, and quick simulations where time or familiarity may be limited.

Customer Persona Deck

Complementing the product deck, the customer persona cards offer relatable, detailed profiles based on demographics, psychographics, motivations, pain points, and behavioral patterns.

Purpose: Help teams deeply understand "who" they're designing for, encouraging empathy and sharper value propositions.

Use Cases: Great for teams learning customer segmentation, market-fit exploration, or testing product-market resonance.

Scenario-Based Strategy Decks: Bringing Big Brands into the Game

To make the experience even more relatable and challenge players with real-world complexity, we introduced Scenario-Based Strategy Decks, where players could step into the shoes of actual brands and strategize their moves for new markets.

Tesla Launch Strategy (India Edition)

Objective: Players are challenged to design Tesla's India entry strategy, navigating through customer affordability, infrastructure gaps, and brand perception.

Deck Includes:

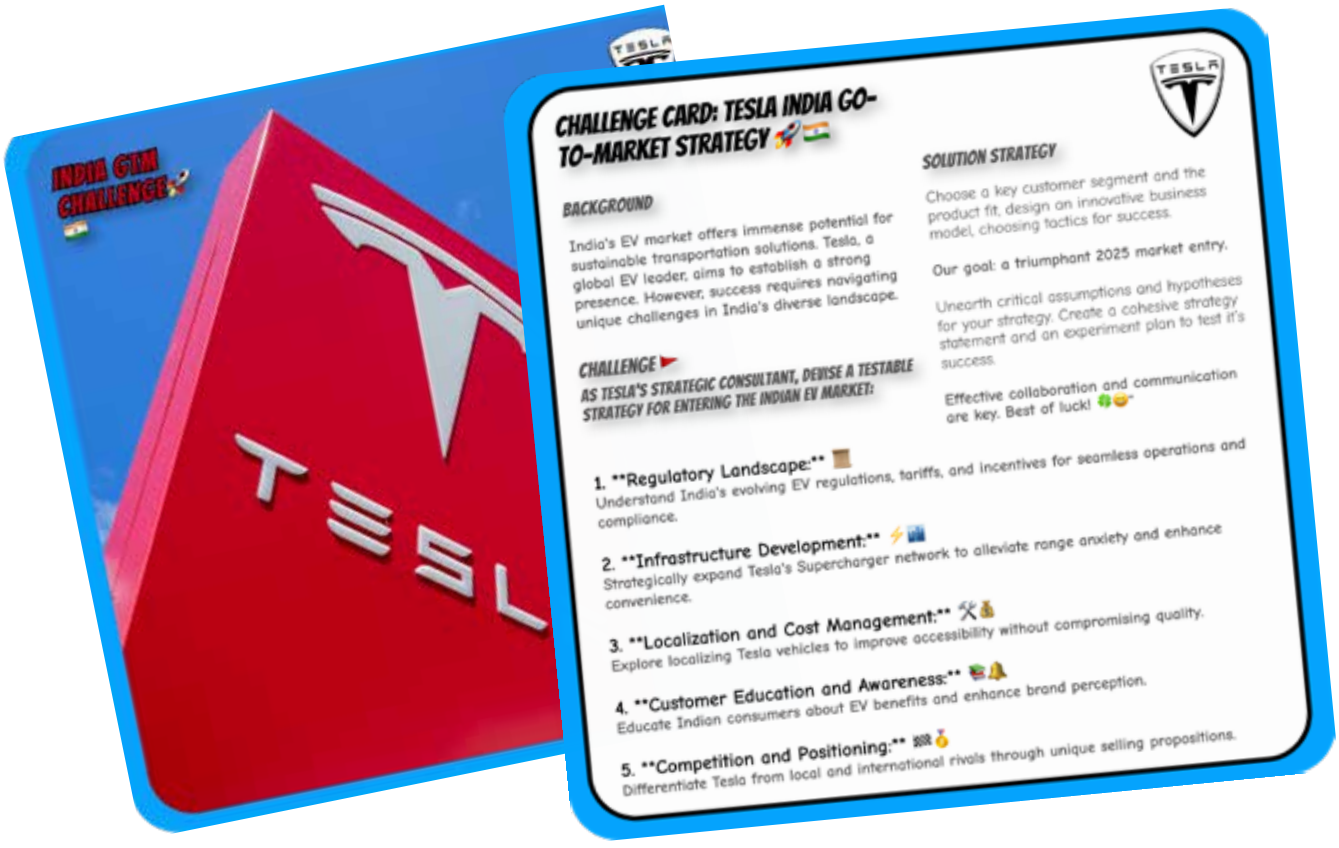
Indian EV consumer personas (urban elite, price-sensitive commuter, environmentalist, etc.)

Infrastructure & policy cards (charging networks, subsidies, urban congestion zones)

Competitive landscape (local players like Tata EV, Ather)

Tactic modifiers tailored for premium electric vehicle market

This deck encourages players to blend global brand strategy with local market adaptation, simulating real-world localization challenges.



Airbnb Growth Strategy – India Urban & Rural Contexts
Objective: Develop growth and trust strategies for Airbnb in diverse Indian settings, from metro city travelers to heritage village stays.

Deck Includes:

Host and traveler personas (budget solo travelers, family vacationers, rural hosts)

Trust-building and community tactics

Regulatory constraints and social stigma modifiers

Local partnerships and cultural immersion strategies

This setup helps players explore platform trust dynamics, community design, and cultural customization—critical aspects of scaling a peer-to-peer business in India.

OVERVIEW

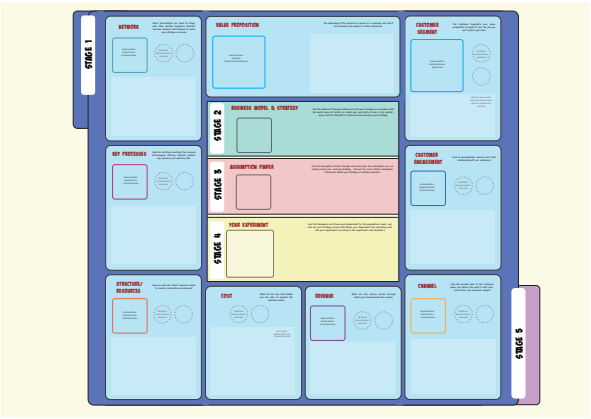
Each prototype cycle allowed us to gather critical user feedback, identify friction points, and make targeted improvements—resulting in a more refined, cohesive, and high-impact learning experience. From low-fidelity paper sketches to full-scale online simulations, prototyping was central to validating learning outcomes and ensuring real-world relevance.

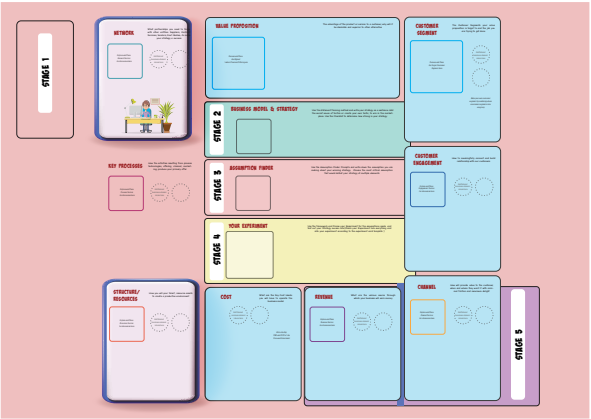
PROTOTYPE AND PLAYTEST

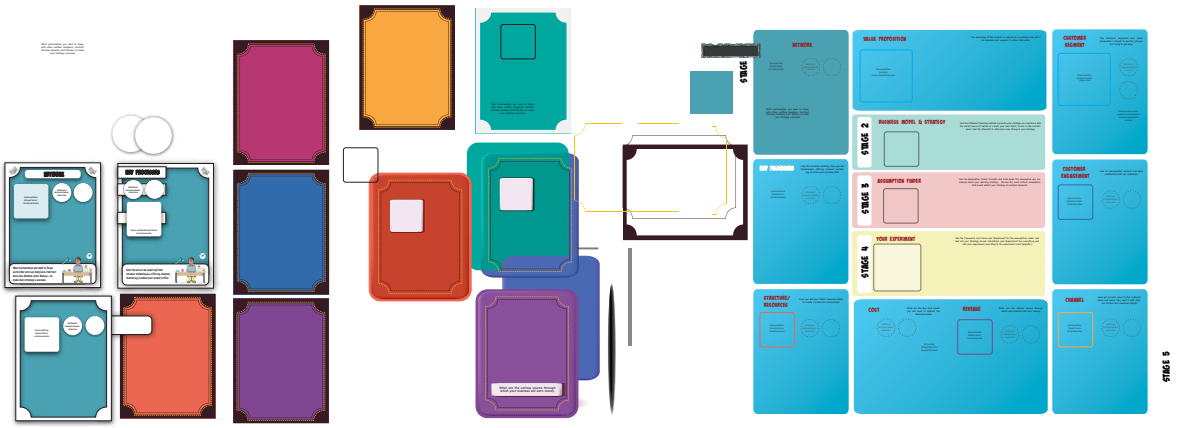
Building prototypes for testing engagement, collaboration, mechanics, understanding of the concepts, and interaction.

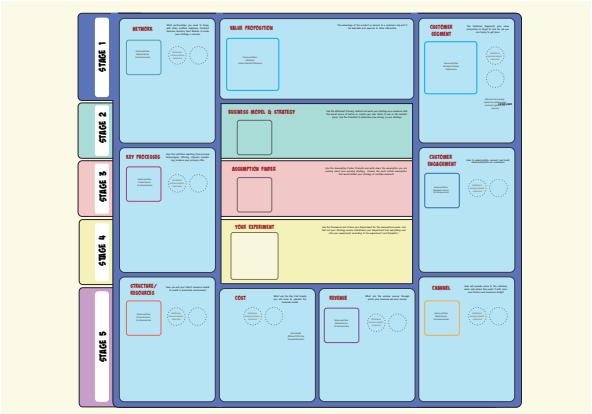
Playtesting & Refi ning the solution based on play-test(Event) feedback.

Game Board design









The Unbox Game Board was thoughtfully designed to serve as the central anchor of the hybrid gameplay experience—bringing together structure, clarity, and engagement in one unified space. Its design balances visual simplicity with strategic depth, enabling players to navigate complex business-building processes in a clear, intuitive, and immersive way.

Design Philosphy

The board was created with two core principles in mind:

Flow-Based Navigation:

The layout mirrors the journey of an entrepreneur or strategist—from identifying a problem to developing, testing, and validating a solution. This aligns with the Double Diamond framework, allowing players to move from divergent exploration to convergent strategy building.

Modularity & Flexibility:

Each section of the board is modular, enabling it to adapt to different session lengths, group sizes, or themes (e.g., startup simulation, social innovation, corporate strategy).

Key sections of the Game board

Challenge Zone

Where players define and refine their "How Might We" (HMW) statement based on user problems, customer personas, and opportunity insights.

Customer & Product Zone

Helps players map user journeys, define their target audience, and craft a value proposition using guided cards and prompts.

Tactic Selection Zone

A structured space for selecting cards across the nine business model elements (based on the Business Model Canvas). This area allows players to visually build out their business strategy.

Experimentation Zone

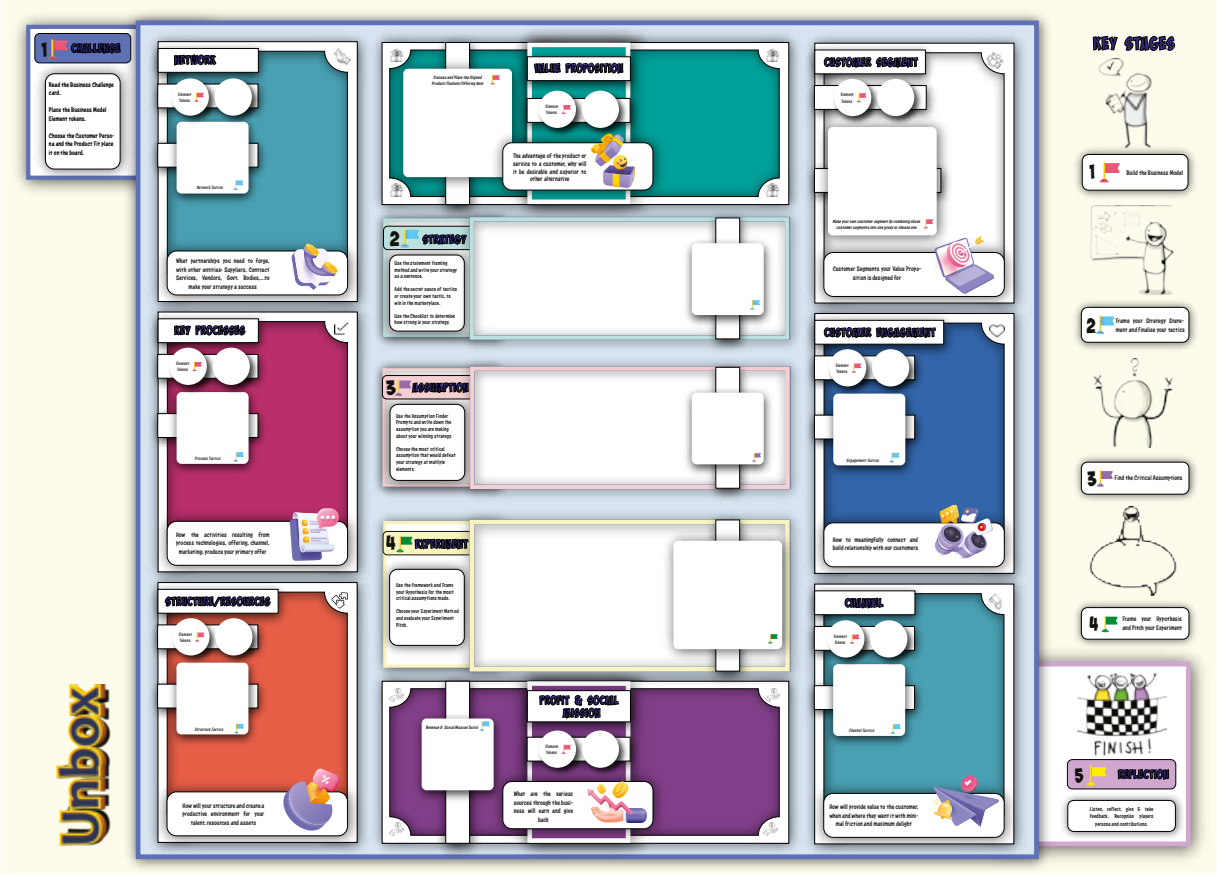
Where teams define assumptions, build hypotheses, and plan validation tests using experiment cards. This section encourages risk-awareness and evidence-based thinking.

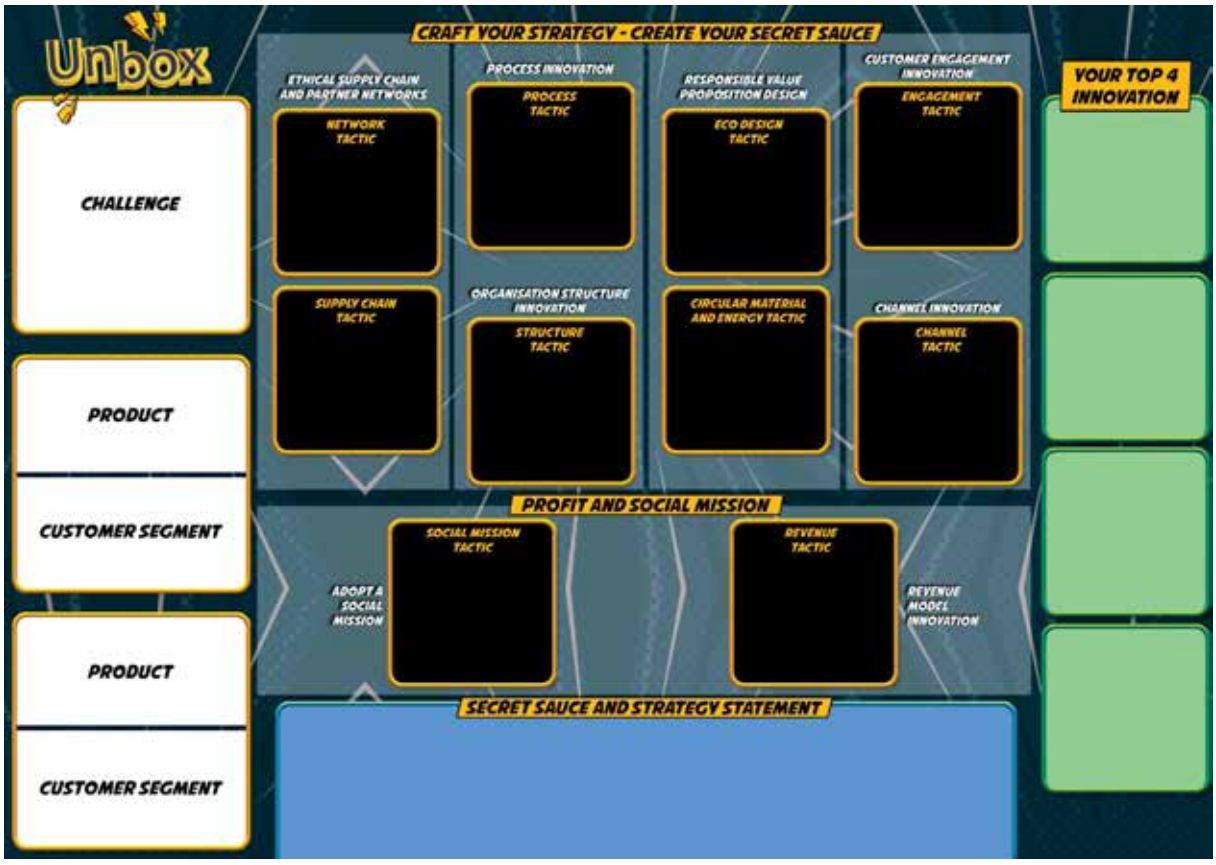
Scoring & Feedback Zone

Used during peer review and the "Wisdom of the Crowd" evaluation. Players reflect on strategy alignment, feasibility, and innovation.

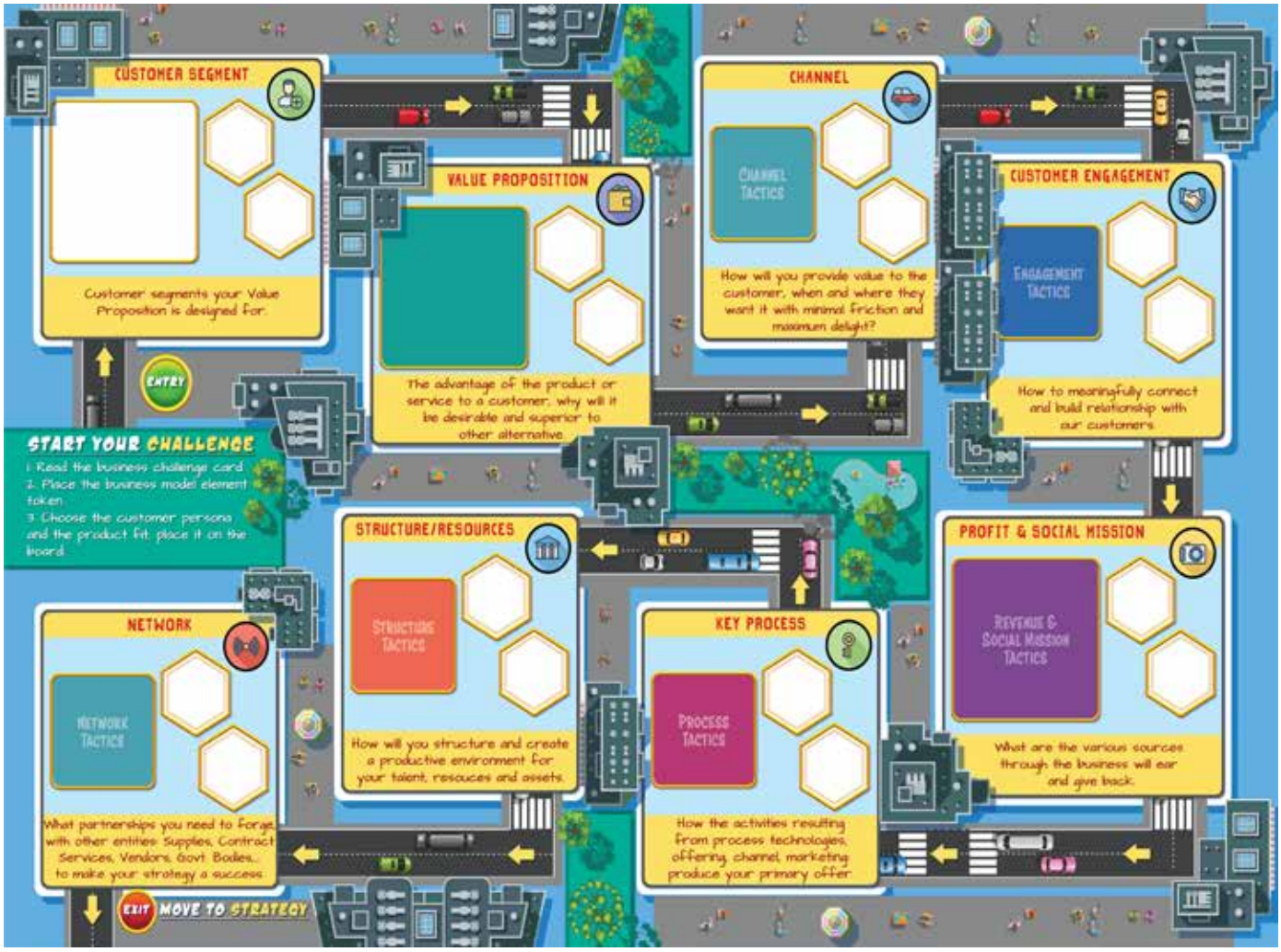
Color-coded paths and zones to guide player attention and support game progression. Iconography and symbols to help players quickly identify card types, game stages, and instructions. Space for card placement, team notes, and score tracking to facilitate collaborative interaction. Designed for both physical and digital play—with the board also available in Miro for remote sessions.

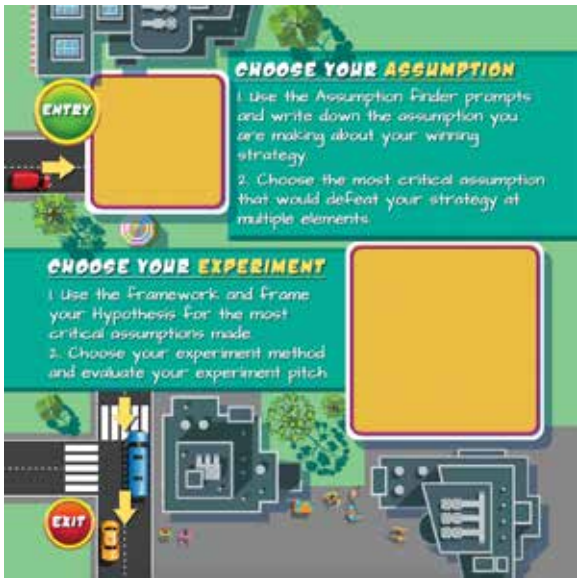
Game Board Iterations

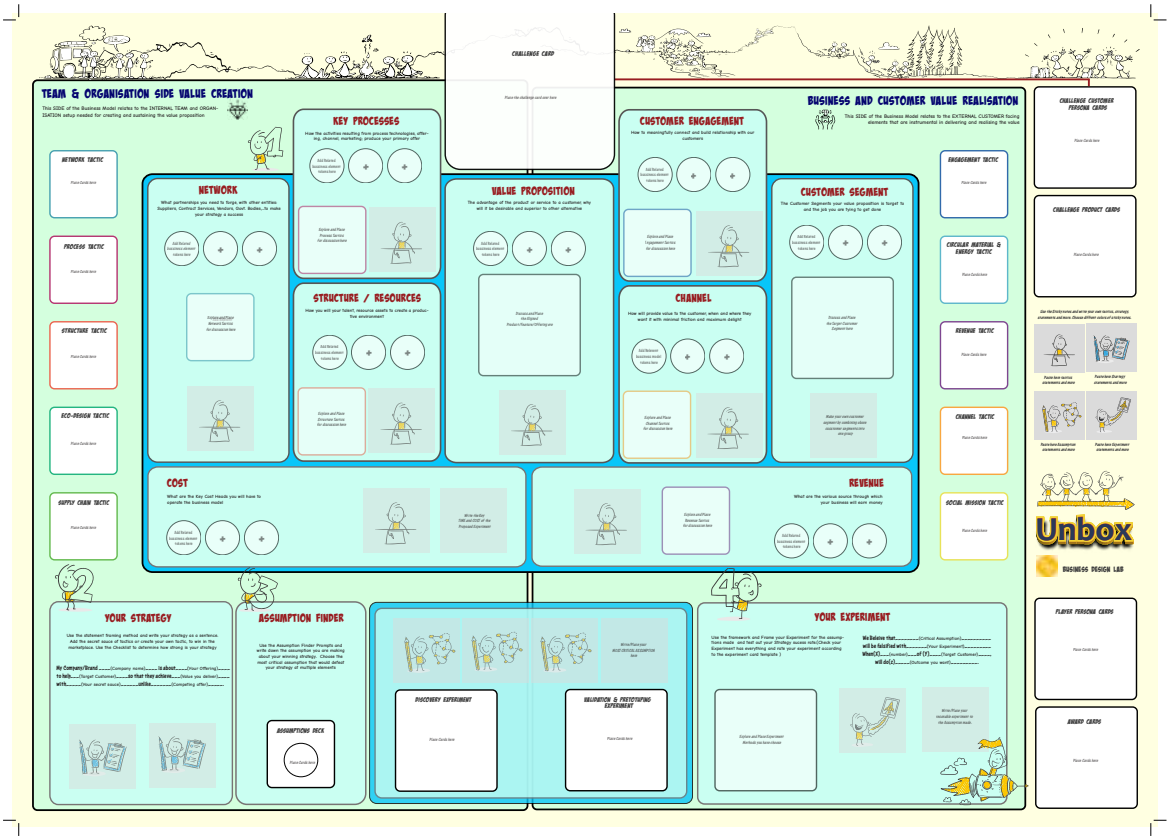




Game Board Iterations







Instruction booklet

OVERVIEW

As a key milestone in the development of the Unbox hybrid board game, a full-scale in-person playtest was conducted at MIT Pune with a diverse mix of students from business, design, and engineering disciplines. This session provided the first opportunity to validate the fully integrated gameplay experience, including the final game board, tactic and experiment cards, and the structured flow of the game.

PROTOTYPE AND PLAYTEST

Building prototypes for testing engagement, collaboration, mechanics, understanding of the concepts, and interaction.

Playtesting & Refining the solution based on play-test(Event) feedback.

Playtesting & Refining the solution based on play-test(Event) feedback.

Live Playtest Event with MIT Pune

To validate the final version of the Unbox board game, we conducted an in-person playtest event at MIT Pune, involving a diverse group of students from business, design, and engineering backgrounds.

This marked a critical milestone in the development journey, as it allowed us to test the complete, integrated experience—including the final game board, tactic cards, experiment cards, and overall flow of gameplay.

Objectives of the Playtest

- Validate clarity and usability of all physical game assets
- Test the engagement level and comprehension across multiple team types
- Observe real-time collaboration, interaction, and ideation
- Gather structured feedback for final refinements

Setup and Structure

- The playtest included 3–4 teams, each made up of 4–6 students.
- Each team was assigned a real-world business challenge—either Tesla's market entry strategy in India or Airbnb's growth in urban and rural markets.
- Participants were guided through the complete Unbox journey:
- Understanding the problem
- Defining customer and product
- Selecting tactics for business model creation
- Building hypotheses
- Planning experiments

Key Observations

- Engagement: Students remained highly engaged throughout, with minimal facilitation needed once the game began.
- Collaboration: Teams naturally adopted collaborative roles—some leading facilitation, others deep-diving into problem-solving or research.
- Card Usability: The final versions of tactic and experiment cards were well-received, though a few terms were flagged for simplification.
- Strategy Thinking: Players were able to make strong strategic connections, especially between customer needs and selected business model tactics.
- Time Feedback: Some teams requested more time during the experimentation and hypothesis phase, suggesting that section had depth worth expanding in future versions.

Refinements Post Playtest

- Minor text edits and clarifications were made to select cards.
- We redesigned a quick onboarding cue card to help teams jump into gameplay faster.
- Added visual symbols on the board and cards to assist with easier identification of gameplay phases. Slight adjustments were made to the time structure and facilitator flow for future sessions.

OVERVIEW

With multiple rounds of research, ideation, playtesting, and refinement completed—including a full-scale live test at MIT Pune—the Unbox hybrid board game was ready to move into its final phase: implementation, production, and deployment.

This stage focused on transforming the functional prototype into a professionally designed, production-ready game, complete with visual identity, cohesive systems, and scalable packaging for wider distribution.

IMPLEMENT & DEVELOP

Develop and deploy the fi nal build with Art assets, Handling pre/post-production of the whole game.

Final Development and Deployment: From Prototype to Polished Product

Final Game Development & Art Asset Integration

The final build of Unbox involved developing all physical and digital assets with high-quality, user-centered design. This included:

Game Board Layout: Finalized the modular layout for both physical and digital use, ensuring clear flow across the four gameplay phases—Problem Framing, Strategy Building, Business Modeling, and Experimentation.

Card Design: Refined and polished the visual language for the Tactic Cards, Experiment Cards, Prompt Cards, and Scenario Decks (e.g., Tesla India and Airbnb Growth). Each card was color-coded, icon-tagged, and hierarchy-structured for quick comprehension and smooth gameplay.

Onboarding Material: Designed user onboarding sheets, quick-start guides, and facilitator instructions to make the setup and execution seamless, even for first-time players.

Digital Templates (Miro): The online counterpart of the game was finalized with linked Miro boards, allowing the same immersive experience to be facilitated in virtual settings.

Handling Pre-Production and Post-Production

To ensure a smooth rollout, the team handled both pre-production planning and post-production organization, including:

Pre-Production:

Designing production-ready files and preparing print specifications for all components.

Prototyping materials and validating print proofs for usability, durability, and visual impact.

Finalizing packaging elements: game box design, card holders, instructional material inserts, etc.

Post-Production:

Conducting internal quality checks of printed components.

Creating a facilitator training kit to support onboarding in academic or corporate environments.

Documenting gameplay mechanics, rule structures, and variation modes in a clear and visually consistent format.

FINAL BOX

Open box

Close box

The Master Unbox Kit – Main Game Box

The main game box is the complete experience kit, containing everything needed to run a full session of Unbox—whether in a classroom, workshop, or startup bootcamp setting. It includes:

Core Components:

The Game Board – Foldable, modular layout covering all phases: Challenge, Strategy, Business Model, Experimentation, Scoring
98 Tactic Cards (from Strategy Box)
39 Experiment Cards (from Experiment Box)

Game Utilities:

Task Cards – To structure the session and guide progression
Trend Cards – To inject external provocations and signals into challenge framing
Generic Customer & Product Cards – For participants who don't bring their own ideas
Timer – To manage rounds and enhance energy
Sticky Notes & Pens – For rapid ideation and mapping
Voting Stickers – For prioritization activities and group alignment
Instruction Booklet – Complete facilitator manual, how-to-play guide, gameflow diagrams
Scoring Sheets – For wisdom-of-the-crowd feedback, facilitator input, and self-assessment

Ideal for: Full facilitation sessions, institutional delivery, train-the-trainer kits.

Box Design iterations

ALL COMPONENTS

This box serves as the core delivery toolkit that combines strategic thinking, collaboration, creativity, and real-world simulation into one immersive package. It ensures that every participant—regardless of background—has the tools they need to frame problems, design strategies, and test solutions in a structured and playful way.

Inside, you'll find all essential physical tools:

Game board

Card decks (strategy, experiment, personas, trends)

Facilitation aids (task cards, instructions, timers, voting stickers)

Stationery (sticky notes, pens, score sheets)

Whether you're guiding first-time learners or experienced professionals, the main game box transforms any space into a collaborative strategy lab.

All Assets of the game

Real world challenges deck

Process Tactics
Engagement Tactics
Supply chain & Network Tactics
Profit & Social Mission Tactics
Circular Eco Design Tactics
Structure Tactics
Channel Tactics
Strategy tactics deck - 98
Discovery Experiment
Validation Experiment
Experiment card deck - 39
Challenge deck
Customer Persona's
CUSTOMER SEGMENT
Product cards
STREAMING SERVICE
PRODUCT OFFERING
Generic challenge cards
PRODUCT INNOVATION
CHALLENGE STATEMENT
Scoring Cards/ Pads
Strategy Scoring
Experiment Scoring
Re writeable tiles - 7
Decision stickers
Post it pads + Pens + Timer

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Unbox

A HOLISTIC BIZ INNOVATOR-IN-A-BOX, TO SOLVE REAL WORLD CHALLENGES

BIZ STRATEGY & TACTICS KIT
STRATEGY CREATION BOARD

Components :
Strategy Building Board
Tactics Card Deck - 98 Cards
Challenge Deck - 44 Cards
Statement Framing Tiles - 7
Strategy Scoring Sheet Pads +
Scoring and Feedback Rewritable Card

Bonus
Business Model
Sticker Game
on MIRO

Sticker Sheets
Transparent Sticky Pads
Dry Erasable Pens - 3
Marker/Pens - 3

Rs.4999/-

BIZ STRATEGY & TACTICS CARD DECK

Rs.2499/-

TRAVEL PACKS
Biz Strategy & Tactics Card Deck
Biz Experiment Methods Card Deck

Support
Book a Facilitator
Book a Team Session
Call us for a Workshop

BIZ EXPERIMENT METHODS CARD DECK

Rs.2499/-

PROFESSIONALS KIT
BIZ INNOVATION KIT

Rs.7999/-

Components :
BIZ STRATEGY & TACTICS KIT COMPONENTS PLUS
Assumption Finder Board
Experiment Methods Deck - 39 Cards
Experiment Pitch Scoring Sheet Pads +
Scoring and Feedback Rewritable Card

miro

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1 Year Subscription to Unbox on MIRO
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Email/Chat Feedback on your
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STRATEGY AND TACTICS CARD DECK

This box contains the complete 98-card Tactic Deck used during the business model creation phase of the game.

Cards are categorized across the 9 building blocks of the Business Model Canvas:

Value Proposition
Customer Segments
Revenue Streams
Channels
Customer Relationships
Key Activities
Key Resources
Key Partnerships
Cost Structure

Each card includes:

A clear strategic move or tactic
A brief description
A real-world reference or example
Icons and color codes for easy categorization

Players use these cards to build, discuss, and prioritize the components of their strategy.

Ideal for: Core gameplay, strategy design, model thinking.

FINAL BOX

Instruction booklet

Mock up and iterations

EXPERIMENT METHODS CARD DECK

This compact, targeted box contains a 39-card Experiment Deck that helps players test and validate their business model.

Each card focuses on a lean experimentation method, guiding players to:

Identify assumptions
Frame testable hypotheses
Design minimal experiments
Measure outcomes and learning

Examples include:

Landing page tests
Concierge MVP
Fake door tests
A/B testing
Surveys and customer interviews

Each card also includes risk levels, evidence strength, and next-step recommendations.

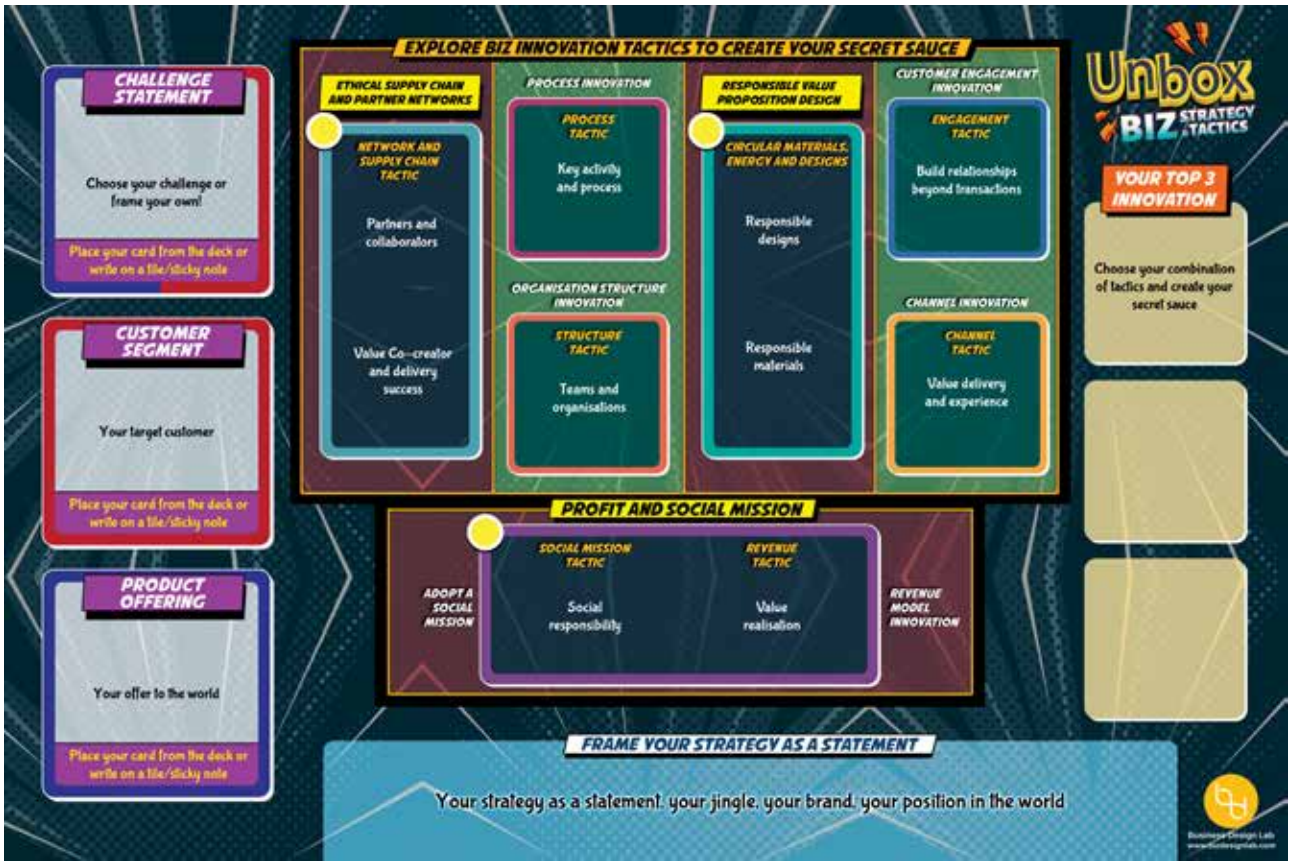
Ideal for: Reducing uncertainty, practicing validation, turning theory into action.

FINAL BOX

Instruction booklet

Mock up and iterations

How to play Board 1



STEP 1

Read the Challenge Card: Understand the challenge scenario thoroughly (e.g., Tesla or Airbnb case).

STEP 2

Choose a Product Fit: Select a product that fits the chosen customer segment and place it on the board as the value proposition.

STEP 3

Choose a Customer Segment Fit: Choose a product fit for the customer segment and place it on the board as the value proposition (this seems like a duplicate of Step 2—could be clarified in the final layout).

STEP 4

Craft Your Strategy – Create Your Secret Sauce: Explore tactic cards in each business element. Identify and place the right tactics in their respective board positions

STEP 5

Discuss and Identify Your Top 3 Tactics:Select the combination of tactics that form the "secret sauce" of your winning strategy.

STEP 6

Secret Sauce and Strategy Statement. Use the statement framing structure to write your strategy as a sentence. Paste the final strategy statement on the board.

Unbox STRATEGY & TACTICS

HOW TO PLAY

STEP 1:
Choose a customer segment from the deck or define your customer segment

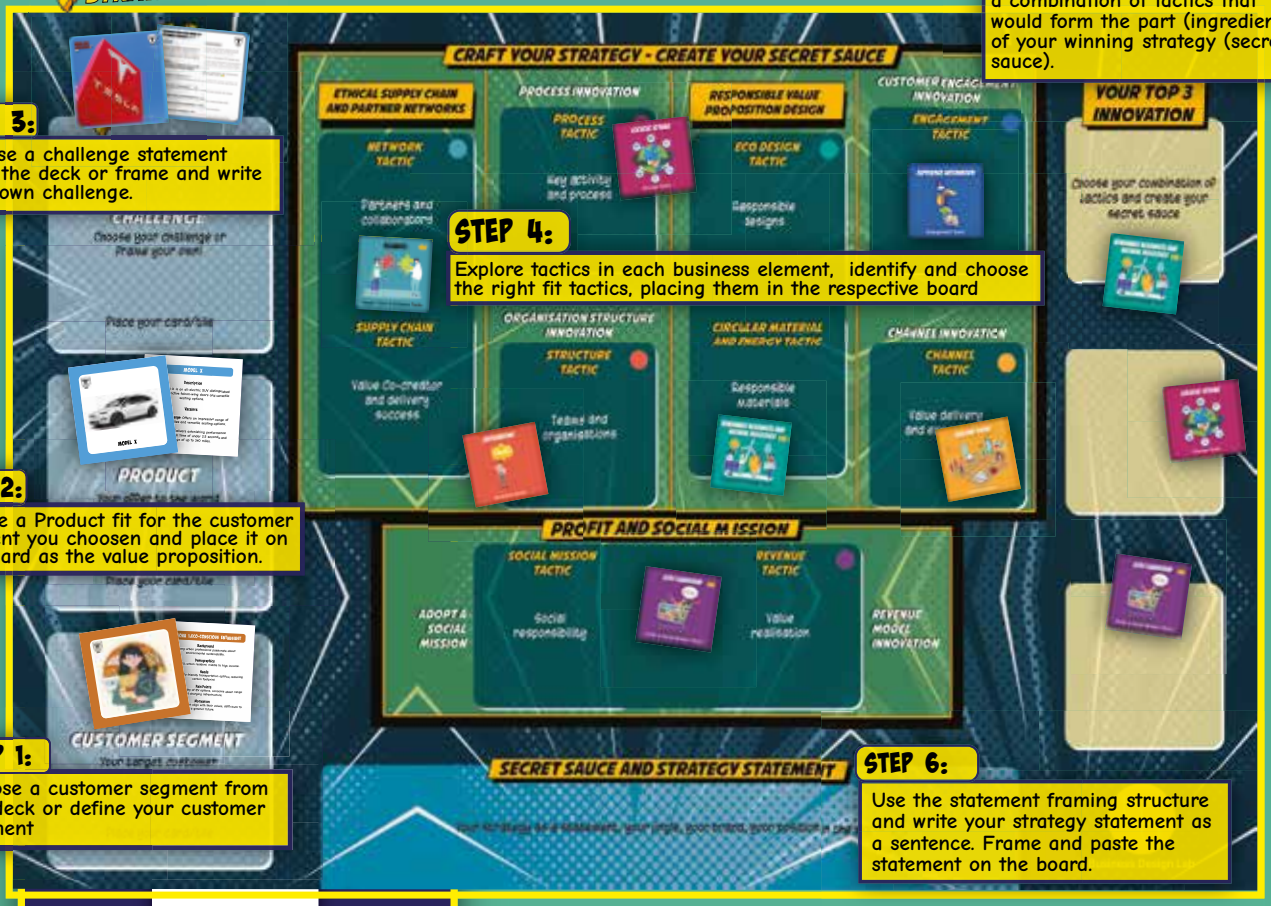
STEP 2:
Choose a Product fit for the customer segment you choosen and place it on the board as the value proposition.

STEP 3:
Choose a challenge statement from the deck or frame and write your own challenge.

STEP 4:
Explore tactics in each business element, identify and choose the right fit tactics, placing them in the respective board

STEP 5
Discuss your strategy and identify a combination of tactics that would form the part (ingredient) of your winning strategy (secret sauce).

STEP 6:
Use the statement framing structure and write your strategy statement as a sentence. Frame and paste the statement on the board.



AN EXAMINATION OF STRATEGY SCORING

* Strategy has 3 criteria's, Rate each of them as Low/Med/High

STRATEGY SCORING CARD

Use Rewritable strategy scoring card for scoring.

* Sum Up the rating for all scoring Criteria

Strategic Direction :

	Low	Med	High
1. Direction Clarity: Is the direction clear and easily understood?	○	○	○
2. Innovation Focus: Does the strategy foster innovation?	○	○	○
3. Scalability: How well can the strategy scale for future growth?	○	○	○

Competitive Differentiation :

	Low	Med	High
4. Uniqueness: How distinct is the differentiation from competitors?	○	○	○
5. Market Positioning: Is the product's positioning clear in the market?	○	○	○
6. Relevance: How well does differentiation meet the target market's needs?	○	○	○

Defensibility :

	Low	Med	High
7. Protection Measures: Are measures in place to defend the strategy?	○	○	○
8. Barrier to Entry: How challenging is it for competitors to replicate the strategy?	○	○	○
9. Adaptability: Can the strategy adapt to changing conditions?	○	○	○

Sum Up the rating for Strategic Direction → **Strategic Direction**: Is your Strategy aligned to the Challenge ? Low ○ Med ○ High ○

Sum Up the rating for Competitive Differentiation → **Competitive Differentiation**: Is your strategy novel and unique ? Low ○ Med ○ High ○

Sum Up the rating for Defensibility → **Defensibility**: Is your strategy defendable against competitors ? Low ○ Med ○ High ○

Convert your rating into points as a team

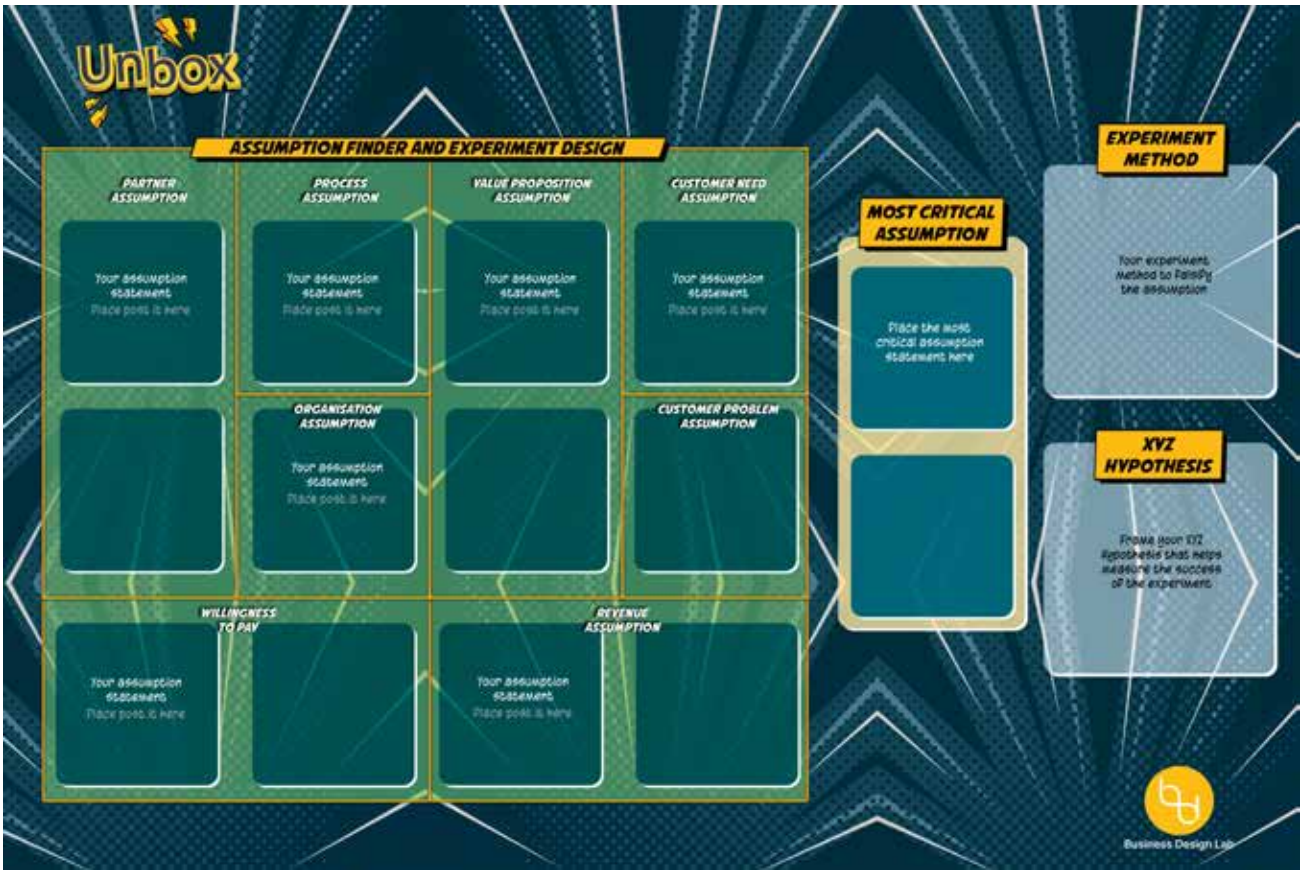
Point Conversion :

5 points for every LOW
10~25 points for every MED
25~50 points for every HIGH

Use the points to determine changes in strategy

Be ready to defend your TEAM points to a jury/ panel of collaborators, customers and possible investors

How to play Board 2



STEP 1

Use Assumption Prompt Cards: Write down the assumptions that might defeat your strategy across areas like:
Partner Assumption, Process Assumption
Value Proposition Assumption
Customer Need Assumption, Organizational Assumption
Customer Problem Assumption, Willingness to Pay
Revenue Assumption

STEP 2

Select the Most Critical Assumption: Discuss as a team and choose the most critical assumption to test.

STEP 3

Form a Hypothesis: Use your critical assumption to frame an XYZ Hypothesis Statement (e.g., We believe that [X user] will [Y behavior] because [Z reason])

STEP 4

Choose an Experiment Method: Pick the experiment card that best helps you falsify or validate your hypothesis.

Unbox Experiment

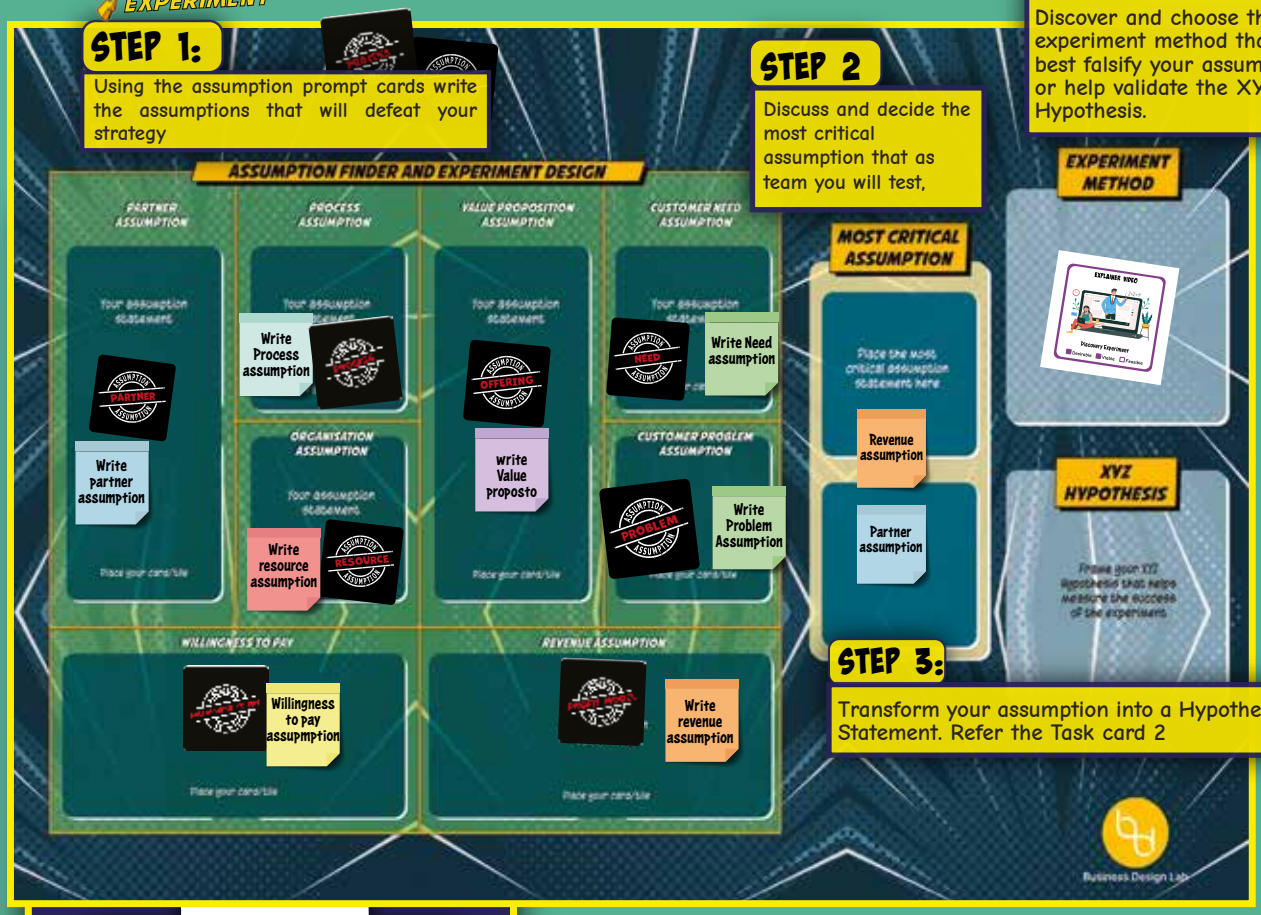
HOW TO PLAY

STEP 1:
Using the assumption prompt cards write the assumptions that will defeat your strategy

STEP 2
Discuss and decide the most critical assumption that as team you will test,

STEP 3:
Transform your assumption into a Hypothesis Statement. Refer the Task card 2

STEP 4:
Discover and choose the experiment method that will best falsify your assumption or help validate the XYZ Hypothesis.



AN EXAMINATION OF ASSUMPTION & EXPERIMENT SCORING

* Experiment has 3 criteria's, Rate each of them as Low/Med/High

Assumption Clarity :

	Low	Med	High
1. Clarity of Assumptions: Are assumptions articulated clearly and unambiguously?	◯	◯	◯
2. Alignment with Strategy: Do the assumptions align with the overall strategy?	◯	◯	◯
3. Criticality: How essential are these assumptions to the strategy?	◯	◯	◯

Testable and Measurable Hypothesis

	Low	Med	High
4. Measurability: Are the hypotheses measurable with clear success criteria?	◯	◯	◯
5. Alignment with Assumptions: Do the hypotheses correspond to the critical assumptions?	◯	◯	◯
6. Effectiveness: How likely are the hypotheses to provide valid results?	◯	◯	◯

Experiment Speed and Efficiency

	Low	Med	High
7. Execution Speed: How fast can experiments be performed to gather data?	◯	◯	◯
8. Resource Efficiency: Are experiments resource-efficient in terms of time and cost?	◯	◯	◯
9. Evidence Strength : How strong and reliable are the experimental results likely to be?	◯	◯	◯

EXPERIMENT SCORING CARD

Use Rewritable experiment scoring card for scoring.

* Sum Up the rating for all scoring Criteria

Sum Up the rating for Assumption Clarity → **Assumption Clarity**
Is your assumption really critical & aligned to the strategy ?
Low Med High ◯ ◯ ◯

Sum Up the rating for Testable & Measurable Hypothesis → **Hypothesis**
Is your experiment plan measurable and effective to falsify the assumption?
Low Med High ◯ ◯ ◯

Sum Up the rating for Experiment Speed & Efficiency → **Speed & Efficiency**
Is your experiment fast and efficient to deliver a strong evidence?
Low Med High ◯ ◯ ◯

Convert your rating into points as a team

Point Conversion :

5 points for every LOW
10~25 points for every MED
25~50 points for every HIGH

Use the points to determine changes in strategy

Be ready to defend your TEAM points to a jury/ panel of collaborators, customers and possible investors

SCORING BOARD 1 — Strategy Scoring

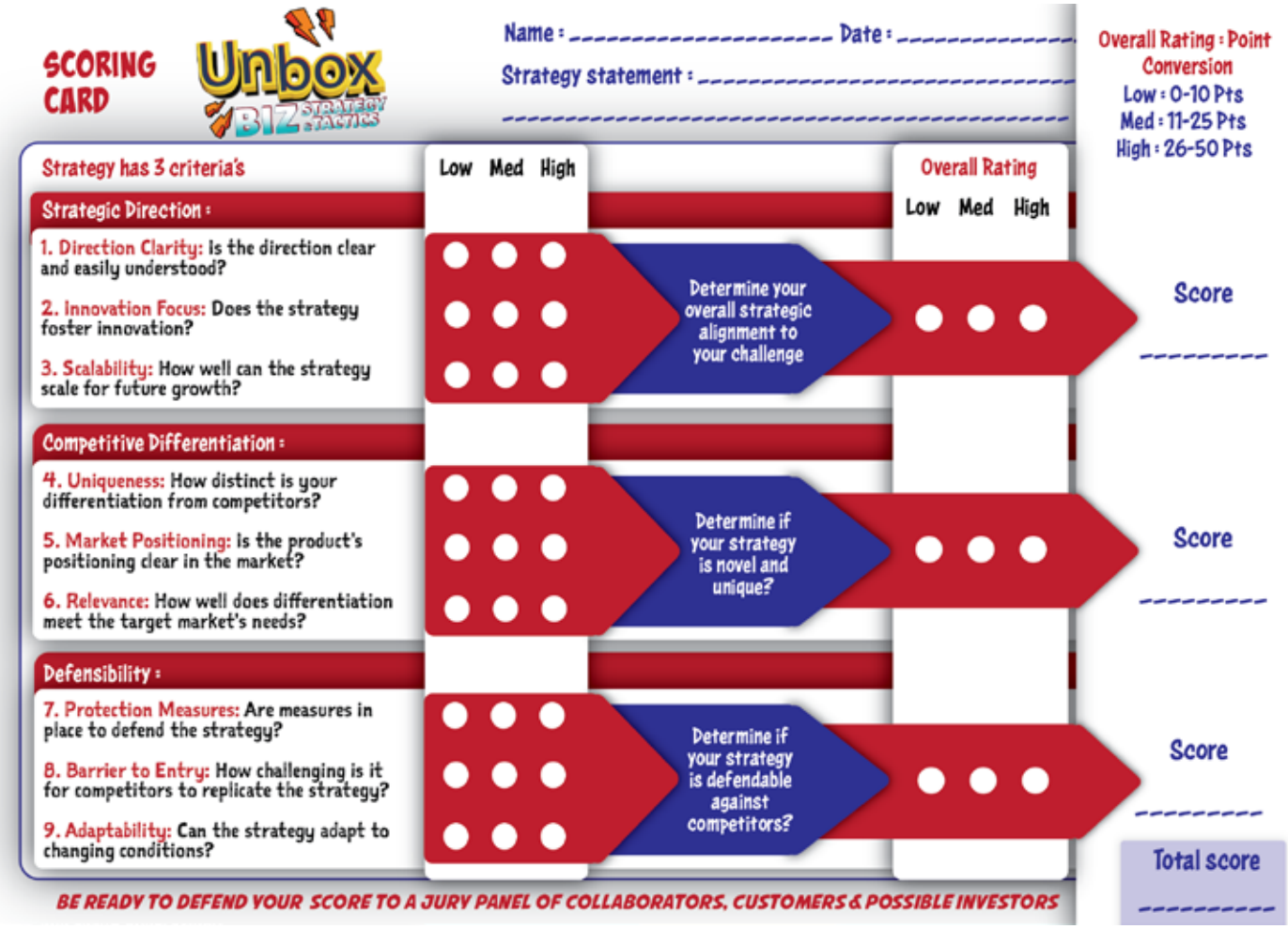
Rate your strategy based on 3 main elements:

Strategic Direction
Direction Clarity
Innovation Focus
Scalability

Competitive Differentiation
Uniqueness
Market Positioning
Relevance

Defensibility
Protection Measures
Barriers to Entry
Adaptability

Each criterion is scored as Low / Medium / High and converted into team points.



SCORING — Assumptions & Experiments

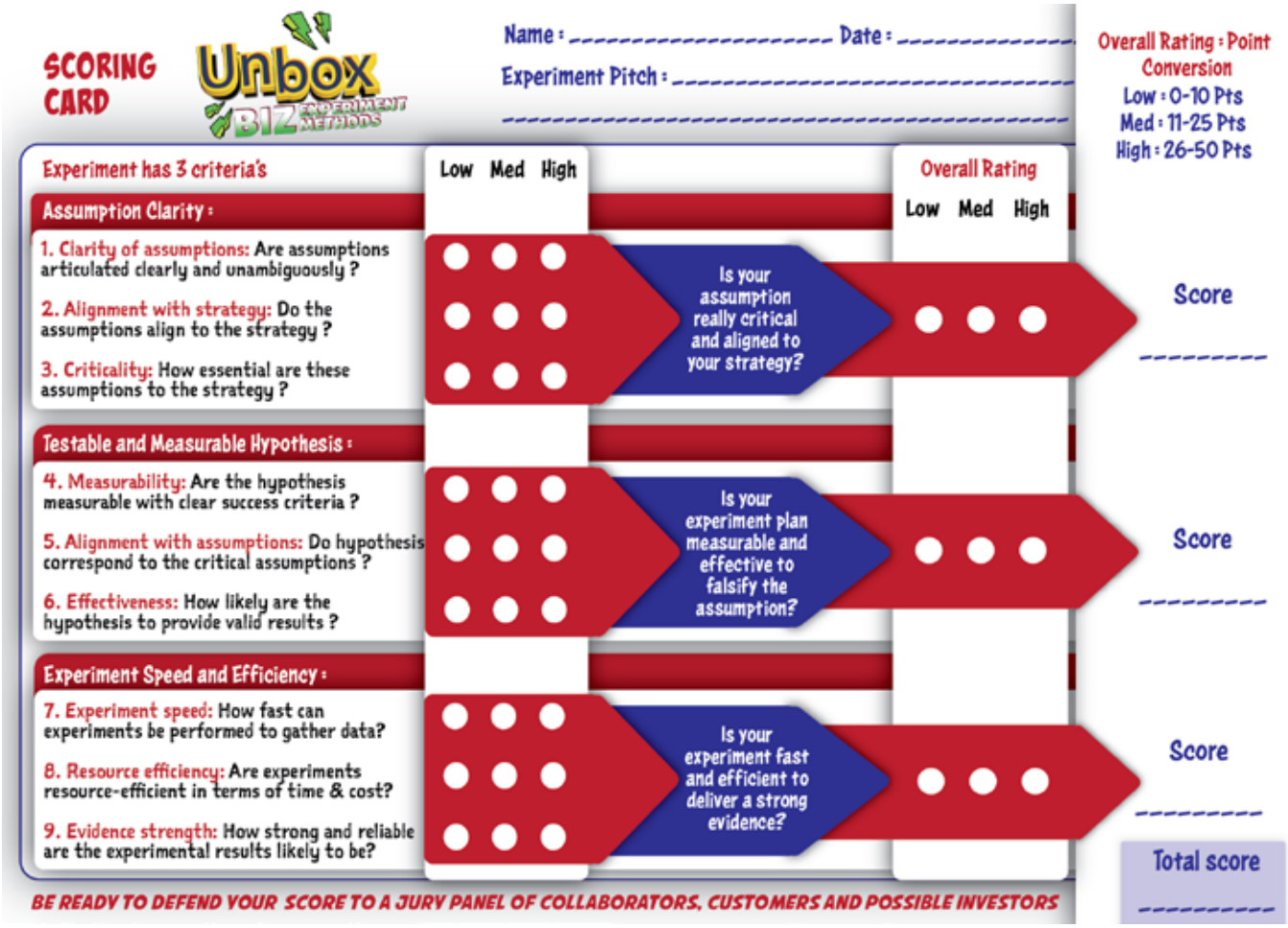
Rate based on:

Assumption Clarity
Clarity
Alignment with Strategy
Criticality

Testable & Measurable Hypothesis
Measurability
Alignment with Assumptions
Effectiveness

Experiment Speed & Efficiency
Execution Speed
Resource Efficiency
Evidence Strength

Scored as Low / Medium / High and converted to points for analysis and iteration.



Website design for Unbox

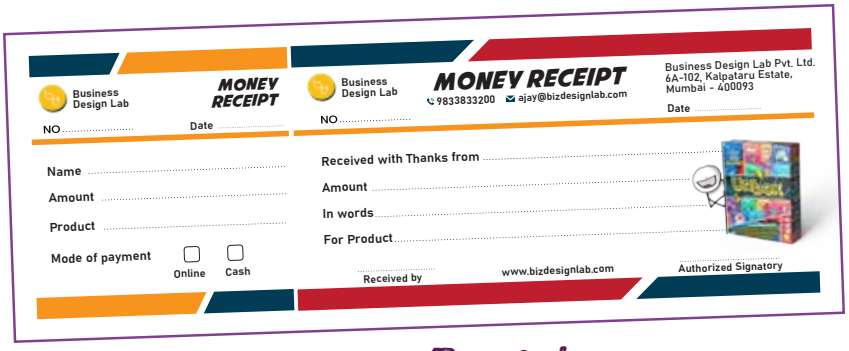
Other promotional content designed

Banners and standees

Logo & stickers

Product Catalouge

Thank you cards



Receipts

Visiting cards

OVERVIEW

As part of the Leadership Offsite Program, participants engage directly with a Client Project, providing a hands-on opportunity to apply leadership principles and problem-solving skills in a real-world setting. This phase is structured around testing and collaborating with the client on a live organizational challenge they are currently facing.

Leadership Off site Program- Client Project (Testing with client)

Playtesting & Contributing to a client projet, Addressing real-world organizational challenges.(Miro Templates)

Co-facilitating the delivery of the Unbox experience, Integrating research findings and industry trends into actionable insights for the client.

Refining the whole game on the basis of session feedback.

About the client- Xylem India

Xylem Water Solutions India Private Limited is the Indian subsidiary of Xylem Inc., a global leader in water technology solutions. Established on June 2, 2011, and headquartered in Vadodara, Gujarat, the company specializes in manufacturing pumps and pumping equipment, catering to various sectors including municipal water, wastewater, residential and commercial building services, and industrial markets .

Xylem India's commitment to addressing water challenges through advanced technology and sustainable solutions positions it as a key player in the country's water sector.

Xylem India's offerings include submersible pumps, mixers, treatment equipment, and solutions for water and wastewater applications, serving industries such as chemicals, petrochemicals, power, oil & gas, irrigation, HVAC, and building services.

The projects focus on real-world organizational challenges presented by the client, which could range from innovation bottlenecks, employee engagement issues, strategic pivots, to culture transformation initiatives. Participants work closely with the client team, blending creativity, leadership acumen, and strategic thinking to co-create impactful solutions. The Project started with wake make model.

The whole team of Xylem was divide into 4 teams. The first activity wake make model was collectively done by all the teams together.

Wake Make Model

Core Components of the WakeMake Model

- **Strategic Design:**
  Crafting environments that encourage collaboration and innovation.
- **Facilitation of Co-Creation:**
  Guiding teams through processes that promote shared ownership of solutions.
- **Collaborative Problem-Solving:**
  Engaging diverse perspectives to address complex challenges.
- **Sustained Productivity:**
  Implementing practices that ensure ongoing effectiveness and adaptability.

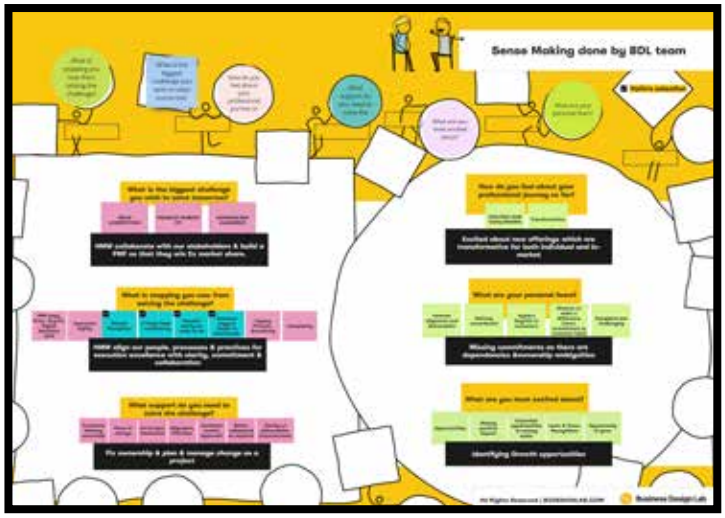
The WakeMake model is a strategic framework designed to facilitate co-creative and collaborative problem-solving environments. This helps the every team to be on the same page.

Benefits of the WakeMake Model

- **Empowered Teams:**
  Teams feel a greater sense of ownership and commitment to solutions they've helped create.

- **Improved Problem-Solving:**
  Collaborative approaches often lead to more comprehensive and effective solutions.

- **Sustainable Change:**
  By involving stakeholders in the creation process, changes are more likely to be embraced and maintained over time.



Studying existing business model

The Business Model Canvas is a strategic tool that helps visualize how a company creates, delivers, and captures value. During the Xylem Leadership Offsite, teams used this canvas to map the current business and identify innovation opportunities. All teams did mapping of the existing business model according to them.

The canvas is made up of 9 key building blocks:

- **Key Partners:**
  Who Xylem relies on externally to succeed (e.g., channel partners, consultants, engineering firms, EPC companies, suppliers, government bodies).

- **Key Activities**
  What activities are critical for delivering the value proposition:
  (e.g., design engineering, manufacturing, supply chain management, servicing, digital product development).

- **Value Proposition**
  What Xylem promises to its customers:
  (e.g., high-efficiency water management solutions, lifecycle cost savings, digital water intelligence).

- Customer Relationships / Customer Engagement
  How Xylem builds and maintains customer trust:
  (e.g., technical support, field service, consultation, training, post-sales engagement).

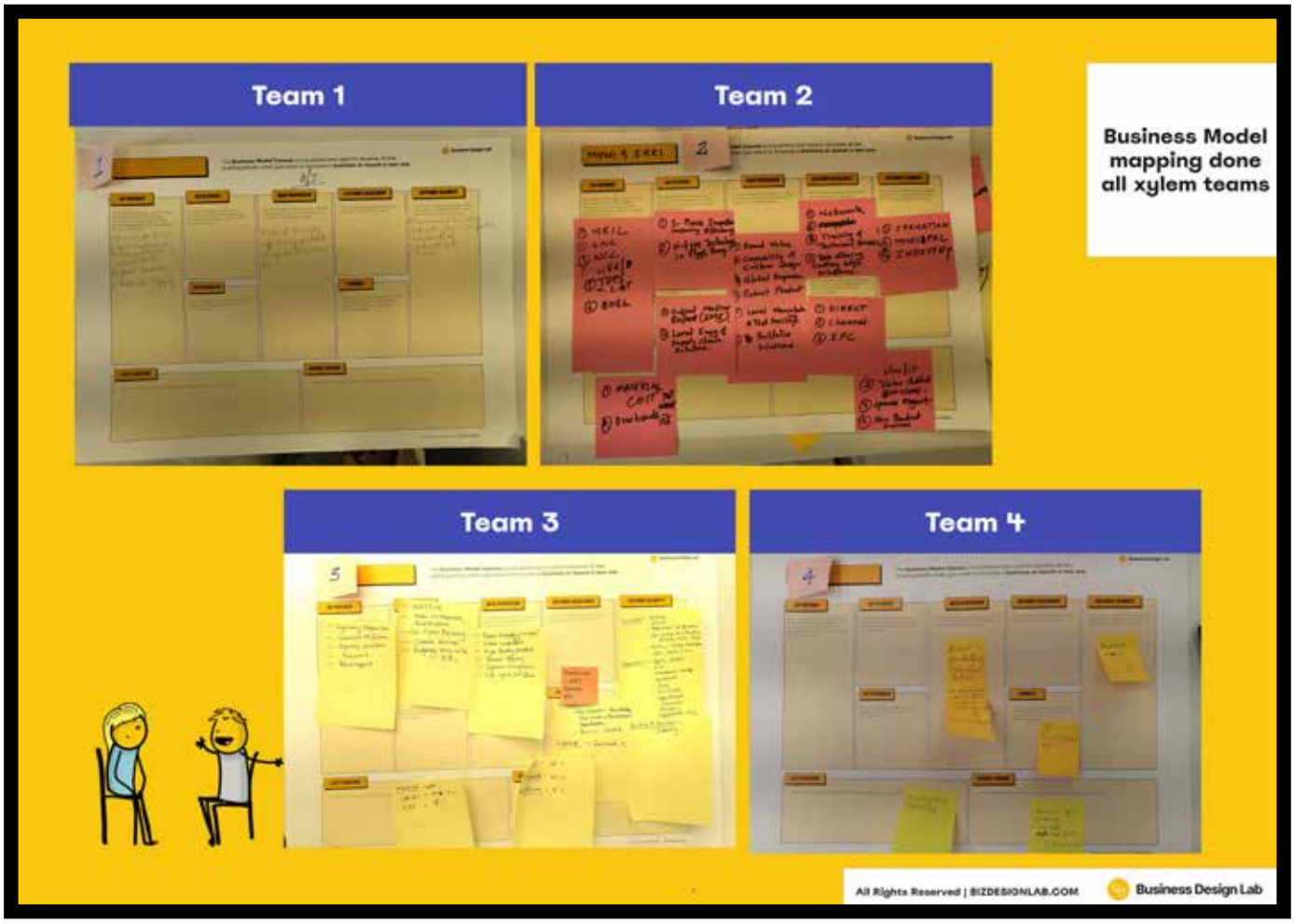
- Customer Segments
  Whom Xylem serves:
  (e.g., municipal corporations, industrial clients like pharma and steel plants, residential complexes, infrastructure projects like airports).

- Channels
  How Xylem delivers its value proposition:
  (e.g., direct sales, channel partners, online platforms, consultants).

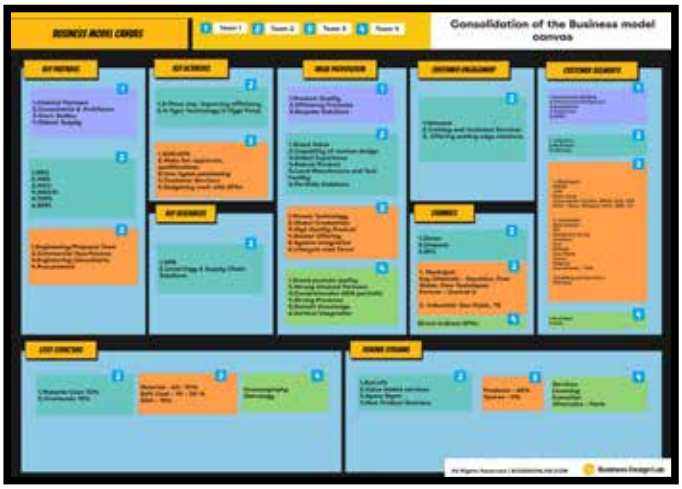
- Key Resources
  What assets Xylem needs:
  (e.g., intellectual property, skilled talent, manufacturing facilities, digital platforms).

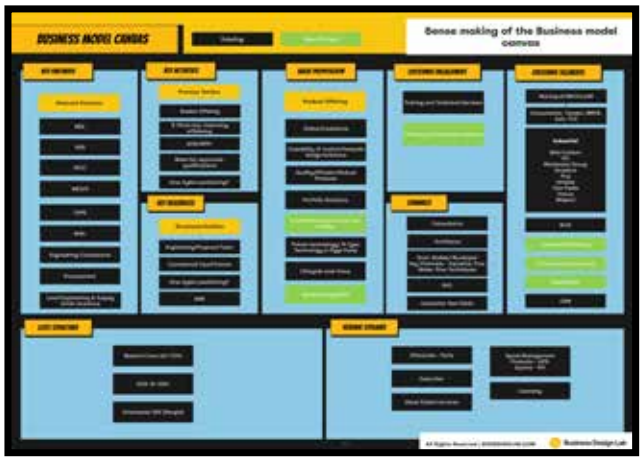
- Cost Structure
  What the major costs are:
  (e.g., material costs, employee costs, manufacturing overheads, service delivery costs).

- Revenue Streams
  How Xylem earns money:
  (e.g., product sales, service contracts, digital subscription models, consulting fees).



All Teams came together to analyse and build their existing business model. All four teams made seprate business models and then consolidated it into one.





Sense Making:

Business model was then anlysed by business design lab team and through sense making, The team identified Key sectors and players in the indian and global market.

Each team was equipped with creative materials like Post-Its, Sharpies, chart papers, badges, and stationery. The goal was to enable brainstorming, prototyping, and experiential workshops.

Identifying trends and Market forces

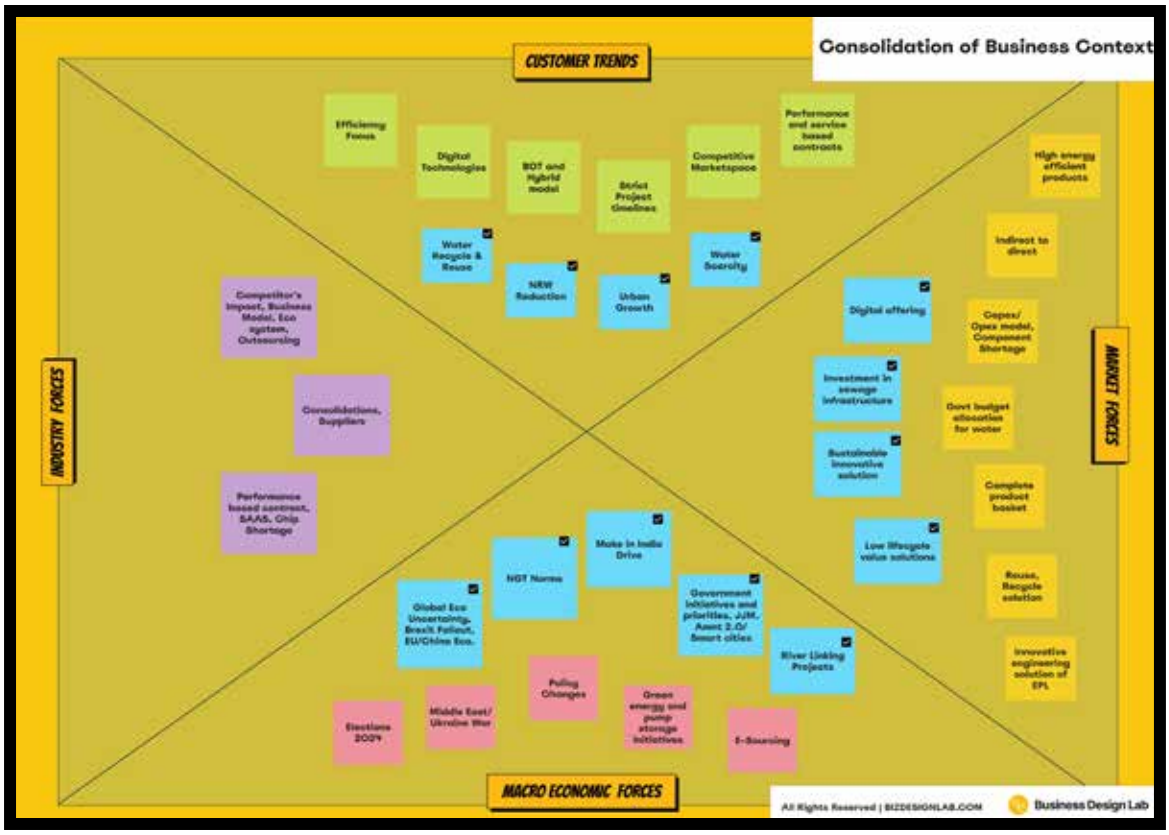
In this section, Xylem's teams analyzed the external environment affecting their business. Understanding customer trends and industry forces is crucial for any company looking to stay competitive and innovative. Prompt questions were provided to the teams in order to stay in the direction.

After identifying maket forces and industry trends, the teams looked at how these forces and trends are affecting the business model.

- **Context Mapping**
  Teams came together to address and map all the new and exisiting markets gaps.

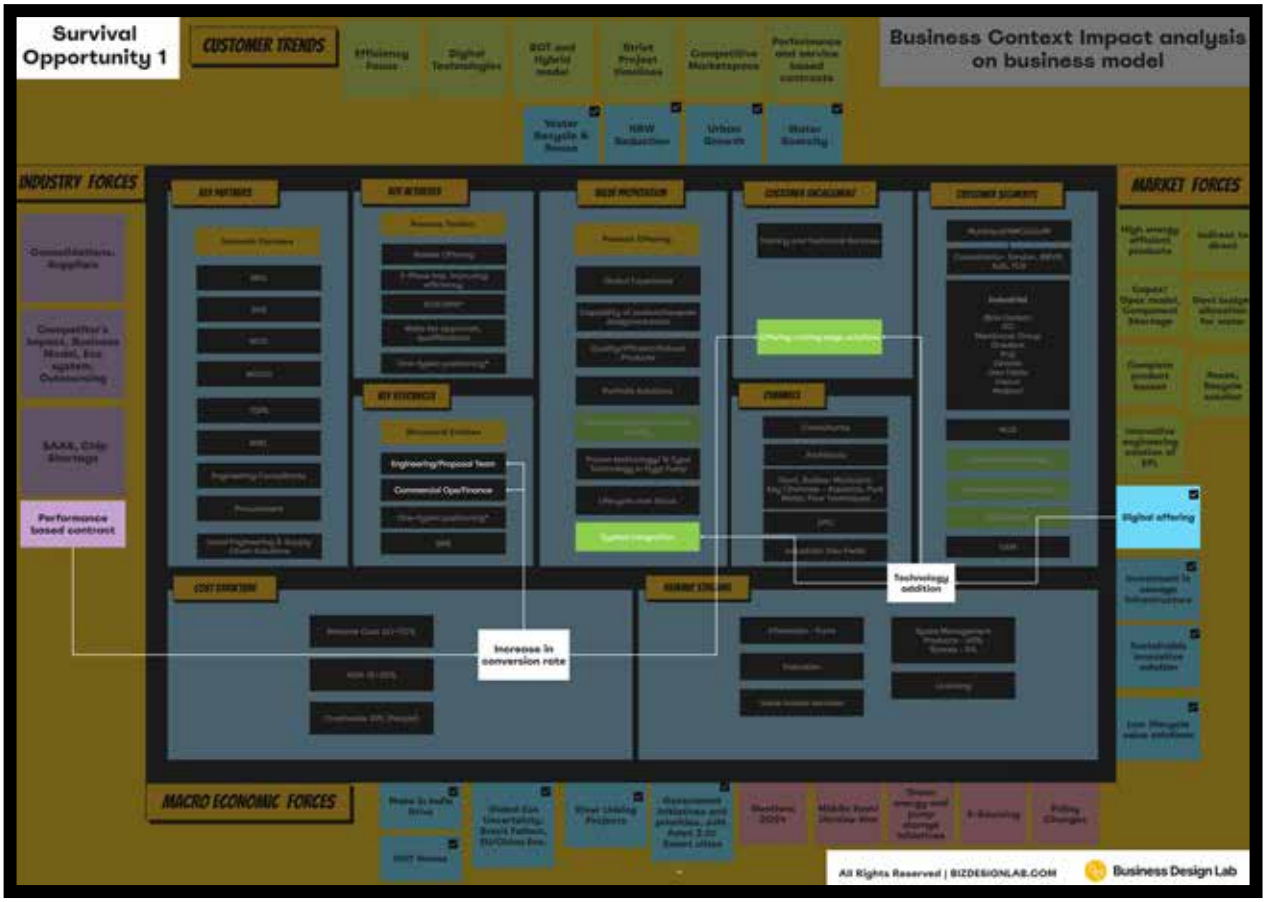
- **Priortization:**
  Teams collectively priortised the trends and forces that wer affecting their business model.

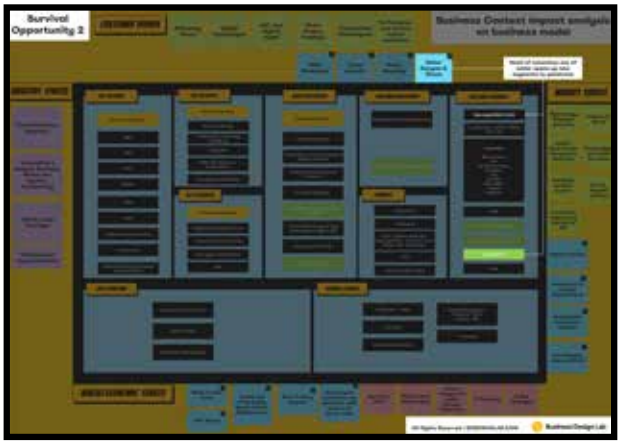
Xylem's teams did business context mapping and priortized the forces that were somehow impacting the existing business model in posititve or negative way.

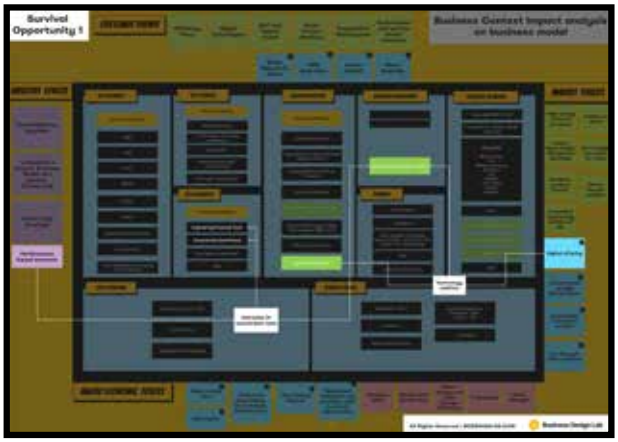


Business context imapact analysis on business model.

"In this phase, the Business Design Lab team focused on understanding the interplay between external forces and Xylem's existing business model. These external forces included a wide range of dynamic shifts—such as technological advancements, changing customer demands, sustainability regulations, economic volatility, and increased competition.





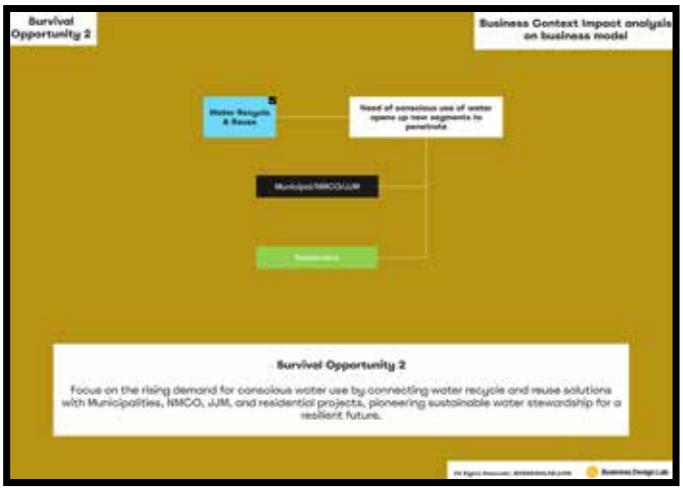


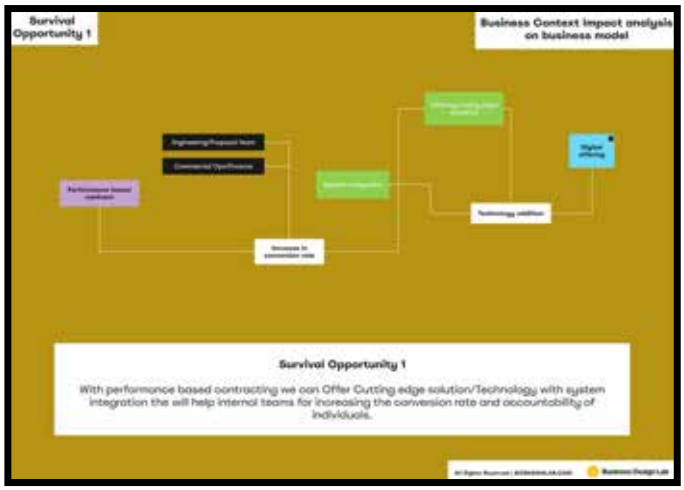
Survival Opportunities

Rather than viewing these trends in isolation, the team used systems thinking to map their collective impact on key components of the business model.

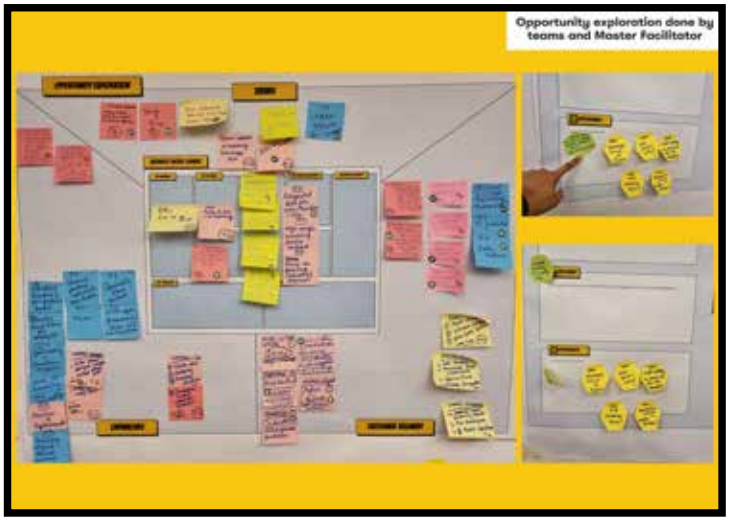
Through strategic frameworks like the Business Model Canvas and the Wake-Make-Model process, the team identified where Xylem's current operations might be vulnerable—and where latent strengths could be activated to respond to these shifts.

This led to the identification of "survival opportunities"—new value propositions, customer segments, and revenue models that could ensure business continuity and future relevance.



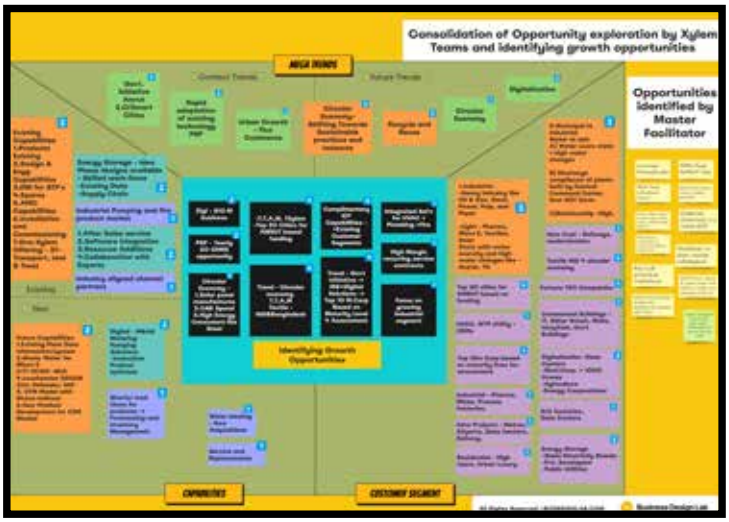


Opportunities



"Opportunity exploration was carried out independently by all participating teams, each bringing their unique perspectives and domain knowledge to the table.

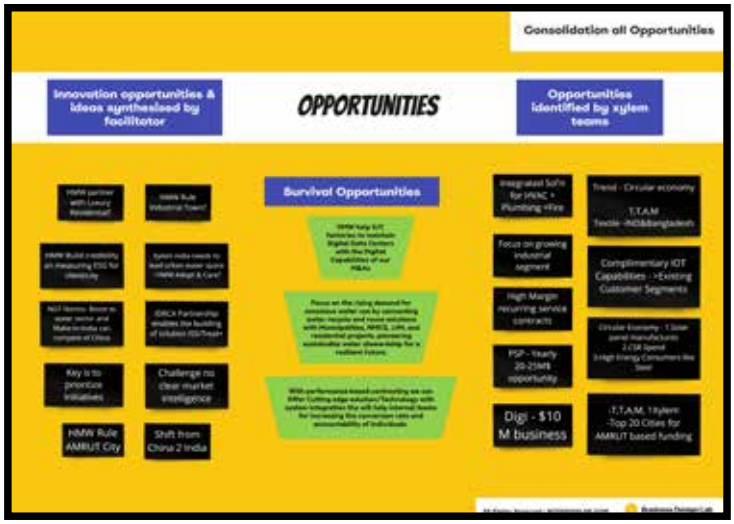
In parallel, a master facilitator synthesized insights across teams, ensuring alignment, cross-pollination of ideas, and identification of overarching strategic opportunities."



The Business Design Lab (BDL) team took on the critical role of consolidating the opportunity explorations conducted independently by the various Xylem teams.

By synthesizing the diverse insights, ideas, and proposals generated across teams, the BDL team identified common patterns, strategic themes, and high-potential growth opportunities.

This consolidated view enabled a holistic understanding of where the organization could innovate and expand.

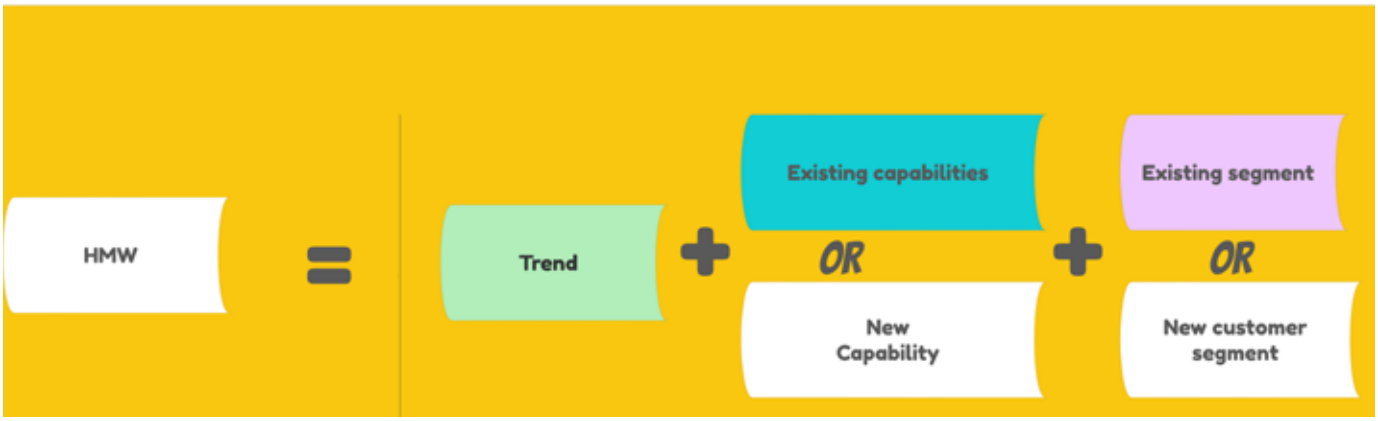


Following this, the participants engaged in a structured prioritization exercise, using voting methods to evaluate and rank the opportunities based on criteria such as impact, feasibility, and alignment with Xylem's long-term vision."

Way forward

Way Forward

Now we can frame/reframe **Survival and growth opportunities** into a HMW(How Might We) challenge statement which can follow specific trend and customer segment and identify existing or new capabilities that will help in solving the challenge.



Both the survival and growth opportunities identified during the exploration and consolidation phases were later translated into 'How Might We' (HMW) challenge statements.

The purpose of this transformation was to set the stage for collaborative problem-solving using the Unbox board game—a tool designed to drive creativity, critical thinking, and cross-functional ideation. By gamifying the innovation process, the Unbox board game enabled teams to explore, prototype, and build on these challenge statements in an engaging and outcome-driven way.

OVERVIEW

Following the identification of key challenge themes, Xylem participants reorganized into three focused teams, each aligned with a specific domain—Industrial, Municipal, and Residential—based on their expertise and functional roles. This re-grouping enabled each team to take full ownership of a segment and begin formulating context-specific strategic responses

Leadership Off site Program- Client Project (Testing with client)

Playtesting & Contributing to a client projet, Addressing real-world organizational challenges.

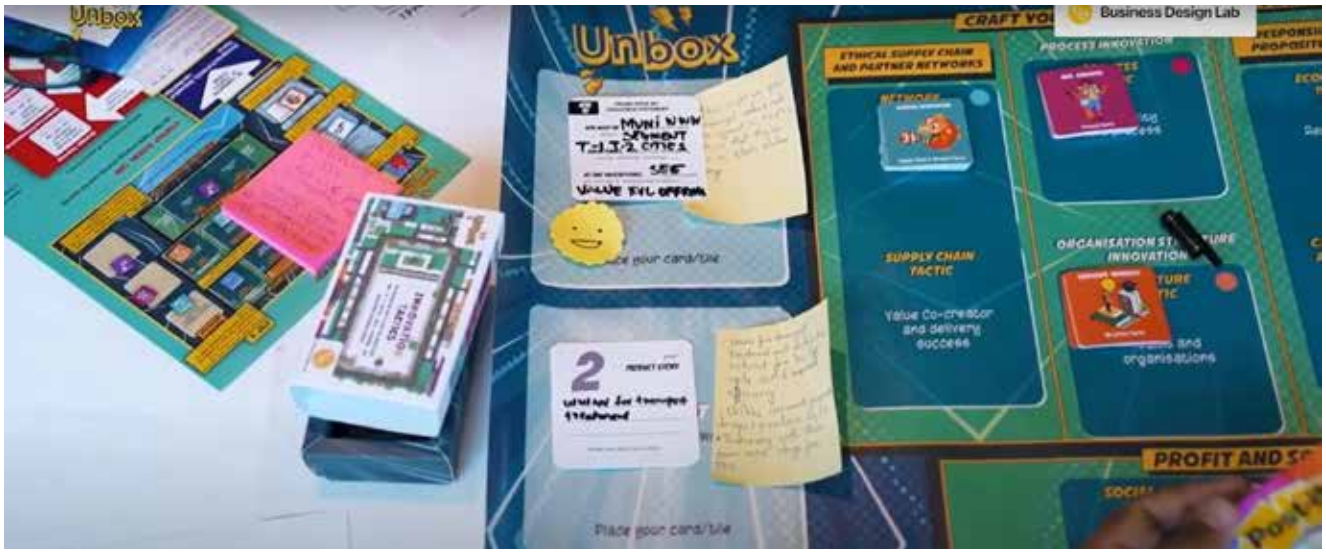
Co-facilitating the delivery of the Unbox experience, Integrating research findings and industry trends into actionable insights for the client.

Refining the final game on the basis of session feedback.

As a result of the previous activities—opportunity exploration, consolidation, and reframing into 'How Might We' statements—three core challenge areas emerged: Industrial, Municipal, and Residential. These represented the primary customer segments with distinct needs, constraints, and growth potentials.

Unbox Experience

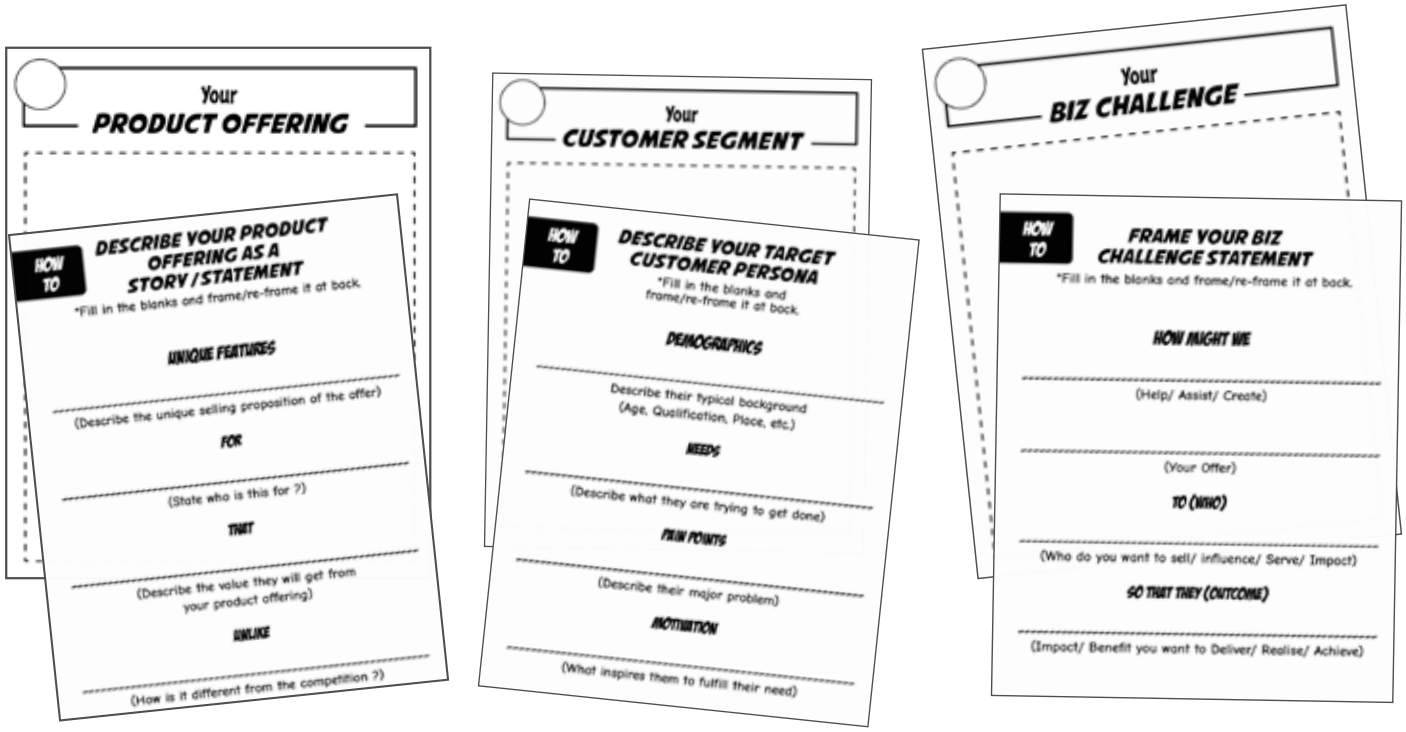
Based on these themes, the Xylem participants re-grouped themselves into three focused teams, aligning with their individual areas of expertise and domain knowledge. Each team took ownership of one segment and began crafting strategic responses tailored to its unique context. During this phase, the Master Facilitator and the Managing Director (MD) engaged directly with each team, moving from group to group to understand their thought process, provoke deeper strategic thinking, and ensure alignment with organizational priorities."



Redefining the challenge statements

Each team began their strategy sprint by revisiting and redefining their assigned customer segment. This involved examining the specific needs, behaviors, and pain points of the segment in greater depth.

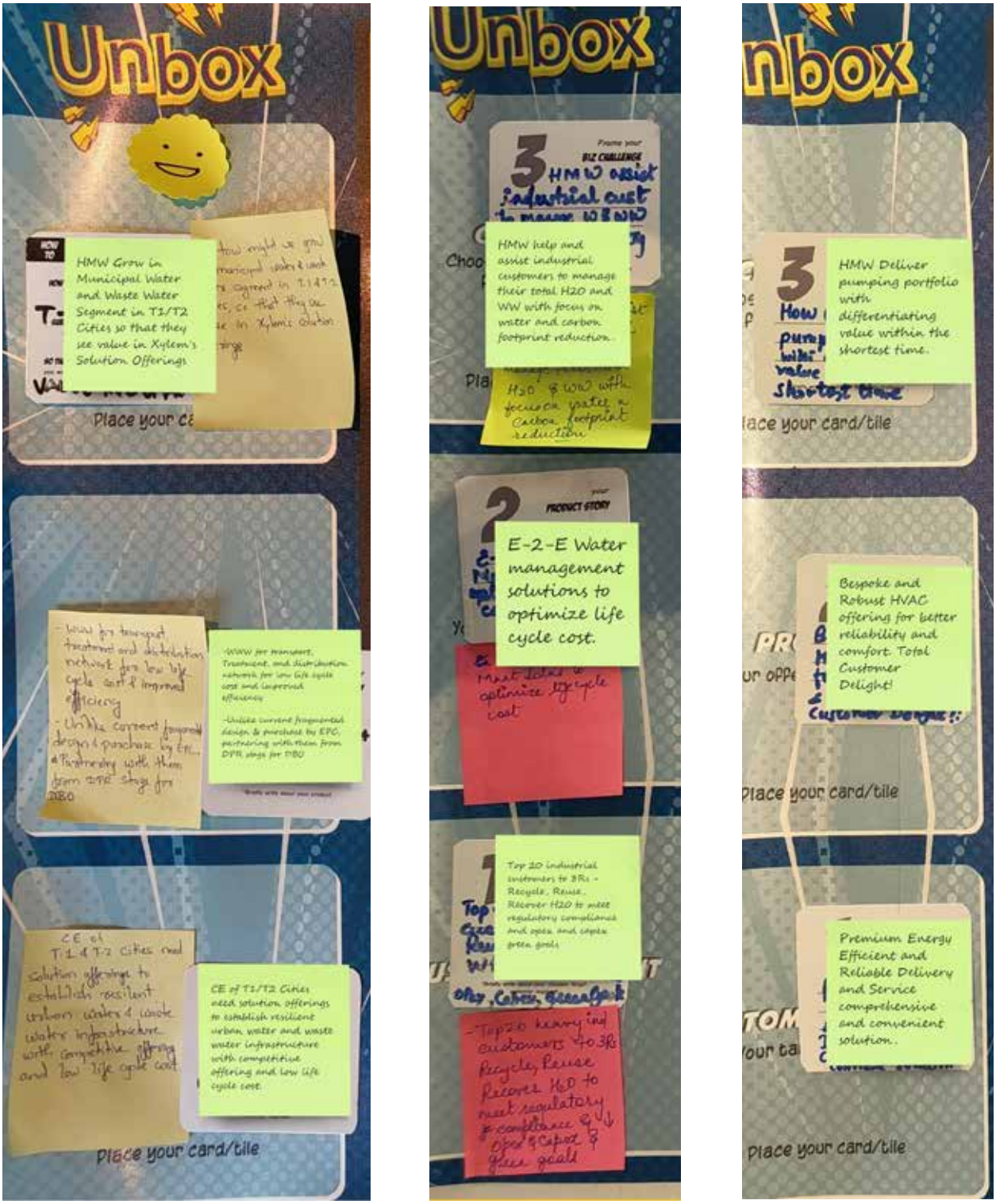
Simultaneously, they reflected on Xylem's current offerings and considered how these could evolve or be reimagined to better meet emerging demands. Through this dual process of customer and product redefinition, the teams crafted refined and sharply focused 'How Might We' (HMW) challenge statements.



"To support the teams in refining their customer segments, product definitions, and final 'How Might We' challenge statements, prompt cards were provided as facilitation tools.

These cards contained targeted questions, strategic provocations, and guided frameworks designed to stimulate deeper thinking and encourage divergent perspectives.

By engaging with the prompts, teams were able to uncover hidden assumptions, clarify ambiguities, and ensure their challenge statements were well-grounded, specific, and innovation-ready."



"Using the prompt cards and guided facilitation, the Xylem teams revisited and redefined three core elements: the product, the customer, and the challenge statement

Strategy In-Making

With clearly defined challenge statements in place, the teams progressed to the next phase: business model development. Anchored in their chosen 'How Might We' challenge, each team began constructing a tailored business model to respond effectively to their defined problem space.

To support this, they were provided with a curated deck of 98 tactic cards—each representing strategic options across the 9 elements of the Business Model Canvas (such as Value Proposition, Customer Segments, Channels, Revenue Streams, and more). These cards offered a wide spectrum of innovative pathways and allowed the teams to explore, combine, and design a coherent strategy.

Once all the relevant tactics were selected and mapped, each team conducted an internal voting exercise to prioritize the top 3 tactics they believed would have the most impact. This helped sharpen focus and align the team on a high-potential strategy."

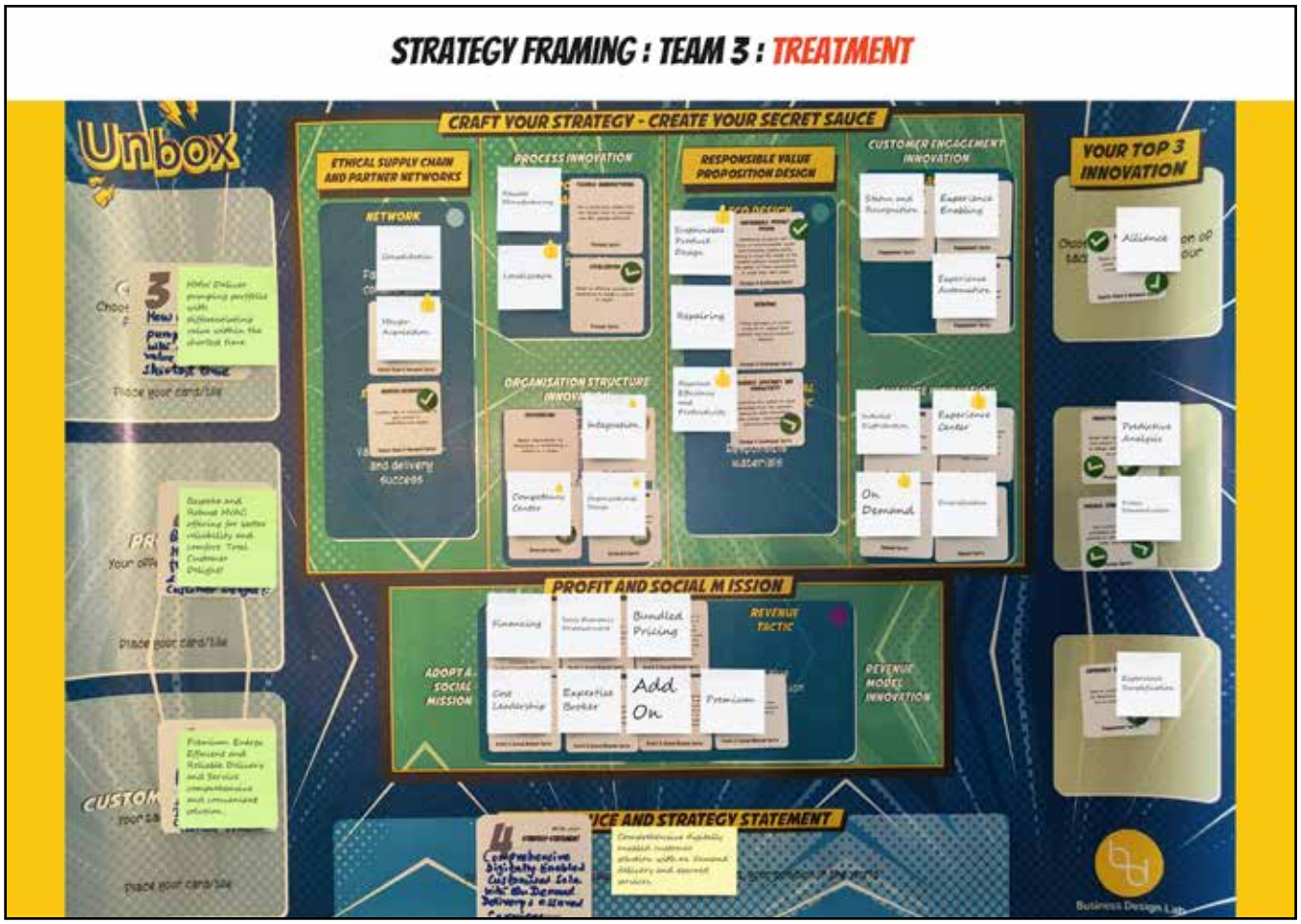
Following the selection and prioritization of business model tactics, each team was guided to synthesize their choices into a coherent strategy.

To support this, a strategy prompt card was provided, containing structured guidance and thought-provoking questions. This helped the teams reflect on the logic behind their selected tactics and articulate a unified strategic narrative.

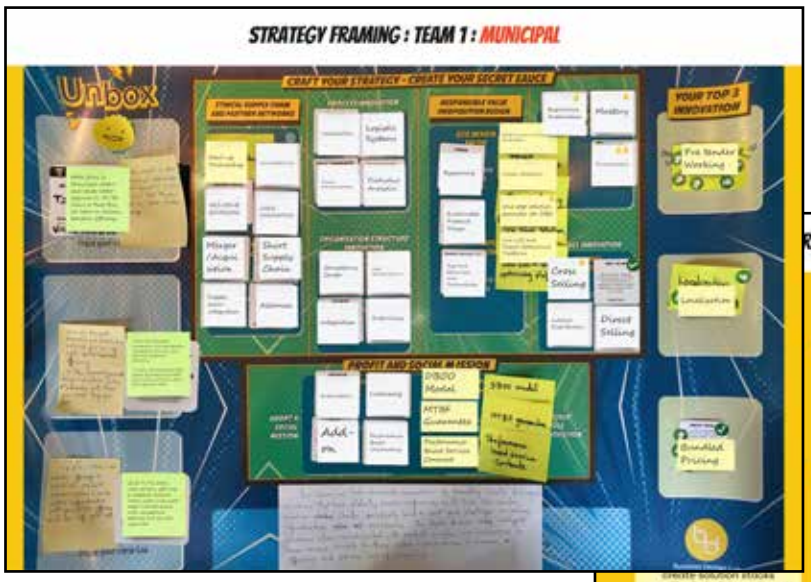
The card encouraged them to consider how the different business model elements interconnect, the value they aim to deliver, and how the strategy aligns with their challenge statement. The outcome was a clear, focused strategy statement that could be communicated, tested, and evolved

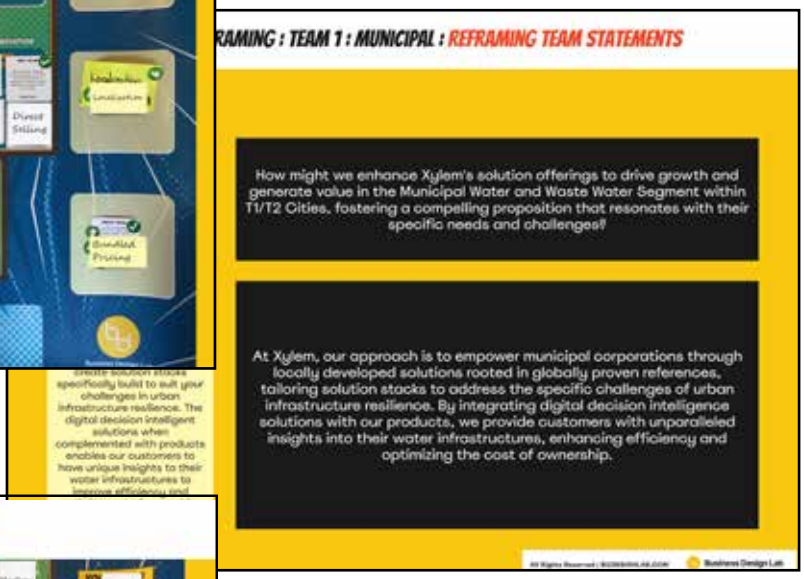
Consolidating ideas/ strategy

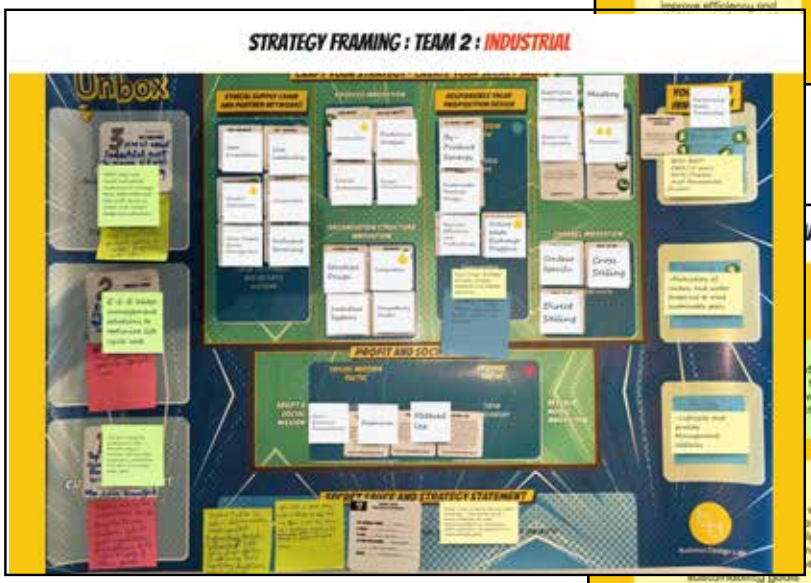
"At the conclusion of the strategic design phase, all three teams—focused on the Industrial, Municipal, and Residential segments—successfully developed complete business models tailored to their respective challenge statements. Using the selected tactics and guided by structured prompts, each team formulated a cohesive strategy that aligned with their chosen customer segment and opportunity area.

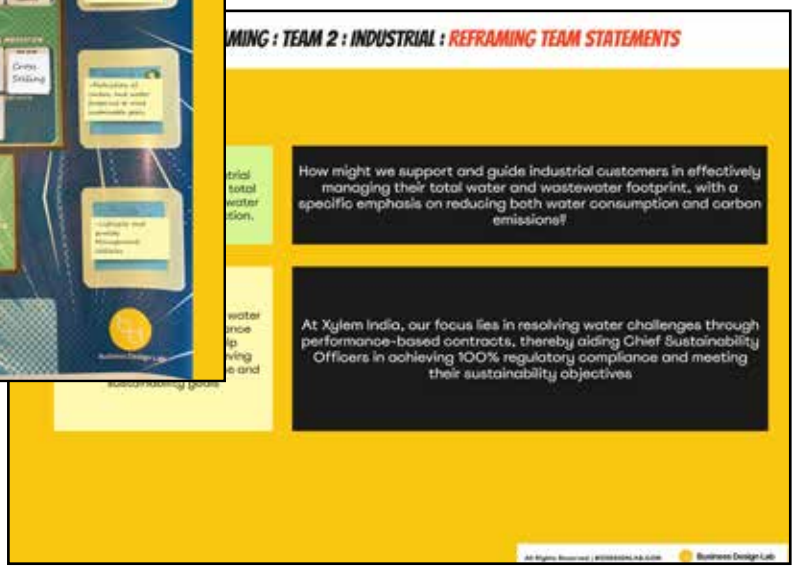


"After the teams finalized their business models and strategies, the Business Design Lab (BDL) team stepped in to refine and reframe the strategy statements into clearer, more actionable language. This reframing ensured that the strategies were not only aligned with business objectives but also suitable for testing and validation.









These refined strategy statements served as the foundation for the next phase of the process: identifying underlying assumptions, formulating hypotheses, and designing experiments. The focus shifted toward de-risking the strategies by systematically testing critical assumptions through experimentation—ultimately aiming to falsify weak hypotheses and strengthen those with evidence-based validation."

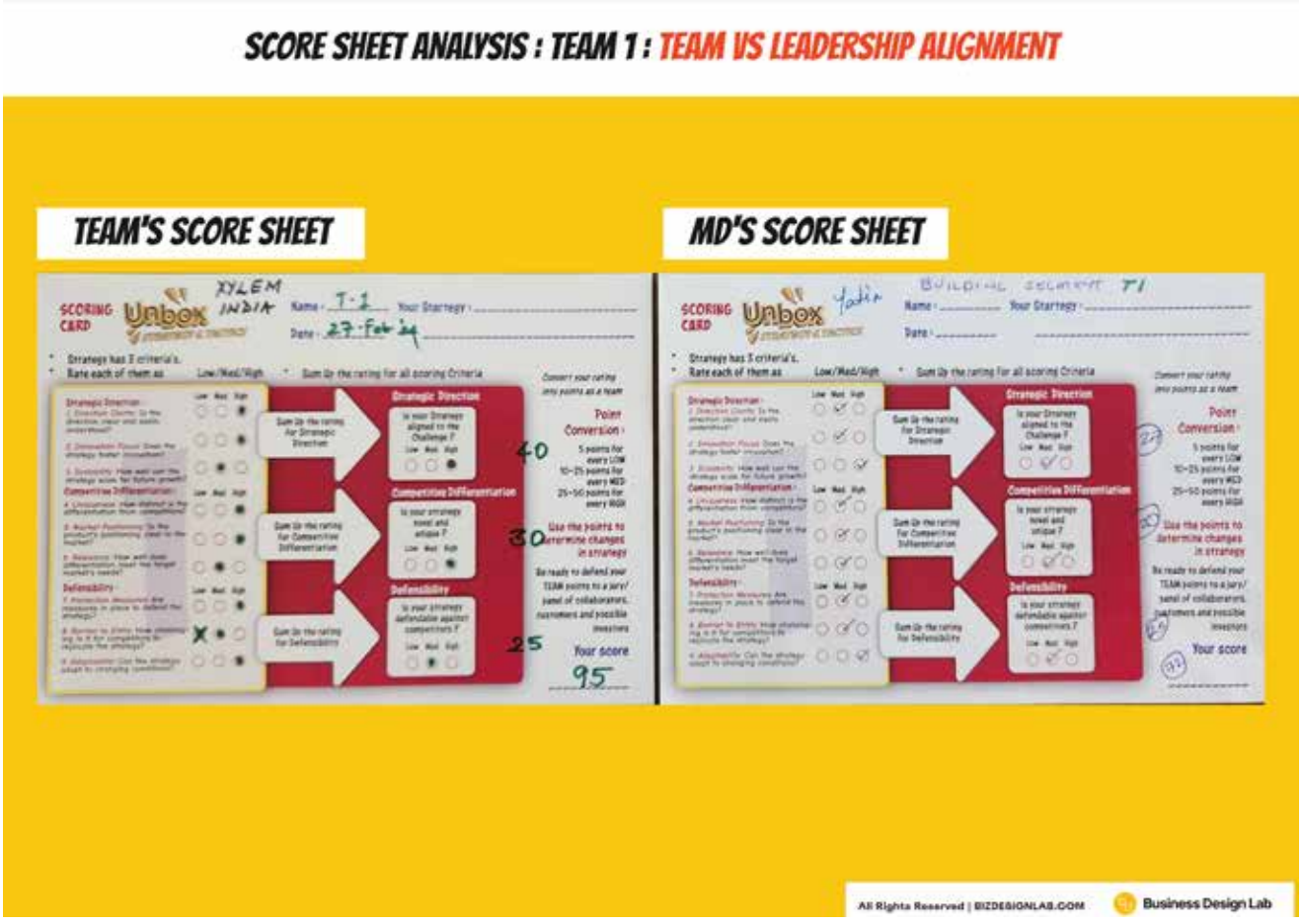
Strategy Scoring

After the Unbox gameplay session, each participant was provided with a scoring sheet to evaluate their team's strategy.

This assessment was done on two levels: individual scoring, where each participant rated the strategy based on specific criteria, and collective team scoring, which encouraged reflection and discussion within the group.

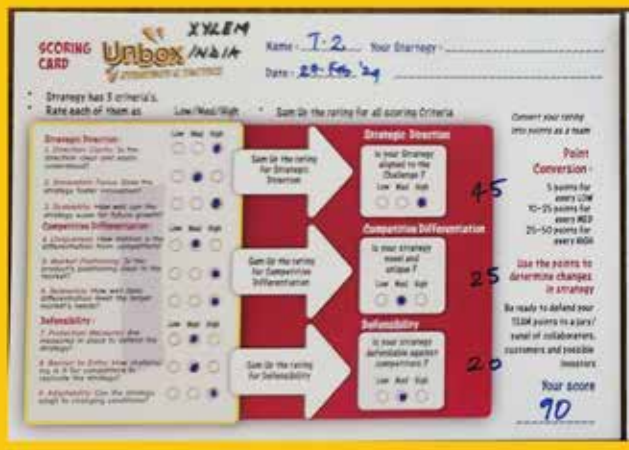
In addition to the team evaluations, the Managing Director (MD) and the Master Facilitator conducted independent evaluations, offering an external and strategic perspective. All scoring sheets were then collected and analyzed collectively.

This comprehensive evaluation process helped identify alignment gaps, differing perceptions, and areas of strategic inconsistency across teams. These insights proved invaluable for Xylem, enabling the organization to reflect deeply, refine its strategies further, and foster stronger alignment across levels."

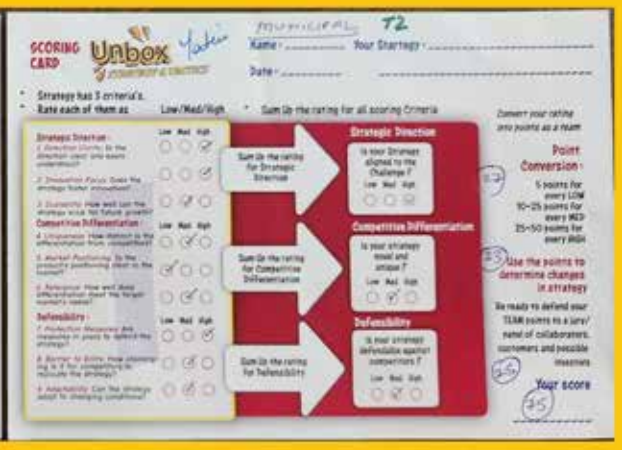


SCORE SHEET ANALYSIS : TEAM 2 : TEAM VS LEADERSHIP ALIGNMENT

TEAM'S SCORE SHEET



MD'S SCORE SHEET



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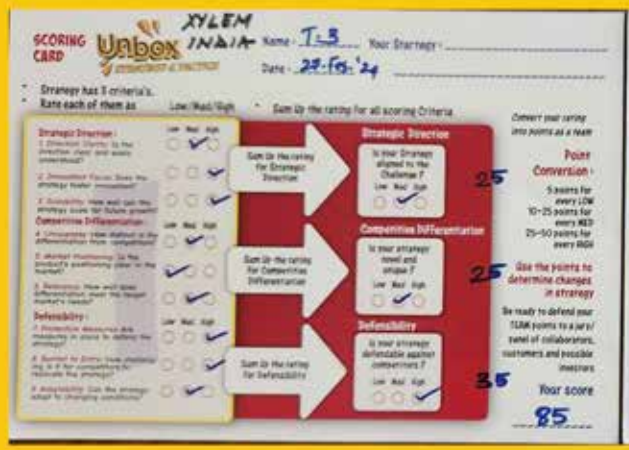
SCORE SHEET ANALYSIS : TEAM 3 : TEAM VS LEADERSHIP ALIGNMENT

TEAM'S SCORE SHEET



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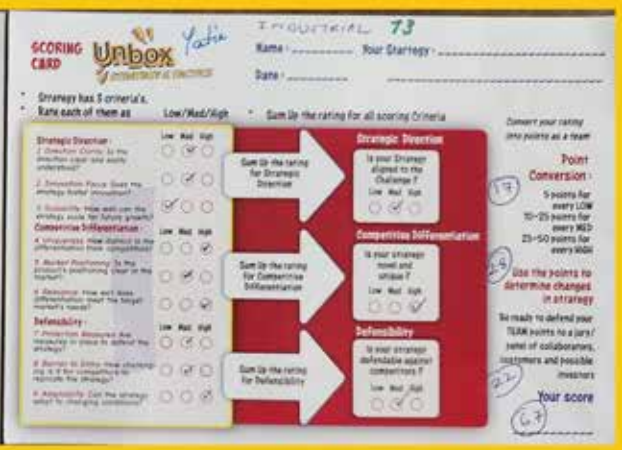

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Execution Roadmap

Once the strategies were refined and evaluated, the Business Design Lab (BDL) team facilitated the development of a strategy execution roadmap for each team.

Using a structured execution framework, the BDL team worked with the Xylem participants to break down their strategic direction into actionable components.

This included identifying key initiatives, assigning responsibilities, defining success metrics, and outlining timelines.

The roadmap served as a practical blueprint to move from strategy to implementation—ensuring clarity, accountability, and momentum in the execution phase.

The activity also reinforced alignment between strategic intent and operational planning."

Team Scoring Sheet

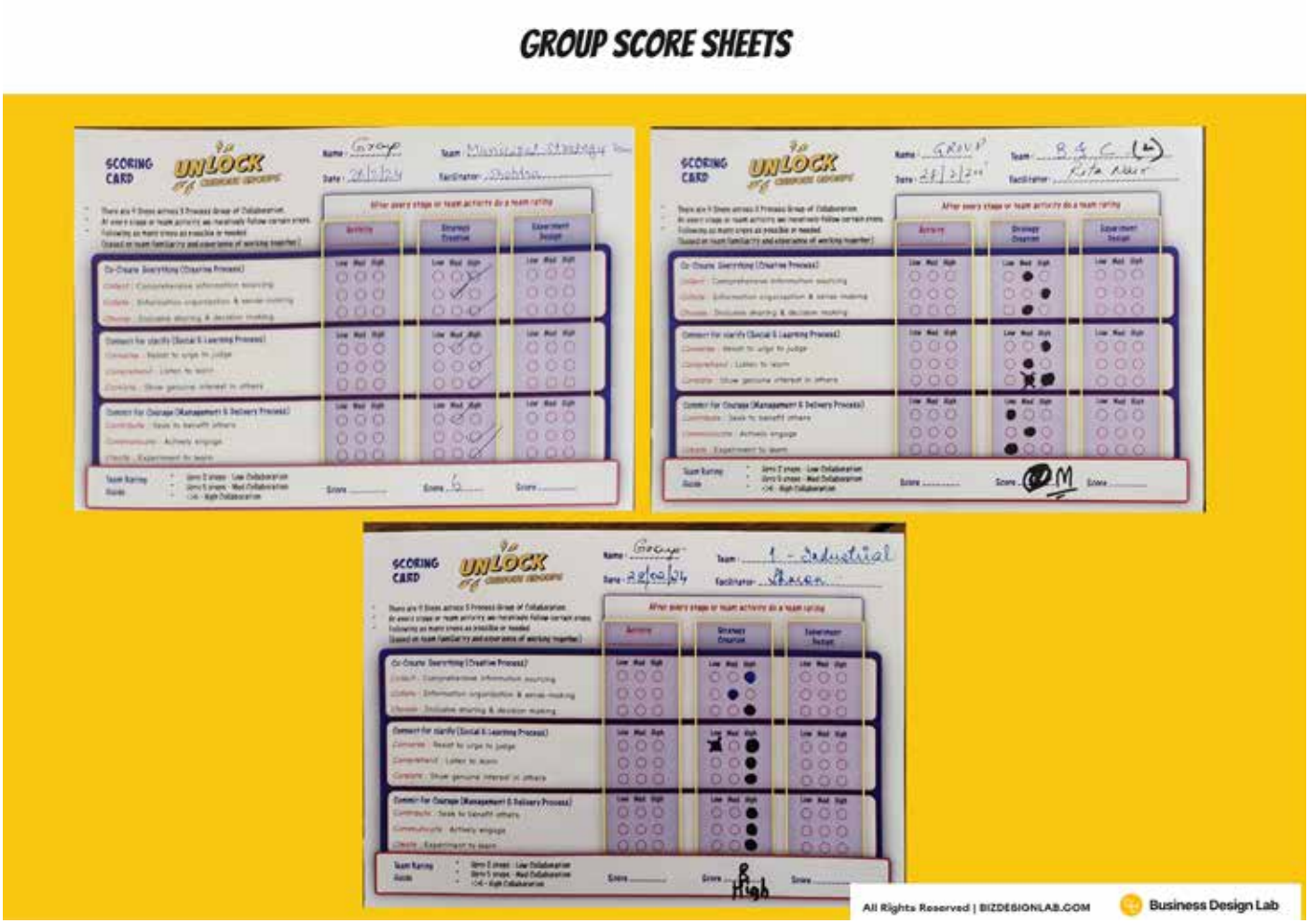
Following the scoring exercise, the Business Design Lab (BDL) team conducted a deeper analysis of all the collected scoring sheets.

This involved examining not only the numerical scores but also the rationale behind them—identifying patterns, divergences in perception, and alignment gaps across individual, team, and leadership evaluations.

By mapping this data, the BDL team uncovered critical insights into how strategies were being understood and valued across different layers of the organization.

This deep dive helped Xylem pinpoint both strengths and blind spots within their strategic thinking, offering clear direction for refinement and stronger alignment going forward."

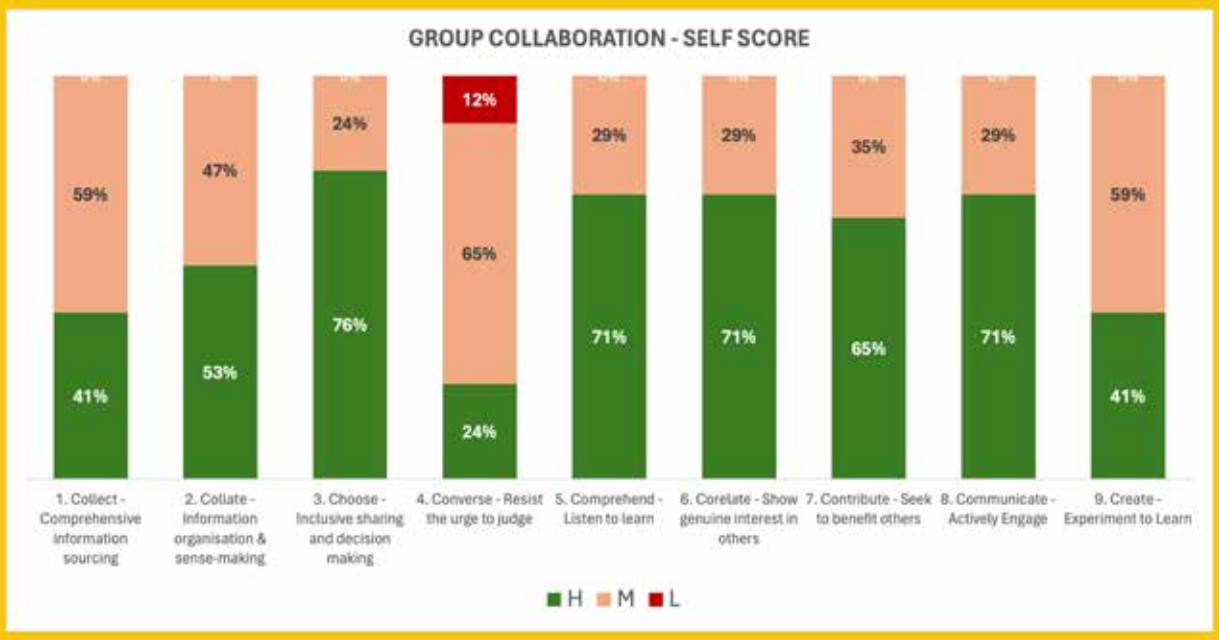
GROUP SCORE SHEETS



Deeper Analysis: Scoring Sheet

Following the strategy evaluation phase, a comprehensive analysis was conducted by the Business Design Lab (BDL) team on all submitted scoring sheets. These sheets, filled out by individual participants, teams, the Managing Director (MD), and the Master Facilitator, provided both qualitative and quantitative insights into how each proposed strategy was perceived and understood.

SUMMARY : TEAM COLLABORATION



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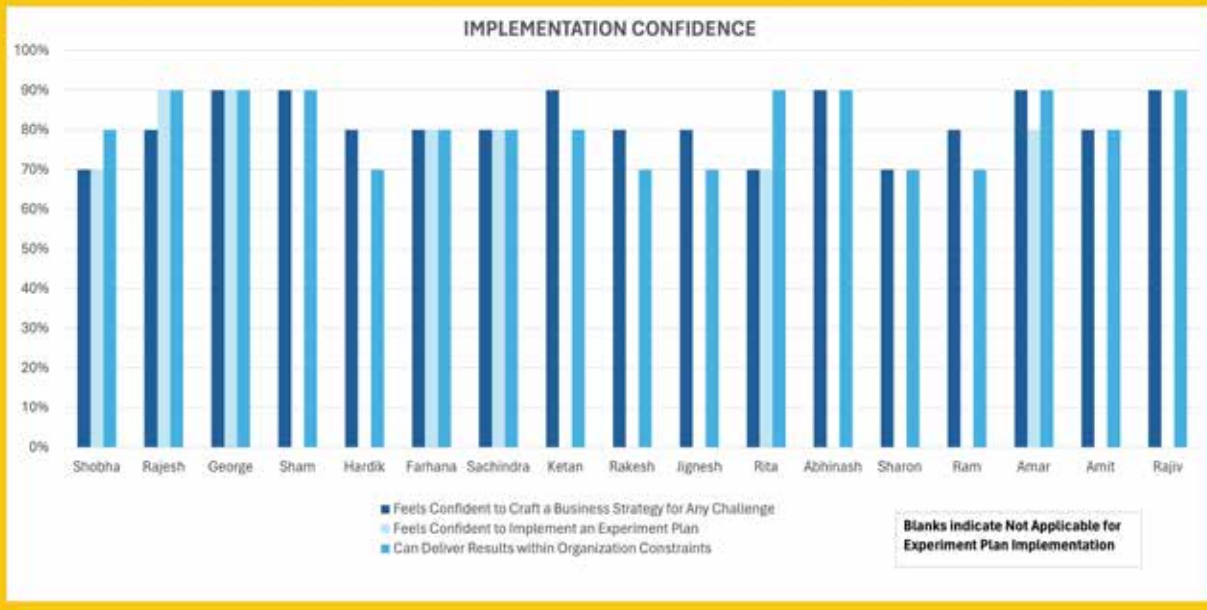
INDIVIDUAL ANALYSIS SUMMARY : IMPLEMENTATION CONFIDENCE



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Delivery of Phygital kit of Unbox to Xylem by BDL

OVERVIEW

The feedback collected from participants at the end of the strategy workshop provided a rich reflection on both the impact and areas for improvement of the overall experience. Participants expressed strong appreciation for the structured approach to strategy development, particularly the use of practical tools such as the Business Model Canvas, tactic cards, and the strategy execution framework.

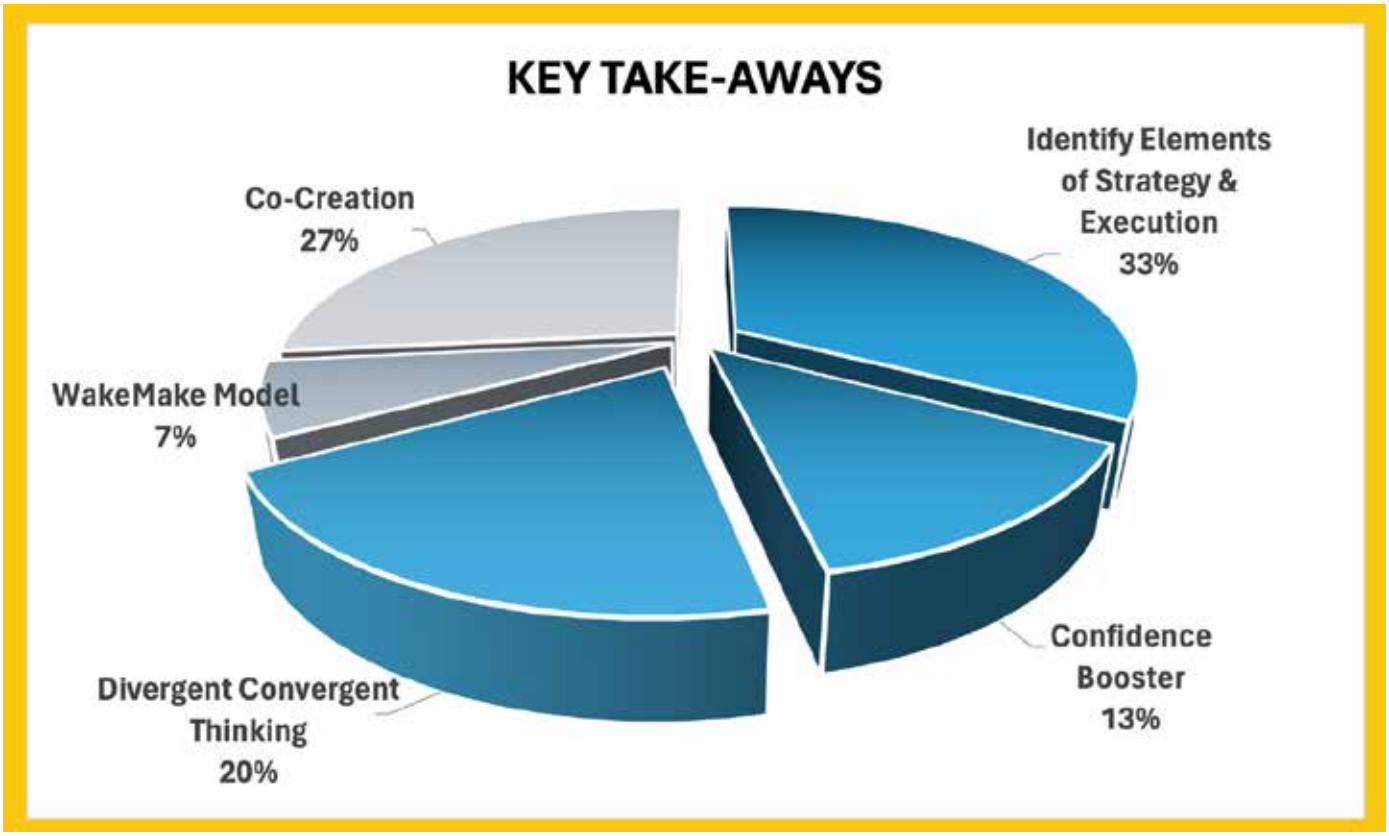
Leadership Off site Program- Client Project (Testing with client)

Playtesting & Contributing to a client projet,
Addressing real-world organizational challenges.

Co-facilitating the delivery of the Unbox experience, Integrating research findings and industry trends into actionable insights for the client.

Refining the final game on the basis of session feedback.

Session Feedback



Participants highlighted the most impactful aspects of the workshop:

Identify Elements of Strategy & Execution – 33%
Most valued learning was around understanding how to define and implement strategy.

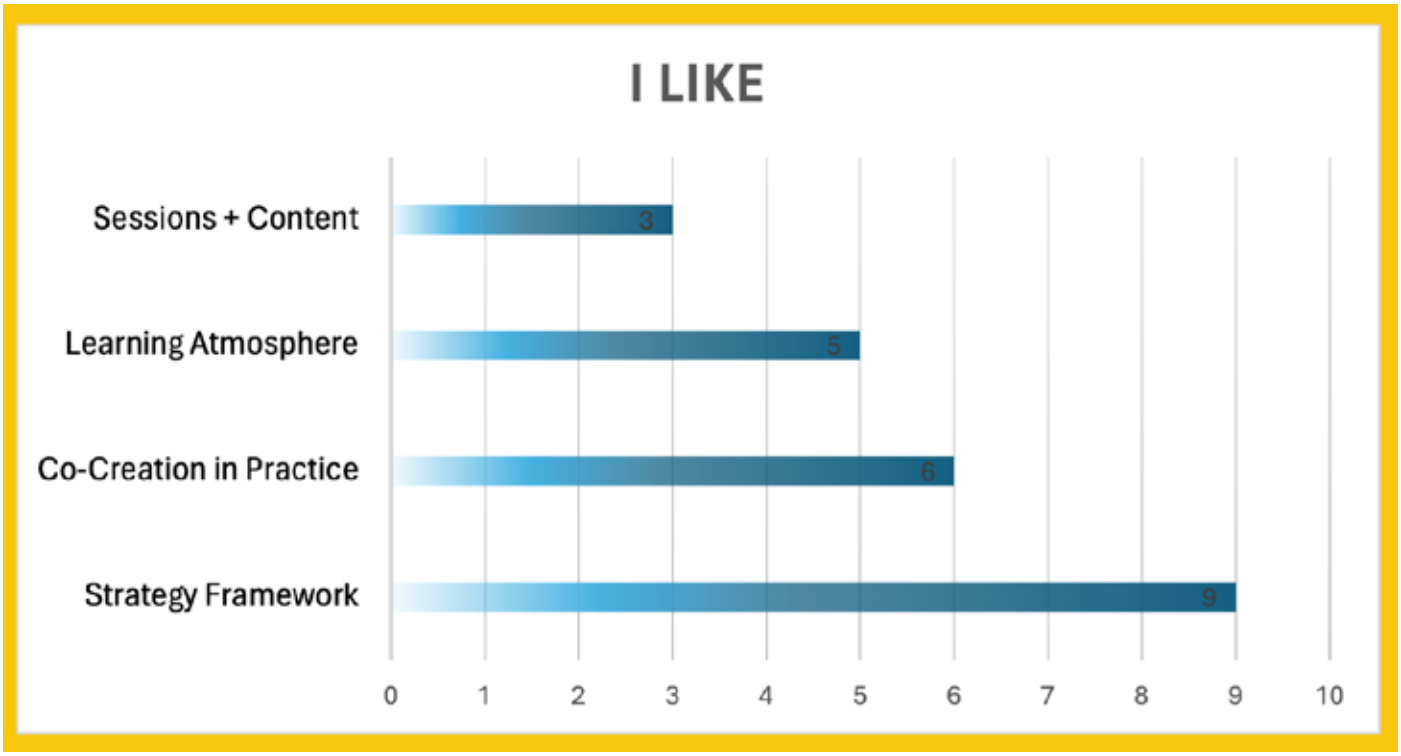
Co-Creation – 27%
Strong appreciation for collaborative methods and team-based innovation.

Divergent & Convergent Thinking – 20%
Participants found value in learning structured ideation and decision-making processes.

Confidence Booster – 13%
The program enhanced participants' self-belief in applying strategy tools.

WakeMake Model – 7%
Gained moderate traction, though not a major standout compared to other tools.

I Like



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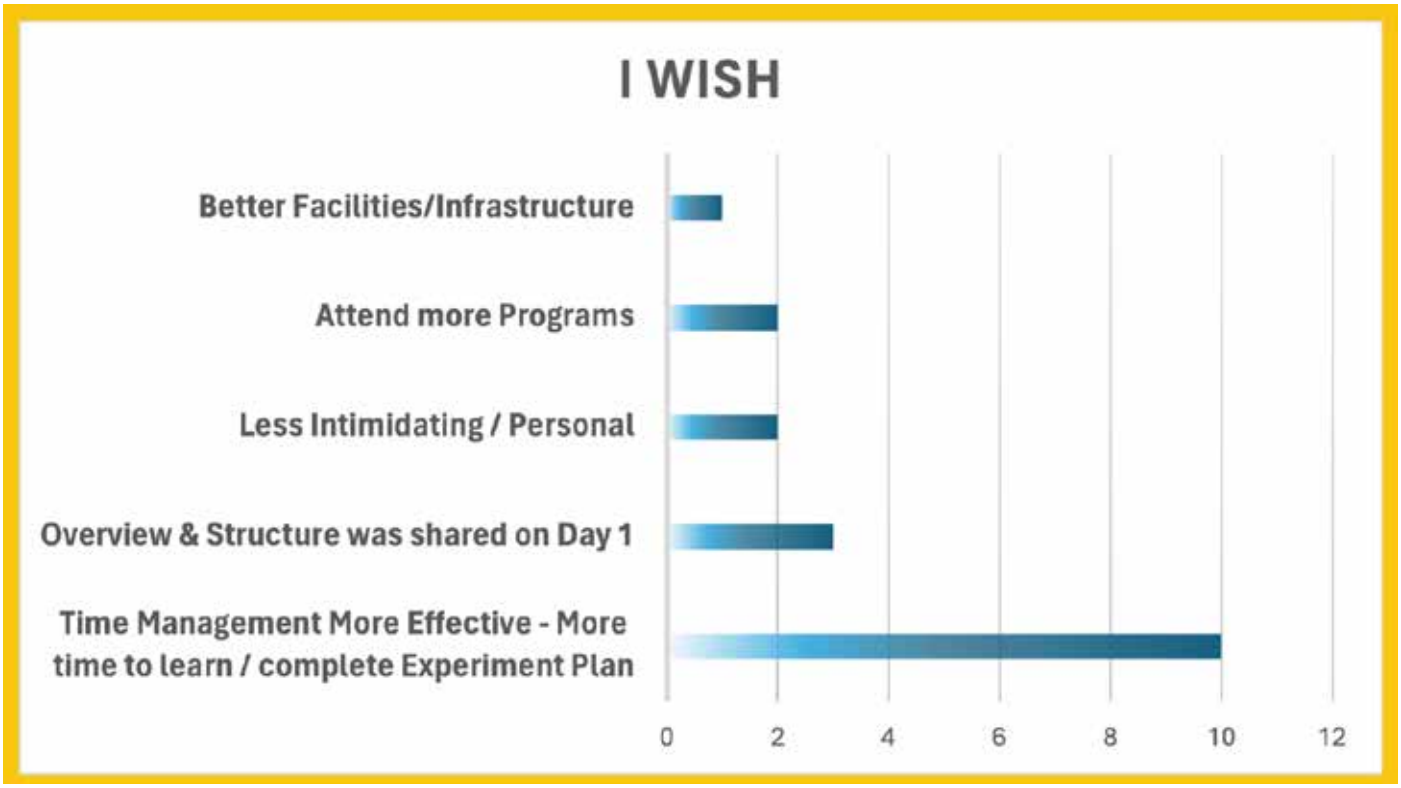
I Wish



I WISH (Suggestions for Improvement)
Participants expressed desires for a better experience:

More Time & Better Time Management – Most mentioned (10+ votes)
Request for extended time to absorb, reflect, and complete experimentation plans.

Earlier Overview of Structure – 4 votes
Participants wanted clarity on program flow from Day 1.

Less Intimidating/More Personal – 2 votes
A need for more personalized and inclusive engagement.

Attend More Programs and Better Infrastructure – 1 vote each
Indicating both excitement and small logistical improvement areas.

I Wonder

I WONDER (Areas of Curiosity/Improvement)
Participants raised questions and improvement points:

Practice in Own Team – Highest interest
Participants are eager to apply learning in their functional teams.

Other areas mentioned include:
Better audibility in sessions, Covering more in Business Excellence, Deeper dive into context + concepts, Clarifying structure and personal biases, More effective time management

Summary

The workshop was well-received, especially in terms of strategic learning and collaboration. Time constraints and early-stage clarity were the biggest areas for improvement. Participants are ready and willing to apply learnings in their own teams, signaling strong post-workshop momentum.

1. High Engagement with Strategic Tools

Participants consistently highlighted their appreciation for structured strategy tools and frameworks introduced during the workshop—particularly those that clarified the elements of strategy formulation and execution. This indicates a strong appetite for practical, action-oriented learning that goes beyond theory. The Business Model Canvas, tactic cards, and execution roadmaps likely played a key role here.

Implication:

There's clear value in continuing to anchor future workshops around structured methodologies and tangible tools that teams can apply directly to their work environments.

2. Strong Emphasis on Co-Creation and Collaboration

The process of co-creating solutions in cross-functional teams was the second most appreciated aspect. This reflects how participants benefited from diverse perspectives and collaborative ideation. The workshop successfully created a safe space for knowledge exchange and collective problem-solving.

Implication:

Xylem should continue encouraging interdisciplinary collaboration, not only in workshops but also as part of ongoing strategy development processes within the organization.

3. Time Constraints Were a Key Limitation

The most dominant feedback under "I Wish" and "I Wonder" was related to time management. Participants felt rushed, especially when it came to synthesizing learnings and completing experimentation plans. Several also expressed a need for more time to apply concepts within their own teams or in real-world scenarios.

Implication:

Future sessions could benefit from:
Allowing more breathing room for deep dives and reflection
Providing pre-workshop orientation or pre-reads
Scheduling dedicated follow-up sessions for implementation and experimentation

4. Post-Workshop Momentum

A number of participants expressed curiosity about applying what they learned in their own teams, reflecting a desire for continuity beyond the workshop. This is a strong indicator that the workshop didn't just "land well" but also inspired action.

Implication:

This momentum can be channeled by:
Supporting teams with micro-implementation kits
Offering coaching or check-ins post-workshop
Encouraging internal showcases or success stories

OVERVIEW

MINERVA
RV Center for Leadership & Executive Education

The Unbox: Gamified Business Innovation Workshop offered a full-day, hands-on experience that immersed participants in the fundamentals of design thinking, strategic innovation, and entrepreneurial problem-solving. Structured around a gamified format, the workshop enabled participants to move beyond passive learning and actively engage in framing real-world challenges, building business models, and testing ideas through collaboration and play.

Game Launch Event

Orchestrating and delivering a gamified workshop experience tailored for stakeholders including students, investors, founders, entrepreneurs, designers, and product managers.

Creating and participating in the whole session experience.
Play-testing to crosscheck accessibility and implementation of all assets.

Overview

In collaboration with Business Design Lab (BDL) and MineRVa – RV Center for Leadership & Executive Education, successfully organized the Unbox: Gamified Business Innovation Workshop at RV Teachers College, Jayanagar, Bengaluru.

The workshop delivered a full-day, immersive experience that combined design thinking, strategic innovation, and entrepreneurial problem-solving in a gamified format.

This event brought together a diverse group of stakeholders including students, startup founders, investors, designers, entrepreneurs, and product managers, offering them a collaborative platform to tackle real-world business challenges.

Workshop

The workshop was centered around the Unbox board game, a gamified strategy and innovation tool designed by Business Design Lab. Participants worked in cross-functional teams to frame challenges, develop business models, and pitch viable and scalable solutions.

The ideation followed the Double Diamond framework—moving through Discover, Define, Develop, and Deploy stages. Tools like prompt cards, assumption finders, and wisdom-of-the-crowd scoring sheets were integrated to guide participants toward well-rounded strategies.

Business Design Lab
MINERVA
FOR
GET READY TO LEVEL UP YOUR BIZ INNOVATION SKILLS
Unbox
A HOLISTIC BIZ INNOVATION IN-A-BOX TO SOLVE REAL WORLD CHALLENGES
NEW AGE LEADERSHIP & EXECUTIVE EDUCATION
BIZ INNOVATION AND DESIGN

CHALLENGE STATEMENT

SOCIAL MISSION
ORGANISATIONAL STRUCTURE
INNOVATION

Organising the Experience

The successful execution of the Unbox Gamified Business Innovation Workshop was the result of meticulous planning, iterative playtesting, and seamless collaboration between student organizers, Business Design Lab (BDL), and RV University's MineRVa team.

The student organizing team played a critical role in orchestrating every layer of the event experience, including:

End-to-End Logistics Coordination:
From venue arrangements, registrations, supplies, and breakout spaces to coordinating guest speakers and facilitators, the team managed every operational detail with precision.

Playtesting the Experience:
In the weeks leading up to the event, the team conducted multiple playtest sessions to validate the accessibility, flow, and clarity of the Unbox game. This ensured that participants, regardless of background, could engage meaningfully with the game mechanics and strategic tools.

Asset Implementation & Setup:
All physical and digital assets—including prompt cards, game boards, scoring sheets, and strategy templates—were organized, assembled, and tested for usability. Clear signage, print materials, and onboarding instructions were prepared in advance.

Stakeholder Management:
The team liaised between multiple parties—faculty, facilitators, speakers, and participants—to ensure a smooth and cohesive experience. This involved real-time coordination and flexibility throughout the day.

Media, Documentation & Feedback:
The event was documented through photographs, videos, and participant interviews. Feedback forms and informal conversations were also facilitated to capture insights for future iterations.

This intensive behind-the-scenes effort reflects the team's capabilities in event design, experiential learning facilitation, stakeholder engagement, and crisis-free execution under tight timelines.

Unbox

6
Discussion
Room
MINERVA
Unbox
TEAM 3

OVERVIEW

MINERVA
RV Center for Leadership & Executive Education

This phase helped participants articulate clearer strategic narratives, test their assumptions through experimentation methods, and recognize the importance of alignment between vision, execution, and market relevance. By the end of the session, Unbox had successfully transformed abstract concepts into practical learning—equipping participants with a deeper understanding of how to build, test, and refine strategies in the real world.

Game Launch Event

Orchestrating and delivering a gamified workshop experience tailored for stakeholders including students, investors, founders, entrepreneurs, designers, and product managers.

Creating and participating in the whole session experience.
Play-testing to crosscheck accessibility and implementation of all assets.

Overview

After the core gameplay concluded, participants entered a structured reflection phase that emphasized self-assessment, peer feedback, and strategic alignment.

Teams scored their strategies across multiple criteria—such as innovation, feasibility, and defensibility—using the "Wisdom of the Crowd" scoring framework.

Insights were drawn not just from individual perspectives, but also from facilitators and expert reviewers, revealing perception gaps and uncovering growth opportunities.

Event concept and Format

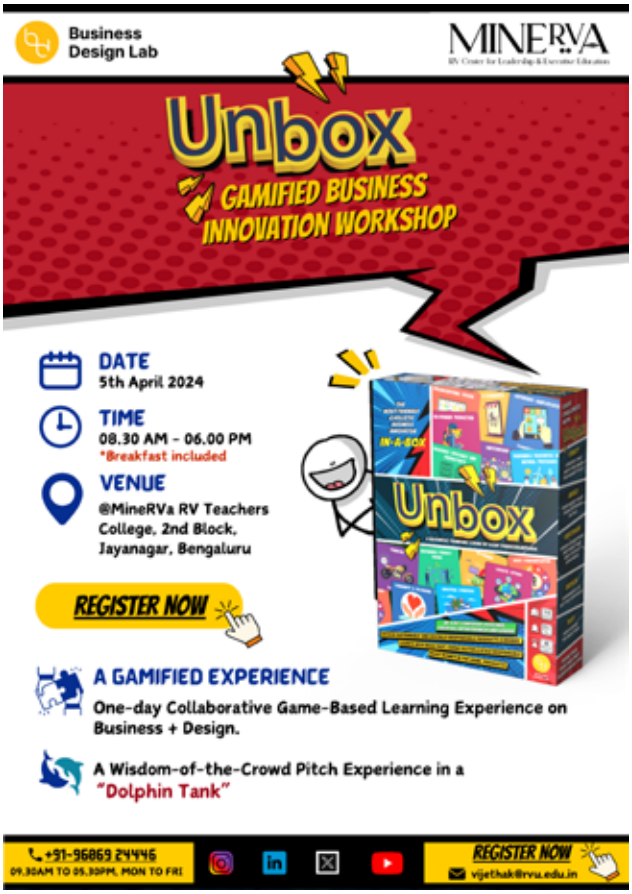
The Unbox: Gamified Business Innovation Workshop was designed as a hands-on, immersive experience that merged the principles of design thinking, business modeling, and lean experimentation into a collaborative, game-based format.

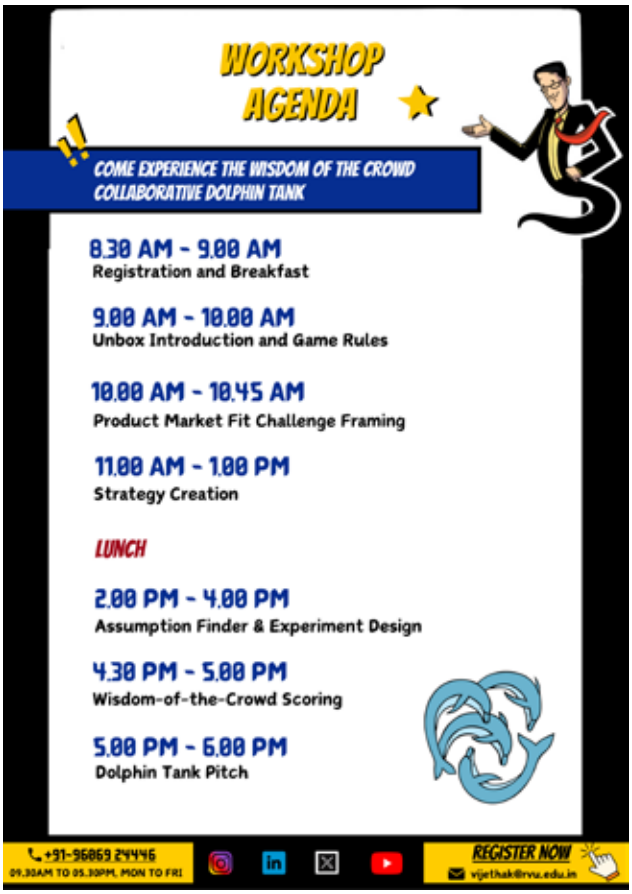
Participants worked in cross-functional teams to solve curated, real-world business challenges—such as launching Tesla in India or scaling Airbnb in rural markets—using a hybrid toolkit of physical game components and digital templates.

The format followed a structured journey inspired by the Double Diamond framework, guiding teams through phases of problem discovery, customer segmentation, strategic design, and hypothesis-driven validation.

The gamified structure encouraged creative exploration, critical thinking, and collaborative decision-making, culminating in team pitches and peer scoring to simulate investor and market feedback.

Dynamic Event Brochure/Promotional Design




WORKSHOP AGENDA
COME EXPERIENCE THE WISDOM OF THE CROWD COLLABORATIVE DOLPHIN TANK
8.30 AM - 9.00 AM
Registration and Breakfast
9.00 AM - 10.00 AM
Unbox Introduction and Game Rules
10.00 AM - 10.45 AM
Product Market Fit Challenge Framing
11.00 AM - 1.00 PM
Strategy Creation
LUNCH
2.00 PM - 4.00 PM
Assumption Finder & Experiment Design
4.30 PM - 5.00 PM
Wisdom-of-the-Crowd Scoring
5.00 PM - 6.00 PM
Dolphin Tank Pitch
+91-96869 24446
09.30AM TO 05.30PM, MON TO FRI
REGISTER NOW
vijethak@rvu.edu.in

Business Design Lab
FOR
MINERVA
CREATORS, DESIGNERS, PRODUCT MANAGERS AND ENTREPRENEURS
WHO ARE SOLVING ANY OF THE FOLLOWING CHALLENGES:
How Might We, build a great product and service?
How Might We, innovate and transform the entire organisation?
How Might We, scale our business and win in the marketplace?
I need to co-create winning designs, innovations and a value proposition.
I need a collaborative team with a business mindset.
Product & Value Focus
Leadership & Execution Focus
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DOLPHIN TANK
TELL YOUR TEAM STORY OF INNOVATION AND EXPERIMENT PITCH TO A POD OF DOLPHIN LEADERS!
GAIN VALUABLE INSIGHTS AND FEEDBACK!
Business Leader
#Dhande ki baat
Eco-System Builder
Research & Academics
Business Design Lab
Unbox
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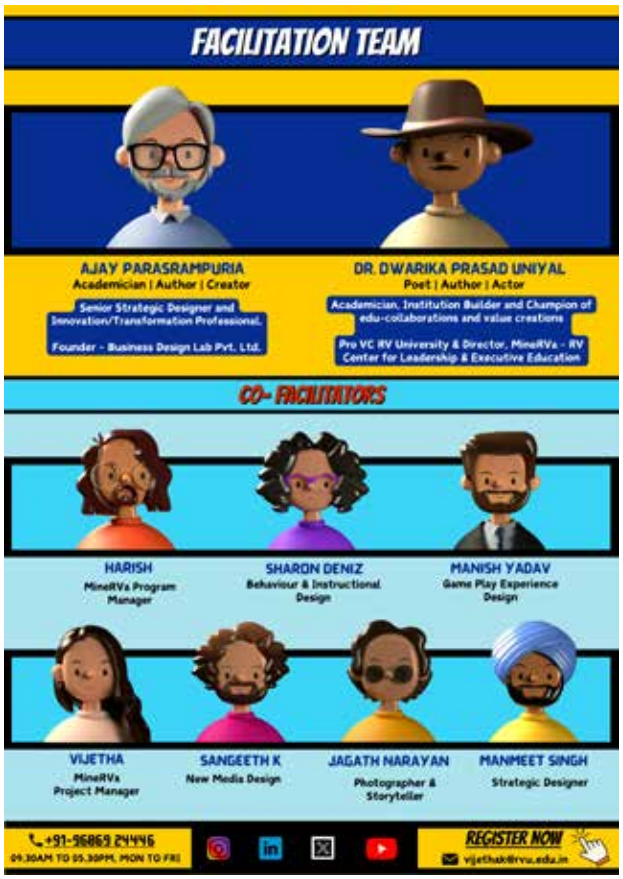
FACILITATION TEAM
AJAY PARASRAMPURIA
Academician | Author | Creator
Senior Strategic Designer and Innovation/Transformation Professional.
Founder - Business Design Lab Pvt. Ltd.
DR. DWARIKA PRASAD UNIYAL
Poet | Author | Actor
Academician, Institution Builder and Champion of edu-collaborations and value creations
Pro VC RV University & Director, MineRVa - RV Center for Leadership & Executive Education
CO- FACILITATORS
HARISH
MineRVa Program Manager
SHARON DENIZ
Behaviour & Instructional Design
MANISH YADAV
Game Play Experience Design
VIJETHA
MineRVa Project Manager
SANGEETH K
New Media Design
JAGATH NARAYAN
Photographer & Storyteller
MANMEET SINGH
Strategic Designer
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09.30AM TO 05.30PM, MON TO FRI
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vijethak@rvu.edu.in

Session Experience

This session was designed to democratize evaluation by involving all participants in the scoring process.

After each team presented their strategic solution, attendees used a structured scoring sheet to assess the ideas based on criteria such as:

Clarity of the problem and solution

Feasibility of implementation

Level of innovation and originality

Customer-centricity

Scalability and impact

By gathering scores from a diverse group of participants—ranging from students to investors, designers to entrepreneurs—this format allowed for real-time collective intelligence to emerge. The process mimicked how real markets respond to ideas, adding a layer of realism and pressure to the exercise.

The scoring helped surface which ideas were most resonant across the room, and revealed interesting alignment gaps between how teams viewed their own strategies vs. how others perceived them.

Thank you!

Conclusion

Inspired by the popular "Shark Tank" format but with a more collaborative and constructive twist, the Dolphin Tank session served as the workshop's grand finale. Each team pitched their business model and strategic vision to a panel of dolphin leaders—mentors and facilitators who represented various industry perspectives.

Unlike competitive pitching formats, the Dolphin Tank emphasized supportive feedback, strategic suggestions, and guidance. The environment encouraged teams to:

Tell the story of their strategy journey

Justify key decisions using frameworks and customer insights

Respond to thoughtful, non-combative critiques from the panel and audience

The feedback covered not just the what of their ideas, but also the how—execution pathways, potential partnerships, and real-world considerations.

Participants found this session deeply validating and insightful, as it allowed them to see their ideas through the lens of industry mentors and identify next steps with greater clarity and confidence.

Learnings and Scope

Key Learnings from the Unbox Development Journey

1. The Power of Structured Play

Gamified learning works best when anchored in a strong, structured process.

The integration of design thinking, business modeling, and experimentation offered both structure and creative freedom.

Players stayed engaged while working through complex strategic concepts because the experience was fun, visual, and purpose-driven.

2. Strategy Can Be Taught Through Experience

Participants absorbed core business concepts such as value propositions, competitive advantage, defensibility, and market fit not through lectures—but by making real decisions in the game.

The tactic cards and board layout turned strategy into a tangible, collaborative exercise.

Real-world thinking became embedded in gameplay, resulting in practical takeaways that could be applied outside the game.

3. Business Thinking is a Learnable Skill

Unbox demonstrated that business thinking is not just for MBAs or entrepreneurs—it can be cultivated through guided play.

Players learned to frame challenges, analyze competitors, define customer segments, and build testable models.

The iterative nature of the game encouraged a mindset of experimentation, critical thinking, and systems perspective—all core to business leadership.

4. Facilitation is Key to a Transformative Experience

The success of every session depended not just on the game design, but on skilled facilitation.

Facilitators had to read the energy of the room, guide discussions without dominating, and help participants extract insights from each phase.

Soft skills like active listening, timeboxing, reframing user inputs, and managing group dynamics were essential to maintaining flow and focus.

Facilitators acted as both guides and amplifiers—ensuring that participants went beyond surface-level play to achieve meaningful learning outcomes.

5. Collaboration Enhances Strategic Quality

Diverse teams consistently created stronger, more resilient strategies.

Cross-functional thinking emerged naturally as designers, engineers, and business students contributed different perspectives.

The structured format ensured equal contribution, encouraging quieter participants to share ideas and insights.

6. Onboarding is a Make-or-Break Moment

A well-crafted onboarding process—through pre-game forms, guided prompts, and persona/product cards—was critical in preparing participants.

When users clearly understood their challenge and customer context from the beginning, their strategy and experimentation were sharper and more relevant.

Onboarding helped shift participants from “what should I do?” to “how should I win?

7. Hypothesis-Driven Thinking Builds Strategic Agility

One of the most transformative aspects of the game was teaching players to identify and test assumptions.

Moving from a solid idea to a testable hypothesis, and then choosing an experiment to validate it, made the strategy feel real and accountable.

This embedded the principles of lean startup, design research, and agile iteration into every decision.

8. Real-World Scenarios Deepen Immersion

Challenges like Tesla's India entry or Airbnb's growth strategy helped players connect with familiar brands and apply strategic frameworks in a realistic setting.

These case decks balanced structure and flexibility, allowing for creativity while staying grounded in business feasibility.

The scenario-based learning bridged the gap between academia and industry.

9. Simplicity + Visual Hierarchy Drives Usability

Players engaged more confidently with assets when visual design prioritized clarity, readability, and intuitive flow.

Icon systems, color codes, and clean layouts helped users navigate complexity without feeling overwhelmed.

Clear design meant facilitators could spend less time explaining and more time enabling

10. Iteration is Everything

Playtesting with real users—such as the Butter community and MIT Pune—uncovered critical refinements in gameplay mechanics, terminology, pacing, and user flow.

Every round of testing revealed something new, reinforcing that no idea is complete without feedback.

Prototyping wasn't just a phase—it became part of the culture of how Unbox was built.

Through Unbox, we learned that effective business thinking isn't about memorizing frameworks—it's about doing, reflecting, and adjusting. And just like business itself, successful learning requires collaboration, facilitation, and experimentation.

Unbox taught how to:
Think like strategists
Facilitate like educators
Design like systems thinkers
And play like innovators

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Thank You

Endnotes